

WHITFIELD COUNTY GEORGIA



Annual Comprehensive Financial Report

For the Year Ended December 31, 2024

Prepared by Finance Department

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

ANNUAL COMPREHENSIVE FINANCIAL REPORT

*FOR THE
YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 2024*



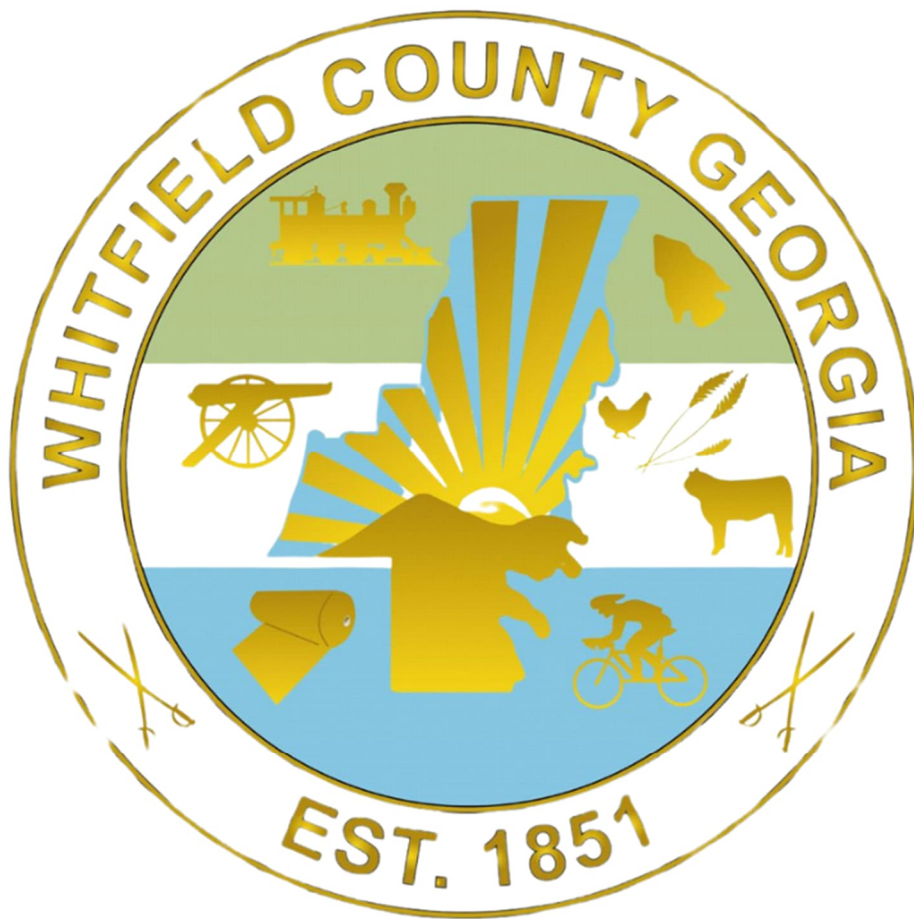
JEVIN JENSEN
CHAIRMAN

Prepared by the Whitfield County Finance Department

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Part I

Introductory Section



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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
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Government Finance Officers Association

**Certificate of
Achievement
for Excellence
in Financial
Reporting**

Presented to

**Whitfield County
Georgia**

For its Annual Comprehensive
Financial Report
For the Fiscal Year Ended

December 31, 2023

Christopher P. Morill

Executive Director/CEO

Whitfield County, Georgia
General Government Officials
December 31, 2024

Legislative

Board of Commissioners

Jevin Jensen, Chairman

Barry W. Robbins, District 1

John Thomas District 3

Robbie Staten, District 2

Greg Jones, District 4

Executive

Administration

Robert Sivick - County Administrator

Blanca Cardona - County Clerk

Department Heads

Debbie Godfrey - Finance

Jackie Carlo - Human Recourses

Rick Lovelady - Information Technology

Charles Fetzer - Buildings and Grounds

Paul Patterson Sr. - Fire Department

David Metcalf - Emergency Services/911

Brian Chastain - Parks and Recreation

Whitney Dunn – Animal Shelter

Kent Benson - County Engineer

Kristi Queen - Chief Appraiser

Shaynee Bryson - Elections Supervisor

George Souther - Juvenile Court Judge

Mary Hammontree - Senior Center

Amanda McCoy - Public Defender

Jean Price-Garland - Zoning Enforcement

Valeria Molina - Public Relations

Diane Franklin - Transit

Constitutional Officers

Scott Chitwood - Sheriff

Babs Bailey - Clerk of Court

Sherri Blevins - Probate Court Judge

Danny W. Sane - Tax Commissioner

Other Elected Officials

Christopher Griffin - Chief Magistrate Court Judge

Thomas Phillips - Magistrate Court Judge

Linda Gayle Gazaway - Magistrate Court Judge

Rodney Weaver - Magistrate Court Judge

Clyde McDaniel Jr. - Coroner

Benjamin Kenemer - District Attorney

Cindy Morris - Chief Superior Court Judge

Bert Poston - Superior Court Judge

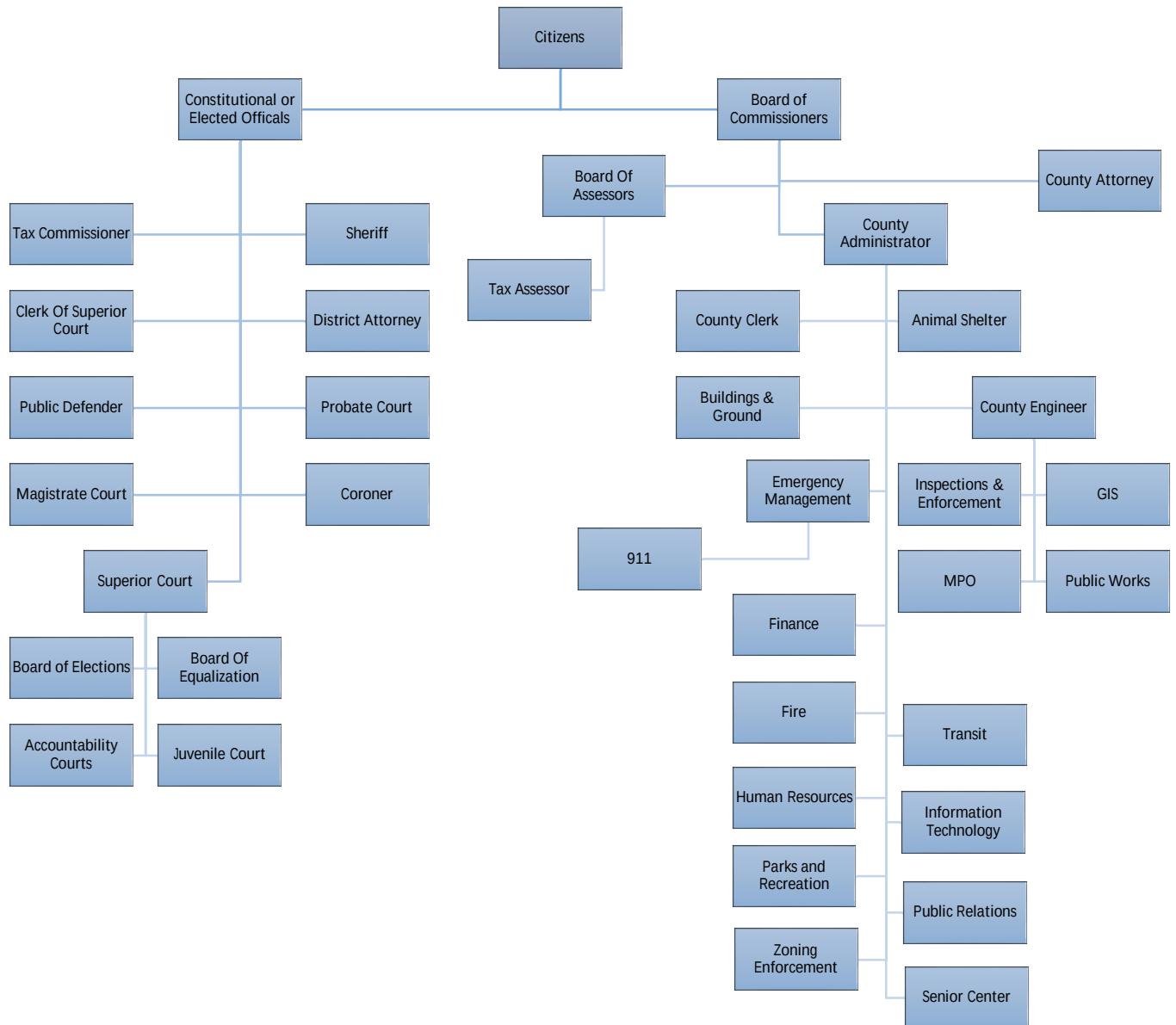
Jim Wilbanks - Superior Court Judge

Scott Minter - Superior Court Judge

Whitfield County, Georgia

Organizational Chart

December 31, 2024



Whitfield County

Board of Commissioners



Board Members
Jevin Jensen, Chairman
Robby Staten
Greg Jones
Barry Robbins
John Thomas

June 30, 2025

The Honorable Jevin Jensen, Chairman
Members of the Board of Commissioners
and Citizens of Whitfield County, Georgia

State law requires that all general-purpose local governments publish within six months of the close of each fiscal year, unless an extension has been approved, a complete set of financial statements presented in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles (GAAP) and audited in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards by a firm of licensed certified public accountants. Pursuant to that requirement, we hereby issue the annual comprehensive financial report of Whitfield County for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2024.

This report consists of management's representations concerning the finances of Whitfield County. Consequently, management assumes full responsibility for the completeness and reliability of all the information presented in this report. To provide a reasonable basis for making these representations, management of Whitfield County has established a comprehensive internal control framework that is designed both to protect the government's assets from loss, theft, or misuse and to compile sufficient reliable information for the preparation of the Whitfield County financial statements in conformity with GAAP. Because the cost of internal controls should not outweigh their benefits, the Whitfield County comprehensive framework of internal controls has been designed to provide reasonable, rather than absolute, assurance that the financial statements will be free from material misstatement. As management, we assert that to the best of our knowledge and belief this financial report is complete and reliable in all material respects.

Whitfield County's financial statements were audited by Rushton, LLC, a firm of licensed certified public accountants. The goal of the independent audit was to provide reasonable assurance that the financial statements of Whitfield County for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2024 were free of material misstatement. The independent audit involved examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements; assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management; and evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. The independent auditor concluded, based upon the audit, that there was a reasonable basis for rendering an unqualified opinion that the Whitfield County financial statements for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2024 were fairly presented in conformity with GAAP. The independent auditor's report is presented as the first component of the financial section of this report.

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www.whitfieldcountyga.com

GAAP require that management provide a narrative introduction, overview, and analysis to accompany the basic financial statements in the form of Management's Discussion and Analysis (MD&A). This letter of transmittal is designed to complement MD&A and should be read in conjunction with it. Whitfield County's MD&A can be found immediately following the report of the independent auditors.

Overview of the Annual Comprehensive Financial Report

The Annual Comprehensive Financial Report is presented in three sections: Introductory, Financial, and Statistical. The Introductory Section includes this letter of transmittal; a list of Whitfield County's principal officials, department directors and elected officials, and organizational chart. The Financial Section includes management's discussion and analysis, basic financial statements and schedules, as well as the independent auditor's report on these financial statements and schedules. The Statistical Section includes selected financial and demographic information, generally presented on a multi-year basis.

Reporting Entity

The financial reporting entity (Whitfield County, Georgia) includes all of the funds of the primary government, as well as all of its component units. Component units are legally separate entities for which the primary government is financially accountable. Blended component units, although legally separate entities, are, in substance, part of the primary government's operations and are therefore also included as part of the primary government. Based on the blended component unit criteria, no blended component units are included in this report.

Discretely presented component units are reported as a separate column in the combined financial statements to emphasize that they are legally separate from the primary government and to differentiate their financial position, results of operations and cash flows from the primary government. The Whitfield County Department of Public Health is included as a discretely presented component unit.

Profile of the Government

Whitfield County is located in the northwestern portion of Georgia. Considered to be the economic hub of the region, it occupies a land area of 290 square miles and serves an estimated population of 105,070. The County is empowered to levy a property tax on both real and personal properties located within its boundaries. Formed from a portion of Murray County in 1851 - making it Georgia's 97th county - it was named for the Reverend George Whitefield, the founder of the Bethesda Orphan House in Savannah. The spelling of the county's name was later changed to reflect its pronunciation.

Located at the foothills of the Appalachian Mountains, the County is blessed with natural beauty and a mild climate. It also is the gateway to the 150 miles long Chieftain's Trail, which traces the path of the Cherokee Indian sites, located in the Northwest Georgia area. Dalton/Whitfield County is, additionally, known as the "Floor Covering Capital of the World". Being located in 'Auto Alley' on Interstate 75, only 25 miles south of Chattanooga and 85 miles north of Atlanta, Whitfield is also a prime location for business expansion, relocation and economic development. This places the County within a day's drive of half the country's population, making it a great location for distribution.

The County has been operating under a Board-Administrator form of government since 1971. Policy-making and legislative authority are vested in the Board of Commissioners consisting of a Chairman elected at-large and four commissioners from four separate districts, elected by district on a partisan basis. The Chairman and Commissioners serve four-year staggered terms. The Board of Commissioners are responsible for passing ordinances, adopting the budget, appointing committees, and hiring the government's administrator, attorney and auditors, among other duties. The County Administrator is responsible for carrying out the policies and ordinances of the Board of Commissioners, for overseeing the day-to-day operations of the government, and for the hiring/dismissing of the Directors of various departments under the Board of Commissioners.

A full range of services, including police protection via the Sheriff's Office, maintenance of roads and other infrastructure, inspections and enforcement, court services, jail, 911, fire protection, animal control, parks and recreation, emergency management, planning and zoning, storm water management, transit bus operations, and a Senior Center are provided.

The annual budget serves as the foundation for Whitfield County's financial planning and control. In accordance with state law, an operating budget consistent with generally accepted accounting principles is adopted annually, after both the required public notices have been issued and a required public hearing held. The final, appropriated budget must be adopted no later than December 31st, and is prepared by fund and department. Departmental Directors may make transfers of appropriations within a department, except for salaries and benefits and capital. Transfers of appropriations from salaries and benefits and capital, or between departments, however, require the approval of the Board of Commissioners. Therefore, other than for this exception of salaries and benefits and capital, the legal level of budgetary control is at the Departmental level, and applies to every fund for which a budget is adopted. Budget-to-actual comparisons are provided in this report for each individual governmental fund for which an appropriated annual budget has been adopted. Annual appropriated budgets are adopted on a basis consistent with generally accepted accounting principles for the general fund, debt service fund, and all special revenue funds. Annual operating budgets are not legally required for enterprise funds, but are prepared for use in planning, control, and evaluation purposes.

Factors Affecting Financial Conditions

Information presented in the financial statements is best understood when it is considered from the broader perspective of the specific environment within which the County operates.

For decades, Dalton/Whitfield County has been known as the "Floor Covering Capital of the World." However, recent community and economic development planning processes in Whitfield County have consistently arrived at a fundamental conclusion: in order to realize a sustainable economic future, the County must diversify its local economy. Specifically, studies have repeatedly concluded that the community is highly dependent on a single business sector: the carpet and flooring industry. The Board of Commissioners, along with the Joint Development Authority and other County-based municipalities, recognize the need for a more diversified local economy and thus, the necessity of recruiting new businesses to the area. The Dalton/Whitfield County Joint Development Authority (DWJDA) focuses on economic growth of the community by attracting and retaining jobs, diverse investments, and growing the tax base. Dalton's economic development policies are implemented by the Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority (DWJDA). The DWJDA targets manufacturing, automotive, plastics/chemical, food processing, and data center industries due to the area's skilled work force, water-rich community, and physical location. In 2024, the DWJDA continued its focus on housing development to support the work force required by the various industries referenced above. Likewise, the DWJDA also had a role in retail/commercial recruitment in 2024 to broaden the sales tax base and to provide more opportunities for the community to dine and shop within the city.

The Dalton/Whitfield County area continues to see growth in both manufacturing and retailers with substantial capital investment. The DWJDA reports updates on the following economic development projects:

- Hanwha Qcells – is an international company that manufactures solar modules. In 2024, the company opened their expansion facility within the Carbondale Business park just south of Dalton. The expansion represents \$379 Million of new investment and the creation of 978 new jobs for the community. Hiring for those jobs began in 2024 and will continue for the next 2-3 years.
- Essentia Protein Solutions – is a global producer of animal protein solutions for the food and beverage industry. In 2022, Essentia announced construction of a facility within the Carbondale Business park which represents an \$80 million investment creating 80 new jobs. The facility construction was completed in 2024 as planned, with approximately 25 employees hired to help them get through the USDA certification process. Full production is slated to begin in 2025. This manufacturing process requires high utility consumption and will be a water, wastewater, and natural gas customer of Dalton Utilities.

- Engineered Floors, LLC – Installation of the new equipment to manufacture luxury vinyl flooring was completed in 2024, with hiring and production to follow. At this 1.2 million square foot facility will create 200+ new jobs and spend more than \$130 million on the investment.
- Techniplas – is a global producer of highly engineered plastic components. Techniplas spent part of 2024 finishing up their expansion and beginning production. This effort expands the automotive industry in Whitfield County.
- Multi-Family Residential Development – To support a world class, diversified industry one of the most critical components is available housing. In 2023, the JDA worked to oversee construction of three large scale apartment projects (Alta Dalton, Hammond Creek Township, and the Lofts at Hamilton) which will create 700+ market rate apartments with amenities. In 2024, leasing began on some of these developments
- Commercial endeavors – Several retail projects were under way or complete in 2024 and will help expand the tax digest and sales tax collections. The projects include a new Zaxby's off the North Bypass, as well as the beginning of construction of a U-Haul storage facility, and a new bank location for TVFCU. Chipotle opened up their facility on West Walnut Avenue, and several new retailers (food mostly) are working on their plans for Whitfield County. Based on current plans, we anticipate more growth in the city and county on several fronts.
- Single family housing – Plans for the Hamilton Street Infill development were revealed in 2024, with work on that project slated for 2025. The plans call for approximately 40 homes to be built on a site on South Hamilton located at 902 South Hamilton Street. We anticipate somewhere between \$6-10 million of new residential property in the city as a result of that project.

Both public and private schools in Whitfield County are major contributors to the local economy in the form of employment opportunities and capital investments being made in new and expanded school facilities.

During 2024, the average Whitfield County worker earned roughly \$55,919; a 3.5% wage increase over the prior year. The only counties with a higher annual wage than this are tied to the strong regional economies of Atlanta. As of 2024 however, per capita income (PCI) remained below that of its peers, equaling \$45,299, lower than the statewide amount of \$62,393. There are several likely factors which may explain the gap between Whitfield County's high wages and low per capita income: Per Capita Income (PCI) is calculated based on total population. A relatively large portion of the County's population consists of individuals aged 18 and under who are not yet prime working age.

Long-Term Financial Planning

As is the case with most local governmental entities, the majority of services provided by Whitfield County are funded through an ad valorem tax levied against real and personal property. In the past, the fair market value of real property had served as an excellent basis for funding governmental services since it had proven to be extremely stable and reliable. In terms of the benefits being received from these taxes, there is often said to be a direct relationship between the quality of the services being provided and the fair market value of the property being served.

Whitfield County experienced a steady decline in Net M&O Digest Totals since the downturn in the economy in 2008 through 2012. The county experienced less than a 1% increase in the Net M&O digest in the years 2013 and 2014. In 2015 and 2016 the net digest experienced a 1.89% and .24% decline due to the effects of the elimination of the motor vehicle digest. In an effort to remain competitive with surrounding counties and to attract new business and jobs to the area, the Board of Commissioners voted in 2011 (effective 2012) to expand the Freeport Exemption to 100%. This increased Whitfield County's exemptions on the Gross Digest from approximately \$491 million dollars to \$835 million dollars, costing approximately \$4.7 million dollars in property tax revenue in 2016. In 2017 the county Board of Assessors office performed an urban land uniformity project intended to ensure equitability in land values across the county, and due in part to positive reassessments combined with new construction, a 6% increase in the total net digest occurred.

The County M&O millage rate for 2023 was set in September at 6.00. Due to a rollback of the rate for the portion which represents a positive reassessment county wide, plus an additional amount enacted by the Board of Commissioners, this totaled a reduction of 1.3 mils from the 2022 rate of 7.3. The special tax district millage rate for

2023 was simultaneously set at 3.0410. This rate was reduced from the 2022 rate of 3.438 mills due to the elimination of the Jointly Funded District. This rate is applied to tax bills of only unincorporated county residents as well as residents of all municipalities in the county other than the City of Dalton.

In 2024, the Board of Assessors did a total re-valuation of the County properties. There was controversy regarding what the digest value should be. Until the digest value could be decided, a temporary collection order was issued so that the taxing authorities could collect tax. The millage rate was set at 5.556 mills for the County M&O while the special tax districts millage rate was 3.041 for this temporary collection order. At this time, the final 2024 digest has been approved and the millage rate will be set soon. In accordance with state law, the millage rate is assessed on only 40% of the property valuation. The 2025 digest and millage rate will be approved after the submission of the 2024 final digest to the state.

Local Option Sales Tax (LOST) is one of the County's most significant sources of revenue. This and TAVT receipts provide the vast majority of the County's recurring monthly operating revenue. As required by state law, the County negotiated LOST percentages with the cities within its borders in 2022. The county faces the continuing challenge of providing both necessary and expected services, while balancing reductions of revenue against unwanted millage rate increases.

Whitfield County voters passed a \$48,000,000 special purpose local option sales tax (SPLOST) in 2008 for the main purpose of financing capital outlay projects involving roads, streets, and bridges. The one remaining project involves a realignment of the intersection of Dawnville-Beaverdale Road with Beaverdale road.

On March 17, 2015, voters approved a four year 1% 2015 SPLOST effective July 1, 2015. Approximately \$65 million worth of collections funded various county paving/resurfacing projects, a new public safety communications system, public safety equipment, recreation improvements, and a new county fire department facility.

On June 9, 2020, voters approved a four year 1% 2020 SPLOST effective October 1, 2020. The County collected \$94.6 million to fund various county paving/resurfacing projects, public safety equipment, construction of Riverbend Park and other recreation improvements, and library capital improvements.

On May 21, 2024, the referendum was approved for a new four year 1% SPLOST beginning October 1, 2024. The 2024 SPLOST will fund capital improvements to public safety buildings, public safety vehicles and equipment, park improvements, and capital infrastructure improvements. The expected funding is \$80 million.

Independent Audit

The Georgia Code requires an annual audit of the books of account, financial records, and transactions of all administrative departments of the County by independent certified public accountants selected by the Board of Commissioners. The auditor's unqualified opinion has been included in this report.

Awards

The Government Finance Officers Association (GFOA) awarded a Certificate of Achievement for Excellence in Financial Reporting to Whitfield County for its annual comprehensive financial report for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2023. In order to be awarded the Certificate of Achievement, a government must publish an easily readable and efficiently organized annual comprehensive financial report. This report must satisfy both generally accepted accounting principles and applicable legal requirements.

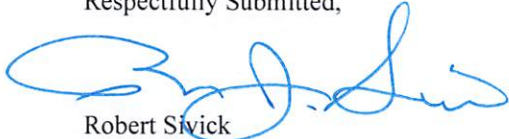
A Certificate of Achievement is valid for a period of one year only. We believe that our current annual comprehensive financial report continues to meet the Certificate of Achievement Program's requirements and we are submitting it to GFOA to determine its eligibility for another certificate.

Acknowledgments

The preparation of this annual comprehensive financial report could not have been accomplished without the dedication and contributions of the entire Finance Department staff and the cooperation of the various elected officials and appointed management. We would also like to express our gratitude and appreciation to the staff of Rushton, LLC, Certified Public Accountants, for their technical guidance and assistance to make this a quality report.

In closing, we also wish to acknowledge the valuable contribution of the Board of Commissioners. Without their guidance and leadership, preparation of this report would not have been possible.

Respectfully Submitted,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "R. Sivick", written over the printed name.

Robert Sivick
County Administrator

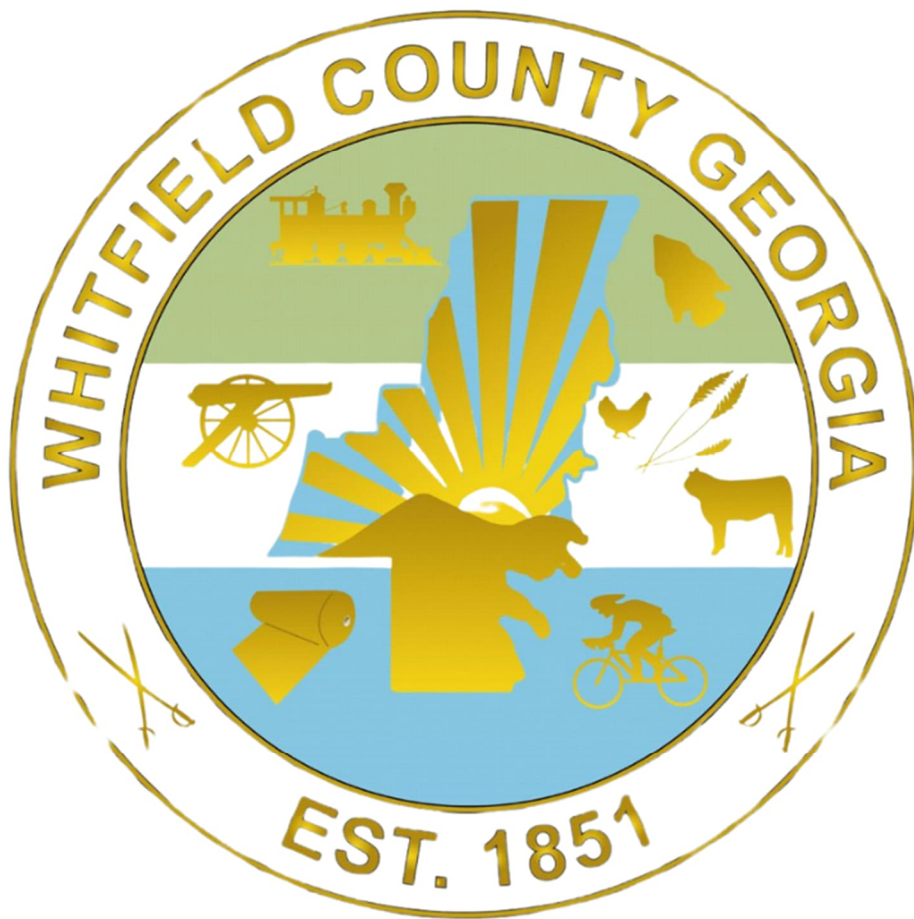
A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Debbie Godfrey", written over the printed name.

Debbie Godfrey
CFO

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Part II

Financial Section



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Independent Auditor's Report

Honorable Chairman and Members
of the Board of Commissioners
Whitfield County, Georgia

Report on the Audit of the Financial Statements

Opinions

We have audited the accompanying financial statements of the governmental activities, the business-type activities, the discretely presented component unit, each major fund, and the aggregate remaining fund information of Whitfield County, Georgia, as of and for the year ended December 31, 2024, and the related notes to the financial statements, which collectively comprise Whitfield County, Georgia's basic financial statements as listed in the table of contents.

In our opinion, based on our audit and the report of the other auditors, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the respective financial position of the governmental activities, the business-type activities, the discretely presented component unit, each major fund, and the aggregate remaining fund information of Whitfield County, Georgia, as of December 31, 2024, and the respective changes in the financial position and, where applicable, cash flows thereof, and the budgetary comparisons of the General Fund, Fire Special Revenue Fund, and American Rescue Plan Act Special Revenue Fund for the year then ended in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

We did not audit the financial statements of Whitfield County Health Department, a discretely presented component unit of Whitfield County, Georgia. Those statements were audited by other auditors whose report has been furnished to us, and our opinion, insofar as it relates to the amounts included for Whitfield County Health Department, is based solely on the reports of the other auditors.

Basis for Opinions

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America and the standards applicable to financial audits contained in *Government Auditing Standards*, issued by the Comptroller General of the United States. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements section of our report. We are required to be independent of Whitfield County, Georgia and to meet our ethical responsibilities, in accordance with the relevant ethical requirements relating to our audit. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinion.

Responsibilities of Management for the Financial Statements

Management is responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America; and for the design, implementation, and maintenance of internal control relevant to the preparation and fair presentation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, management is required to evaluate whether there are conditions or events, considered in the aggregate, that raise substantial doubt about Whitfield County, Georgia's ability to continue as a going concern for twelve months beyond the financial statement date, including any currently known information that may raise substantial doubt shortly thereafter.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinions. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not absolute assurance and therefore is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards and *Government Auditing Standards* will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control. Misstatements are considered material if there is a substantial likelihood that, individually or in the aggregate, they would influence the judgment made by a reasonable user based on the financial statements.

In performing an audit in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards and *Government Auditing Standards*, we:

- Exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism throughout the audit.
- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the financial statements, whether due to fraud or error, and design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks. Such procedures include examining, on a test basis, evidence regarding the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements.
- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control. Accordingly, no such opinion is expressed.
- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of significant accounting estimates made by management, as well as evaluate the overall presentation of the financial statements.
- Conclude whether, in our judgment, there are conditions or events, considered in the aggregate, that raise substantial doubt about Whitfield County, Georgia's ability to continue as a going concern for a reasonable period of time.

We are required to communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit, significant audit findings, and certain internal control-related matters that we identified during the audit.

Required Supplementary Information

Accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America require that the management's discussion and analysis, the Schedule of Changes in the County's Net Position Liability and Related Ratios, the Schedule of Pension Contributions, the Schedule of Changes in Total OPEB Liability and Related Ratios, and the Notes to the Required Supplemental Information, as presented in the table of contents, be presented to supplement the basic financial statements. Such information is the responsibility of management and, although not a part of the basic financial statements, is required by the Governmental Accounting Standards Board who considers it to be an essential part of financial reporting for placing the basic financial statements in an appropriate operational, economic, or historical context. We have applied certain limited procedures to the required supplementary information in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America, which consisted of inquiries of management about the methods of preparing the information and comparing the information for consistency with management's responses to our inquiries, the basic financial statements, and other knowledge we obtained during our audit of the basic financial statements. We do not express an opinion or provide any assurance on the information because the limited procedures do not provide us with sufficient evidence to express an opinion or provide any assurance.

Supplementary Information

Our audit was conducted for the purpose of forming opinions on the financial statements that collectively comprise Whitfield County, Georgia's basic financial statements. The combining and individual fund financial statements and schedules and the schedules of projects financed with special purpose local option sales tax (the "supplementary information"), as listed in the table of contents, are presented for purposes of additional analysis and are not a required part of the basic financial statements. The schedule of expenditures of federal awards is presented for purposes of additional analysis as required by Title 2 U.S. *Code of Federal Regulations* Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards*, and is also not a required part of the basic financial statements. Such information is the responsibility of management and was derived from and relates directly to the underlying accounting and other records used to prepare the basic financial statements. The information has been subjected to the auditing procedures applied in the audit of the basic financial statements and certain additional procedures, including comparing and reconciling such information directly to the underlying accounting and other records used to prepare the basic financial statements or to the basic financial statements themselves, and other additional procedures in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. In our opinion, the supplementary information and the schedule of expenditures of federal awards are fairly stated in all material respects in relation to the financial statements as a whole.

Other Information

Management is responsible for the other information included in the annual report. The other information comprises the introductory and statistical sections but does not include the basic financial statements and our auditor's report thereon. Our opinions on the basic financial statements do not cover the other information, and we do not express an opinion or any form of assurance thereon.

In connection with our audit of the basic financial statements, our responsibility is to read the other information and consider whether a material inconsistency exists between the other information and the basic financial statements, or the other information otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If, based on the work performed, we conclude that an uncorrected material misstatement of the other information exists, we are required to describe it in our report.

Other Reporting Required by Government Auditing Standards

In accordance with *Government Auditing Standards*, we have also issued our report dated June 30, 2025, on our consideration of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over financial reporting and our tests of its compliance with certain provisions of laws, regulations, contracts, grant agreements, and other matters. The purpose of that report is to describe the scope of our testing of internal control over financial reporting and compliance and results of that testing, and not to provide an opinion on the internal control over financial reporting or on compliance. That report is an integral part of an audit performed in accordance with *Government Auditing Standards* in considering Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over financial reporting and compliance.

Rushton, LLC

Gainesville, Georgia
June 30, 2025

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
MANAGEMENT'S DISCUSSION AND ANALYSIS
Year Ended December 31, 2024

Management's Discussion and Analysis of Whitfield County Government's Annual Comprehensive Financial Report (ACFR) provides an overall narrative and analysis of the County's financial statements for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2024. This discussion and analysis are designed to provide insight regarding the County's financial performance as a whole. The reader should also review the information presented here in conjunction with additional information which has been furnished in the financial statements and the notes to the financial statements to gain an enhanced understanding of Whitfield County's financial performance.

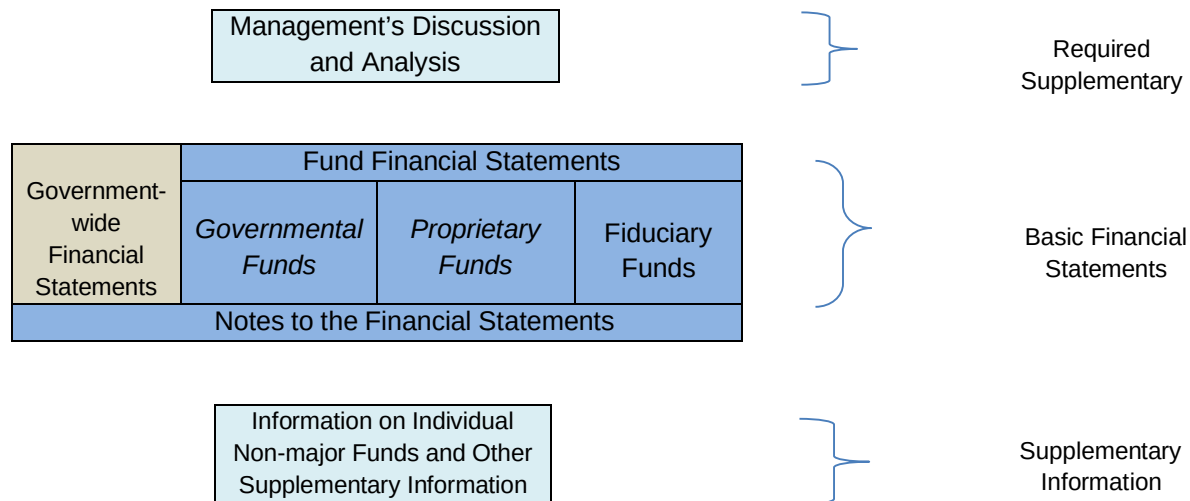
FINANCIAL HIGHLIGHTS

Key financial highlights for 2024 are as follows:

- ◆ The County's combined net position totaled \$267.2 million. Of this amount, \$251.3 million represents governmental activities and \$15.9 million represents business-type activities. This is a decrease of \$1.7 million from the prior year.
- ◆ Total net position is comprised of the following:
 - (1) Net investment of capital assets of \$215.0 million includes property and equipment, net of accumulated depreciation and amortization, and reduced for outstanding debt related to the purchase or construction of capital assets.
 - (2) Net position of \$15.6 million is restricted by constraints imposed from outside the County such as debt covenants, grantors, laws, or regulations.
 - (3) Unrestricted net position of \$36.6 million represents the portion available to maintain the County's continuing obligations to citizens and creditors.
- ◆ Combined revenue totaled \$108.2 million, of which governmental activities totaled \$107.4 million and business-type activities totaled \$0.8 million.
- ◆ Overall expenses totaled \$109.9 million of which governmental activities totaled \$108.0 million and business-type activities totaled \$1.9 million.
- ◆ The County's governmental funds reported a total ending fund balance of \$47.4 million for this year, which is a decrease of \$6.3 million from the prior year.
- ◆ At December 31, 2024, the County's General Fund reported an unassigned fund balance of \$29.5 million.

OVERVIEW OF THE FINANCIAL STATEMENT

This is the twentieth Annual Comprehensive Financial Report (ACFR) Whitfield County has issued under the Governmental Accounting Standards Board (GASB) Statement 34. The following illustration is provided as a guide for the financial statements:



This discussion and analysis are intended to serve as an introduction to Whitfield County's basic financial statements. The basic financial statements include: (1) government-wide financial statements, (2) fund financial statements, and (3) notes to the financial statements. The County also includes in this report additional information to supplement the basic financial statements. Comparative data is presented when available.

Government-wide Financial Statements

The Government-wide financial statements provide a broad view of the County's operations in a manner similar to a private-sector business. The statements provide both short-term and long-term information about the County's financial position, which assists in assessing the economic condition at the end of the fiscal year. These statements are prepared using the flow of economic resources measurement focus and the accrual basis of accounting. This means the statements consider all revenues and expenses connected with the fiscal year even if cash involved has not been received or paid. There are two government-wide financial statements, the Statement of Net Position and the Statement of Activities, which are both described below.

The Statement of Net Position presents information on all the County's assets, deferred outflows of resources, liabilities, and deferred inflows of resources, with residual of all other elements reported as net position. Over time, increases or decreases in net position may serve as a useful indicator of whether the financial position of the County is improving or deteriorating.

The Statement of Activities presents information showing how the County's net position changed during the most recent fiscal year. All changes in net position are reported as soon as the underlying event giving rise to the change occurs, regardless of the timing of related cash flows. This means that revenues and expenses are reported in this statement for some items that will not result in cash flows until future fiscal periods. An example of this would be uncollected taxes and earned but unused paid time off.

Both of the government-wide financial statements distinguish functions of Whitfield County Government that are principally supported by taxes and intergovernmental revenues from other functions that are intended to recover all or a significant portion of their costs through user fees and charges. The governmental activities include general government, judicial, public safety, public works, health and welfare, culture and recreation and housing and development. The business-type activities include the Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center, Whitfield Transit System, and Dalton-Whitfield Solid Waste Management Authority. The government-wide financial statements also include a discretely presented component unit which is the Whitfield County Health Department. Component units are legally separate organizations for which the elected officials of the County are financially accountable.

Fund Financial Statements

A fund is a grouping of related accounts that is used to maintain control over resources that have been segregated for specific activities or objectives. The County, like other state and local governments, uses fund accounting to ensure and demonstrate compliance with finance-related requirements.

The fund financial statements focus on individual parts of the County government, reporting the County's operations in more detail than the government-wide statements. All of the funds of the County can be divided into three categories: governmental funds, proprietary funds and fiduciary funds. It is important to note that these fund categories use different accounting approaches and should be interpreted differently.

- ◆ **Governmental Funds** – Most of the basic services provided by the County are financed through governmental funds. Governmental funds are used to account for essentially the same functions reported as governmental activities in the government-wide financial statements. However, unlike the government-wide statements, the governmental fund financial statements focus on short-term financing requirements. This approach is known as using the flow of current financial resources measurement focus and the modified accrual basis of accounting. These statements provide a detailed short-term view of the County's finances that assists in determining whether there will be adequate financial resources available to meet the County's current needs.

The County maintains four governmental fund types: General Fund, Special Revenue Funds, Debt Service Fund, and the Capital Projects Funds. Information is presented separately in the governmental fund balance sheet and in the governmental fund statement of revenues, expenditures and changes in fund balances for the General Fund, American Rescue Plan Act Fund, SPLOST 2020 Fund, and the Special Fire District Fund, all of which are considered to be major funds. Data from the other governmental funds are combined into a single, aggregated presentation. The basic governmental fund financial statements are presented on pages 21 through 26 of this report.

Individual fund information for non-major governmental funds is found in combining statements in a later section of this report.

- ◆ **Proprietary Funds** – These funds are used to account for activities that operate similar to those commercial enterprises found in the private sector. Because these funds charge fees for services provided to outside customers including local governments, they are known as enterprise funds. Proprietary funds use the accrual basis of accounting, thus there is no reconciliation needed between the government-wide financial statements for business-type activities and the proprietary fund financial statements.

The Whitfield County Transit System is the only proprietary fund operated by the County. Services provided by the two joint ventures to customers include the Dalton-Whitfield Solid Waste Management and the Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center. Internal service funds are an accounting device used to account for services provided and billed on an internal basis. The County utilizes internal service funds for workers' compensation and health insurance. The internal service funds are reported as governmental activities on the basic proprietary fund financial statements which can be found on pages 31 through 33.

- ◆ **Fiduciary Funds** – These funds are used to account for assets held by the County as an agent for individuals, private organizations, other governments and other County departments. The county is responsible for ensuring that the assets reported in these funds are used only for their intended purposes and only by those to whom the assets belong. These funds are not reflected in the government-wide financial statements because the resources are not available to support the County's operations or programs. The accounting used for fiduciary funds is much like that used for proprietary funds. Whitfield County maintains six fiduciary agency funds which include the Clerk of Superior Court, Probate Court, Magistrate Court, Sheriff, Juvenile Court and Tax Commissioner. The statement of fiduciary assets and liabilities for these agency funds can be found on page 34. A combining statement of changes in assets and liabilities for these agency funds can be found in a later section of this report.

Budgetary Comparisons

Whitfield County adopts an annual appropriated budget for the General Fund, Special Revenue Funds, Capital Projects Funds, and Debt Service Funds. Although not required, the County also adopts an annual appropriated budget for the Whitfield Transit System which is a non-major enterprise fund. A budgetary comparison schedule has been provided for the General Fund and can be found on pages 27 through 30. Budget to actual comparisons for other funds are provided in individual schedules elsewhere in this report.

Notes to the Financial Statements

The notes provide additional information that is essential to a full understanding of the data provided in the government-wide and fund financial statements. The notes to the financial statements can be found on pages 36 through 83 of this report.

Other Supplementary Information

In addition to the basic financial statements and accompanying notes, this report also presents certain required supplementary information concerning the County's progress in funding its obligation to provide pension and OPEB benefits to its employees. Required supplementary information can be found on pages 84 through 92 of this report.

GOVERNMENT-WIDE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

As noted earlier, net position may serve over time as a useful indicator of a government's financial position. The County's combined net position (governmental and business-type activities) totaled \$267.2 million as of December 31, 2024.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA STATEMENT OF NET POSITION						
	Governmental Activities		Business Activities		Total	
	2024	2023	2024	2023	2024	2023
Assets:						
Current assets	\$ 65,714,952	\$ 73,575,726	\$ 404,301	\$ 415,452	\$ 66,119,253	\$ 73,991,178
Other assets	1,509,520	1,381,221	15,457,383	16,541,961	16,966,903	17,923,182
Capital assets	216,659,034	219,081,747	62,634	89,104	216,721,668	219,170,851
Total assets	283,883,506	294,038,694	15,924,318	17,046,517	299,807,824	311,085,211
Deferred Outflows of Resources	8,612,054	11,913,586	-	-	8,612,054	11,913,586
Liabilities:						
Current liabilities	11,563,809	23,349,642	41,802	120,843	11,605,611	23,470,485
Non-current liabilities	27,031,482	27,066,076	9,594	7,675	27,041,076	27,073,751
Total liabilities	38,595,291	50,415,718	51,396	128,518	38,646,687	50,544,236
Deferred Inflows of Resources	2,599,442	3,395,433	-	-	2,599,442	3,395,433
Net position:						
Invested in capital assets	214,890,988	209,697,143	62,634	89,104	214,953,622	209,786,247
Restricted	15,631,120	16,763,292	-	-	15,631,120	16,763,292
Unrestricted	20,778,719	25,680,694	15,810,288	16,828,895	36,589,007	42,509,589
Total net position	\$ 251,300,827	\$ 252,141,129	\$ 15,872,922	\$ 16,917,999	\$ 267,173,749	\$ 269,059,128

A large portion of the County's net position reflects its investment in capital assets such as land, buildings, equipment and infrastructure less any related debt used to acquire those assets that is still outstanding. Net investment in capital assets increased by \$5.2 million (2.5%) in 2024.

The County uses these capital assets to provide services to its citizens; therefore, these assets are not available for future spending. Although the County's investment in its capital assets is reported net of related debt, it should be noted that the resources needed to repay this debt must be provided from other sources since the capital assets themselves cannot be used to liquidate these liabilities.

Changes in Net Position

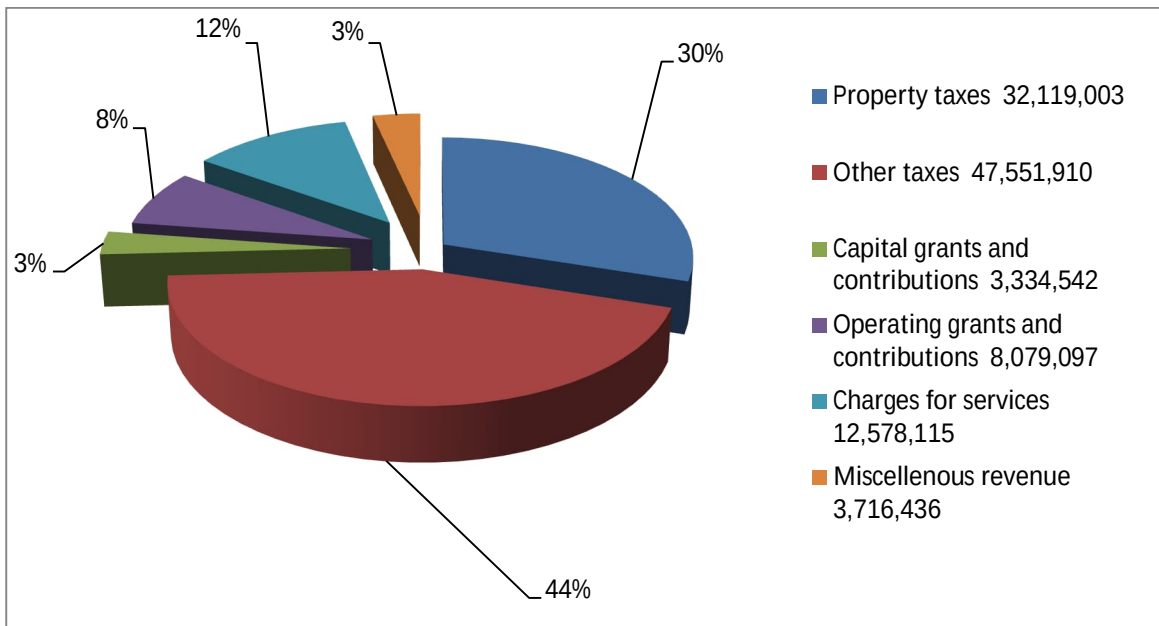
Governmental and business-type activities decreased the County's net position by \$1.7 million in 2024. The following table indicates the changes in net position for governmental and business-type activities in 2024 and 2023.

	Governmental Activities		Business Activities		Total	
	2024	2023	2024	2023	2024	2023
Revenues:						
Program:						
Charges for services	\$ 12,578,115	\$ 10,590,260	\$ 262,551	\$ 318,420	\$ 12,840,666	\$ 10,908,680
Operating grants	8,079,097	13,882,307	563,715	381,075	8,642,812	14,263,382
Capital grants	3,334,542	3,733,255	-	-	3,334,542	3,733,255
General:						
Property taxes	32,119,003	31,725,127	-	-	32,119,003	31,725,127
Sales taxes	40,550,126	41,141,493	-	-	40,550,126	41,141,493
Insurance premium taxes	5,632,927	5,295,852	-	-	5,632,927	5,295,852
Alcoholic beverage taxes	400,551	401,523	-	-	400,551	401,523
Hotel/Motel taxes	178,231	225,585	-	-	178,231	225,585
Miscellaneous taxes	790,075	586,878	-	-	790,075	586,878
Miscellaneous	2,142,634	422,319	-	-	2,142,634	422,319
Gain on disp. of capital assets	165,723	48,907	-	-	165,723	48,907
Investment earnings	1,408,079	1,626,195	-	-	1,408,079	1,626,195
Total revenues	107,379,103	109,679,701	826,266	699,495	108,205,369	110,379,196
Program Expenses:						
General government	15,116,378	11,853,842	-	-	15,116,378	11,853,842
Judicial	9,774,672	9,890,084	-	-	9,774,672	9,890,084
Public safety	45,281,174	44,297,001	-	-	45,281,174	44,297,001
Public works	28,375,351	24,592,195	-	-	28,375,351	24,592,195
Health and welfare	1,270,711	3,841,823	-	-	1,270,711	3,841,823
Culture and recreation	3,960,102	3,898,447	-	-	3,960,102	3,898,447
Housing and development	4,096,847	4,002,331	-	-	4,096,847	4,002,331
Interest on long-term debt	90,957	166,236	-	-	90,957	166,236
Other programs	-	-	1,943,130	3,475,189	1,943,130	3,475,189
Total expenses	107,966,192	102,541,959	1,943,130	3,475,189	109,909,322	106,017,148
Change in net position	(587,089)	7,137,742	(1,116,864)	(2,775,694)	(1,703,953)	4,362,048
Net position -						
beginning of year (original)	252,141,129	245,003,387	16,917,999	19,693,693	269,059,128	264,697,080
Restatements	(253,213)	-	71,787	-	(181,426)	-
Net position -						
beginning of year (restated)	251,887,916	245,003,387	16,989,786	19,693,693	268,877,702	264,697,080
Net position -						
end of year	\$ 251,300,827	\$ 252,141,129	\$ 15,872,922	\$ 16,917,999	\$ 267,173,749	\$ 269,059,128

Governmental Activities

The following chart depicts revenues of the governmental activities for the year ended December 31, 2024.

Revenues by Source – Governmental Activities

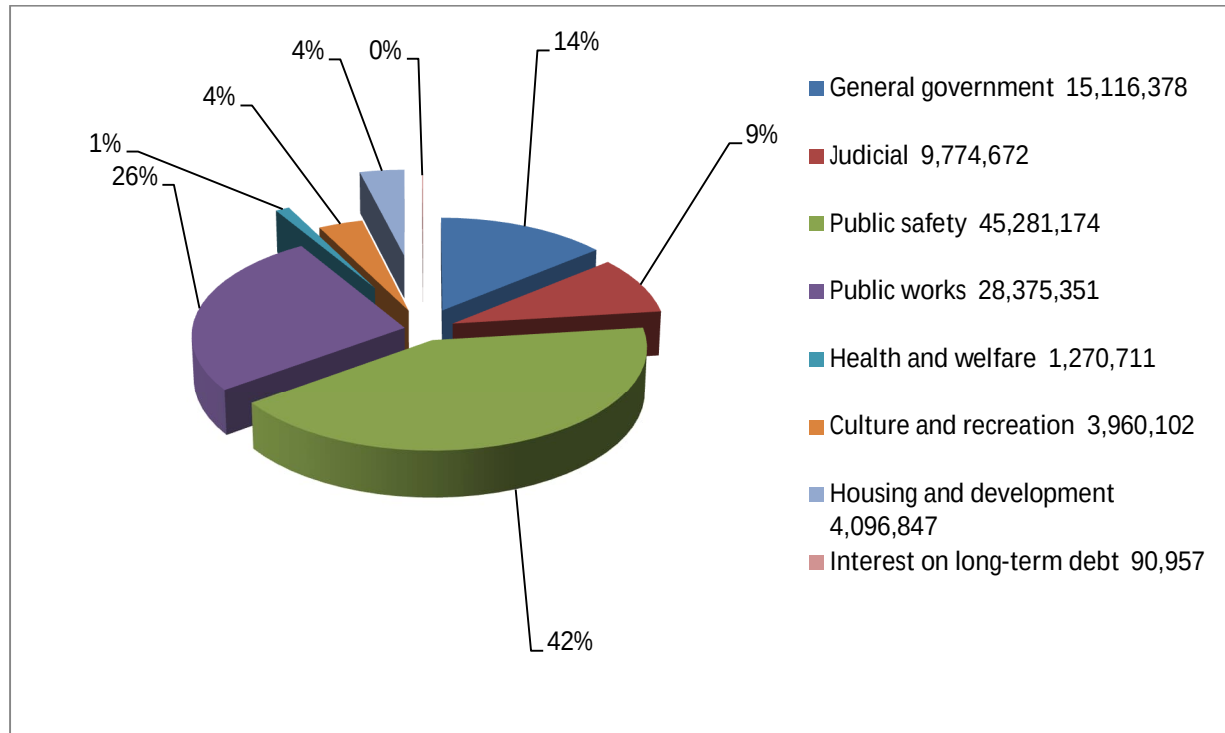


As indicated by the revenue diagram above, property taxes and other taxes were the largest sources for governmental activities. Other taxes include sales tax, insurance premium tax, hotel-motel tax and alcohol beverage tax. The two largest portions of the County's program revenue were shared by Charges for Services and Operating Grants and Contributions, accounting for 11.7% and 7.5% respectively, of total program revenues each. Charges for Services include licenses and permits, fines and forfeitures related to judicial activity, fees for real estate transfers, fees associated with the collection of property taxes and fees charged through various County governmental departments. Operating Grants and Contributions revenues were largely related to American Rescue Plan Act grant revenue for general government and public safety operations.

The County's governmental activities total revenue decreased 2.1%, or \$2.3 million, in 2024. The largest contributing factor to this change was earned revenue related to the American Rescue Plan Act grant in the previous year.

The following chart depicts expenses of the governmental activities for the year ended December 31, 2024.

Expenses by Function – Governmental Activities



As indicated by the expense diagram, the largest uses of County resources were for Public Works and Public Safety services such as Sheriff's Department Enforcement and Corrections divisions, Fire, Coroner, Animal Control and Emergency Management.

The County's governmental activities total expenses increased 5.3%, or \$5.4 million during the year ended December 31, 2024. The majority of the increase is related to market factors on cost such as supply chain concerns and inflation.

The following table presents the cost of each of the County's programs, including the net costs (i.e., total cost less revenues generated by the activities). The net costs illustrate the financial burden placed on the County's taxpayers by each of these functions.

Governmental Activities		
Governmental activities		
	Total cost of services	Net cost of services
General government	\$ 15,116,378	\$ 5,805,943
Judicial	9,774,672	7,374,992
Public safety	45,281,174	41,807,218
Public works	28,375,351	21,444,789
Health and welfare	1,270,711	178,959
Culture and recreation	3,960,102	3,296,139
Housing and development	4,096,847	3,975,441
Interest	90,957	90,957
Total	<u>\$ 107,966,192</u>	<u>\$ 83,974,438</u>

Business-type Activities

The County's business-type activities total revenues increased \$127 thousand, while expenses decreased \$1.5 million for 2024; accordingly, net position for business-type activities decreased 6.2%. The majority of the decrease was related to the losses on the investments in joint ventures in the current year.

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS OF THE GOVERNMENT'S FUNDS

Governmental Funds

Whitfield County uses fund accounting to ensure and demonstrate compliance with finance-related legal requirements. All of the funds of Whitfield County can be divided into three categories: governmental funds, proprietary funds, and fiduciary funds.

The focus of the County's governmental funds is to provide information on short-term inflows, outflows and balances of spendable resources. Such information is useful in assessing the County's financial requirements. In particular, the unassigned fund balance may serve as a useful measure of a government's net resources available for spending at the end of the fiscal year.

The County ended 2024 with strong fund balances in its governmental funds. The combined balance of all governmental funds was \$47.4 million. Of this total, \$26.5 million or 56.0% represented unassigned fund balance, which is available for spending in the coming year. The remainder of fund balance was non-spendable, restricted, committed, or assigned, to indicate that it was not available for new spending because it had already been designated: (1) to liquidate contracts, purchase orders and inventories of the prior period, (2) to pay debt service and (3) for a variety of other restricted purposes.

Major Governmental Funds

General Fund:

The General Fund is the County's primary operating fund and is used to account for all governmental financial resources not restricted by state or federal laws, local ordinances, or other externally imposed requirements. At the end of the current year, unassigned fund balance of the General Fund was \$29.5 million, and the total fund balance was \$30.0 million. As a measure of the General Fund's liquidity, it may be useful to compare both unassigned fund balance and total fund balance to total fund expenditures. Unassigned fund balance represents 48.0% of total General Fund operating expenditures and total fund balance represents 49.0% of the same amount.

The fund balance of the General Fund decreased \$5.3 million in 2024 for a total of \$30.0 million. The Board of Commissioners made a collaborative effort to focus on maintaining the County's excellent financial position. Revenues decreased \$1.7 million (3.0%) while operating expenditures increased \$4.1 million (7.2%). Charges for services decreased mostly due to a decrease in commissions on property tax collections due to the delayed billing of the 2024 digest. Various departmental budget increases related to expected price increases per the consumer price index (CPI), coupled with salary and benefits increases, contributed to the operating expenditures increase.

Special Revenue Funds:

- ◆ The Special Fire District Fund was established in 2013 to account for the funding and expenditures incurred in conjunction with the establishment of a special tax district used to provide adequate and equitable funding of fire protection services to all areas of Whitfield County outside the municipal limits of the City of Dalton. Revenues are derived primarily from property and insurance premium taxes. At the end of 2024, the fund balance was (\$98 thousand), reflecting a \$1.8 million fund balance decrease. Timing of the collection of property tax revenues and payments in lieu of taxes due to billing delays and increased salaries contributed to the fund balance decrease.
- ◆ The American Rescue Plan Act Fund incurred \$2.2 million of eligible expenditures and recognized \$4.6 million in revenues from the grant funding. The County has \$1.8 million of unearned grant funds remaining to expend in this fund.

Capital Projects Funds:

- ◆ Capital Projects SPLOST 2020 Fund is used to account for the acquisition and construction of major capital assets. Revenues are derived from special purpose local option sales taxes. Collections for these funds are restricted for construction and capital outlay. Collections for the 2020 SPLOST began in October 2020, and ended in September 2024. Projects related to the 2020 SPLOST, as well as bond debt service, are funded as taxes are collected and include road, street and bridge projects, sewer extensions, and library capital improvements. At the end of 2024, the 2020 SPLOST fund balance was \$7.6 million.

- ◆ Capital Projects SPLOST 2024 Fund is used to account for the acquisition and construction of major capital assets. Revenues are derived from special purpose local option sales taxes. Collections for these funds are restricted for construction and capital outlay. Collections for the 2024 SPLOST began in October 2024, and will end in September 2028. Projects related to the 2024 SPLOST are funded as taxes are collected and include road, street and bridge projects, sewer extensions, fire station renovations, and park capital improvements. At the end of 2024, the 2024 SPLOST fund balance was \$351 thousand.

Proprietary Funds

The proprietary funds share the same focus as the government-wide statements, reporting both short-term and long-term information about financial status. This provides a perspective similar to that found in the private sector with its basis in accrual accounting and elimination or reclassification of activities between funds.

GENERAL FUND BUDGETARY HIGHLIGHTS

Whitfield County operated under an annual balanced budget (budgeted revenues equal or exceed budgeted expenditures), which is adopted by resolution and administered in accordance with State law. The legal level of control (the level at which expenditures may not legally exceed appropriations) for each legally adopted annual operating budget is at the fund/department level. Over the course of the year, the General fund was amended by the Board of Commissioners.

The most significant expenditure amendments are summarized as follows:

General Government

- ◆ General government had an overall increase of \$986 thousand. Salary and benefit increases, leased office space, and inflationary effects contributed to the increase.

Judicial

- ◆ Judicial budgets increased \$483 thousand due to salary and benefits increases and inflationary effects of the cost of supplies and court costs.

Public Safety

- ◆ Public safety had an overall increase of \$1.2 million mainly due to selective pay increases, greater fuel costs, higher inmate medical costs and the need to budget salary and benefits to actual employment levels. This year Public Safety departments were fully staffed.

Public Works

- ◆ Public works had an overall increase of \$2.0 million mainly due to salary and benefits increases, paving materials and fuel cost increases as a result of inflationary effects.

CAPITAL ASSETS AND DEBT ADMINISTRATION

Capital Assets

The County's investment in capital assets for its governmental and business-type activities as of December 31, 2024 amounts to \$214.9 million (net of accumulated depreciation/amortization and related debt). This investment in capital assets includes land, buildings, improvements, equipment, infrastructure and construction in progress. Infrastructure assets are items that are normally immovable and of value only to the County, such as roads, bridges, streets and sidewalks, drainage systems and other similar items.

Whitfield County's Capital Assets (Net of Depreciation and Amortization)

	Governmental Activities		Business Activities		Total Primary Government	
	2024	2023	2024	2023	2024	2023
Land	\$ 14,230,895	\$ 14,230,895	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 14,230,895	\$ 14,230,895
Construction in progress	6,226,997	6,677,645	-	-	6,226,997	6,677,645
Buildings and land improvements	52,209,548	51,901,057	-	-	52,209,548	51,901,057
Equipment and fixtures	10,381,864	8,872,793	17,575	19,425	10,399,439	8,892,218
Vehicles	4,396,350	4,273,265	45,059	69,679	4,441,409	4,342,944
Right to-Use Subscription Asset	26,176	89,952	-	-	26,176	89,952
Infrastructure	129,187,204	133,018,568	-	-	129,187,204	133,018,568
Total	<u>\$ 216,659,034</u>	<u>\$ 219,064,175</u>	<u>\$ 62,634</u>	<u>\$ 89,104</u>	<u>\$ 216,721,668</u>	<u>\$ 219,153,279</u>

The County's total decrease in capital assets for the current fiscal year was 1.1%.

Governmental assets that were moved from construction in progress to the asset records during the year total approximately \$4.6 million. Completed items include jail, courthouse, and fire station improvements as well as several major road projects designed to increase drivability and safety. These were primarily SPLOST expenditures. See Note 8 for more detailed information on capital asset activity.

Long-term Debt

As of December 31, 2024, Whitfield County's revenue bonds and notes payable totaled \$861 thousand. This is a decrease of \$7.4 million from the prior year. See Notes 10 and 11 for additional information on Whitfield County's long-term debt.

	Governmental Activities	
	2024	2023
Notes payable	\$ 305,187	\$ 354,818
Subscription payable	-	77,192
Intergovernmental liability	-	6,715,000
Revenue bonds	556,000	1,095,000
Total	<u>\$ 861,187</u>	<u>\$ 8,242,010</u>

ECONOMIC FACTORS AND NEXT YEAR'S BUDGET

As of December 2024, Whitfield County's unemployment rate was 4.2%, slightly higher than the prior year. The local and regional economies have struggled to fill positions as the industry and service sectors seek to fulfill demand since the exit of the pandemic era began. Under normal economic circumstances, the Board of Commissioners, along with the Joint Development Authority and municipalities, recognizes the need for a more diversified local economy and the need to recruit new businesses to the area. The Dalton-Whitfield County Joint Development Authority's economic development mission is to facilitate the long-term, positive economic growth of the community by attracting jobs, diverse investments, and growing the tax base. These efforts led to the capital investment of \$130 million to construct the world's largest solar cell manufacturing facility in the County's southern-located industrial park, Carbondale Business Park, along the I-75 corridor. This facility opened their expansion facility within the park which represents \$379 million of new investment and the creation of 978 new jobs for the community. Essentia Protein Solutions, a global producer of animal protein solutions for the food and beverage industry, completed their facility construction in 2024. This is an \$80 million investment and will create 80 new jobs.

The County's assessed net taxable digest increased by 30.6% in 2024 to \$4.569 billion. Total exemptions on the gross digest were \$1.5 billion. The 2023 millage rate of 6.0 will be reduced by the Board of Commissioners to the rollback rate to be set in July 2025 due to a delay in the calculation of the final 2024 digest. The Whitfield County Board of Commissioners created special tax districts to include all areas of Whitfield County outside the municipal limits of the City of Dalton for the purpose of providing adequate and equitable funding of certain jointly funded services between Whitfield County and the City of Dalton for the benefit of all such areas. For 2024, the millage rate was 2.755 for the Fire district and .2860 for the Solid Waste authority.

The County entered into LOST negotiations as required by state law with the City of Dalton and the other cities located within the county's borders in 2022. As a result of these negotiations the County's percentage of LOST collections will remain unchanged, which constitutes a 22.8% reduction since the beginning of the prior agreement in 2012. Understandably, County leadership has been challenged to continuously provide the same level of services which have come to be expected by the citizenry with this sustained downward trend of reduced revenue. Sales tax collections remained flat from 2023 to 2024. TAVT collections began

in the County in March 2013. Actual TAVT collections for 2024 were \$5.6 million which was an increase of 7% over 2023.

Voters passed a 1 penny sales tax in May of 2024 which raised the sales tax rate from 6% to 7% effective October 1, 2024. This one penny SPLOST is expected to raise approximately \$80 million dollars and will be used to fund public safety equipment enhancements for local law enforcement, fire, road paving and improvements, bridge and culvert repair, construction of a new community center, and other park improvements.

Other factors considered when preparing the 2025 budget include:

- ◆ A flat millage rate for 2025 for M&O and the special tax districts was assumed; however, economic factors may dictate a higher rate.
- ◆ OBEP costs will be funded on the pay-as-you-go basis.
- ◆ No defined benefit pension contributions have been budgeted for in 2025. However, it is the policy of the Board to keep the plan at a 100% funded level.
- ◆ Based upon estimates from the insurance broker and the decision of the BOC, a flat rate of \$12,350 was applied to each full-time employee in allocating health insurance expense to departments.
- ◆ Extremely limited capital requests were considered in the 2025 general fund budget, as other large capital needs are expected to be acquired via the 2020 SPLOST and 2024 SPLOST.
- ◆ The County continues to evaluate the level of services desired by citizens and how to provide those services as economically as possible. Based on demographic considerations, demands for all types of public safety, courts, and general services are expected to continue at 2024 levels.
- ◆ The 2025 budget includes 3.5% pay raises for most full-time County employees.
- ◆ Departmental operating budgets will be held to prior year levels except where sufficient justification is provided.
- ◆ Due to the 2020 SPLOST and 2024 SPLOST, which includes paving and various other road projects, paving was not included in the 2025 general fund budget.

Robust economic conditions coupled with prudent fiscal management resulted in the County's not needing a tax anticipation note (TAN) to help fund operations during 2024. Again for 2025, no TAN is anticipated. Cash flow projections are constantly updated through the year. Should forecasts indicate the need for short-term borrowing, the County has procedures for quickly obtaining such funding.

REQUEST FOR INFORMATION

This financial report is designed to provide a general overview of Whitfield County finances, comply with finance-related laws and regulations, and demonstrate the County's commitment to public accountability. If you have questions about this report or would like to request additional information, contact:

Whitfield County Finance Department
201 S. Hamilton Street, Fourth Floor
Dalton, Georgia 30720
Telephone: 706-275-7500
Website: www.whitfieldcountyga.com

BASIC FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
December 31, 2024

	Primary Government			Component Unit
	Governmental Activities	Business-type Activities	Total	Whitfield County Health Department
ASSETS				
Current assets				
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 35,547,830	\$ 159,728	\$ 35,707,558	\$ 5,753,862
Receivables (net)				
Accounts	2,234,582	51,743	2,286,325	268
Intergovernmental	2,513,867	192,830	2,706,697	322,101
Taxes	21,627,739	0	21,627,739	0
Inventories	0	0	0	769
Restricted cash and cash equivalents	31,412	0	31,412	0
Prepaid items	3,759,522	0	3,759,522	350
Total current assets	65,714,952	404,301	66,119,253	6,077,350
Noncurrent assets				
Capital assets				
Non-depreciable capital assets	20,457,892	0	20,457,892	0
Depreciable/amortizable capital assets (net)	196,201,142	62,634	196,263,776	117,647
Investment in joint venture	1,509,520	15,457,383	16,966,903	0
Proportionate share of OPEB asset	0	0	0	262,279
Total noncurrent assets	218,168,554	15,520,017	233,688,571	379,926
Total assets	283,883,506	15,924,318	299,807,824	6,457,276
DEFERRED OUTFLOWS OF RESOURCES				
Deferred outflows of resources - pension	4,745,864	0	4,745,864	778,448
Deferred outflows of resources - OPEB	3,866,190	0	3,866,190	385,917
Total deferred outflows of resources	8,612,054	0	8,612,054	1,164,365
LIABILITIES				
Current liabilities				
Payables:				
Accounts	2,658,534	1,540	2,660,074	27,579
Retainages	110,417	0	110,417	0
Intergovernmental	2,562,395	0	2,562,395	0
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	1,168,623	5,487	1,174,110	0
Compensated absences	1,776,947	22,386	1,799,333	89,631
Unearned revenue	1,915,287	12,389	1,927,676	0
Claims payable	519,837	0	519,837	0
Total OPEB liability	245,790	0	245,790	0
Notes payable	49,979	0	49,979	0
Bonds payable	556,000	0	556,000	0
Total current liabilities	11,563,809	41,802	11,605,611	117,210

See accompanying notes to the financial statements.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
December 31, 2024

	Primary Government			Component Unit
	Governmental Activities	Business-type Activities	Total	Whitfield County Health Department
Noncurrent liabilities				
Net pension liability	\$ 14,800,416	\$ 0	\$ 14,800,416	\$ 0
Total OPEB liability	11,214,310	0	11,214,310	0
Proportionate share of net pension liability	0	0	0	3,408,857
Proportionate share of OPEB liability	0	0	0	156,055
Compensated absences	761,548	9,594	771,142	59,754
Notes payable	255,208	0	255,208	0
Total noncurrent liabilities	27,031,482	9,594	27,041,076	3,624,666
Total liabilities	38,595,291	51,396	38,646,687	3,741,876
DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES				
Deferred inflows of resources - pension	17,542	0	17,542	653,894
Deferred inflows of resources - OPEB	2,581,900	0	2,581,900	338,526
Total deferred inflows of resources	2,599,442	0	2,599,442	992,420
NET POSITION				
Net investment in capital assets	214,890,988	62,634	214,953,622	117,647
Restricted for:				
Judicial	2,134,606	0	2,134,606	0
Public Safety	2,681,492	0	2,681,492	0
Housing and Development	81,456	0	81,456	0
Grant Specifications	266,901	0	266,901	0
Capital Outlay	10,464,137	0	10,464,137	0
Debt Service	2,528	0	2,528	0
Program income	0	0	0	137,008
OPEB related items	0	0	0	262,279
Unrestricted	20,778,719	15,810,288	36,589,007	2,370,411
Total net position	\$ 251,300,827	\$ 15,872,922	\$ 267,173,749	\$ 2,887,345

		Program Revenues			
			Operating	Capital	Net
		Charges for	Grants and	Grants and	(Expense)
	Expenses	Services	Contributions	Contributions	Revenue
FUNCTIONS/PROGRAMS					
Primary government					
Governmental activities					
General Government	\$ 15,116,378	\$ 5,474,980	\$ 3,809,259	\$ 26,196	\$ (5,805,943)
Judicial	9,774,672	1,990,283	409,397	0	(7,374,992)
Public Safety	45,281,174	3,409,632	4,212	60,112	(41,807,218)
Public Works	28,375,351	1,194,489	2,607,135	3,128,938	(21,444,789)
Health and Welfare	1,270,711	44,801	1,046,951	0	(178,959)
Culture and Recreation	3,960,102	446,545	98,122	119,296	(3,296,139)
Housing and Development	4,096,847	17,385	104,021	0	(3,975,441)
Interest on long-term debt	90,957	0	0	0	(90,957)
Total governmental activities	107,966,192	12,578,115	8,079,097	3,334,542	(83,974,438)
Business-type activities					
Dalton/Whitfield Solid Waste Management	1,008,535	0	0	0	(1,008,535)
Northwest GA Trade and Convention Center	76,043	0	0	0	(76,043)
Whitfield Transit System	858,552	262,551	563,715	0	(32,286)
Total business-type activities	1,943,130	262,551	563,715	0	(1,116,864)
Total primary government	109,909,322	12,840,666	8,642,812	3,334,542	(85,091,302)
Component units					
Whitfield County Health Department	3,801,452	1,760,950	2,988,185	0	947,683
Primary Government					
	Governmental Activities	Business-Type Activities	Total	Component Units	
Change in net position					
Net (expense) revenue	\$ (83,974,438)	\$ (1,116,864)	\$ (85,091,302)	\$ 947,683	
General revenues					
Taxes					
Property	32,119,003	0	32,119,003	0	
Sales	40,550,126	0	40,550,126	0	
Insurance premium	5,632,927	0	5,632,927	0	
Occupational	145,667	0	145,667	0	
Franchise	382,239	0	382,239	0	
Intangible	74,489	0	74,489	0	
Alcohol excise	400,551	0	400,551	0	
Hotel/Motel	178,231	0	178,231	0	
Energy excise	186,365	0	186,365	0	
Other	1,315	0	1,315	0	
Interest and investment earnings	1,408,079	0	1,408,079	15,331	
Gain on sale of assets	165,723	0	165,723	0	
Change in investment in joint venture	159,711	0	159,711	0	
Other	1,982,923	0	1,982,923	0	
Total general revenues	83,387,349	0	83,387,349	15,331	
Change in net position	(587,089)	(1,116,864)	(1,703,953)	963,014	
Net position - beginning, as previously stated	252,141,129	16,917,999	269,059,128	1,924,331	
Error correction	124,880	72,869	197,749	0	
Change in accounting principle	(378,093)	(1,082)	(379,175)	0	
Net position - beginning, as restated	251,887,916	16,989,786	268,877,702	1,924,331	
Net position - ending	\$ 251,300,827	\$ 15,872,922	\$ 267,173,749	\$ 2,887,345	

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
BALANCE SHEET
GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
December 31, 2024

	General	Special Fire District	American Rescue Plan Act
ASSETS			
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 8,118,695	\$ 768,145	\$ 3,394,258
Receivables (net)			
Accounts	59,202	0	0
Intergovernmental	912,816	184,019	122,102
Taxes	15,100,992	3,763,439	0
Due from other funds	10,862,993	0	0
Restricted cash and cash equivalents	0	0	0
Prepaid items	560,010	0	0
Total assets	\$ 35,614,708	\$ 4,715,603	\$ 3,516,360
LIABILITIES			
Accounts payable	\$ 1,114,158	\$ 40,092	\$ 66,692
Retainage payable	0	0	0
Intergovernmental payables	739	0	0
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	1,026,014	101,641	9,849
Due to other funds	0	3,688,885	1,331,981
Unearned revenue	74,350	0	1,840,937
Total liabilities	2,215,261	3,830,618	3,249,459
DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES			
Unavailable revenue:			
Property taxes	3,376,961	982,770	0
Fines and forfeitures	0	0	0
Total deferred inflows of resources	3,376,961	982,770	0
FUND BALANCES			
Nonspendable prepaid items	560,010	0	0
Restricted			
Judicial	0	0	0
Public safety	0	0	0
Housing and development	0	0	0
Grant specifications	0	0	266,901
Capital outlay	0	0	0
Debt service	0	0	0
Committed			
Capital outlay	0	0	0
Assigned			
Public works	0	0	0
Culture and recreation	0	0	0
Unassigned	29,462,476	(97,785)	0
Total fund balances	30,022,486	(97,785)	266,901
Total liabilities, deferred inflows of resources, and fund balances	\$ 35,614,708	\$ 4,715,603	\$ 3,516,360

2020 SPLOST	2024 SPLOST	Nonmajor Governmental Funds	Totals
\$ 8,588,970	\$ 2,479,199	\$ 9,230,713	\$ 32,579,980
0	0	2,001,235	2,060,437
0	0	1,294,930	2,513,867
0	2,365,306	398,002	21,627,739
0	0	0	10,862,993
0	0	31,412	31,412
0	3,199,512	0	3,759,522
<u>\$ 8,588,970</u>	<u>\$ 8,044,017</u>	<u>\$ 12,956,292</u>	<u>\$ 73,435,950</u>
\$ 701,425	\$ 50,095	\$ 333,326	\$ 2,305,788
110,417	0	0	110,417
0	2,561,656	0	2,562,395
0	0	31,119	1,168,623
140,076	5,080,955	621,096	10,862,993
0	0	0	1,915,287
<u>951,918</u>	<u>7,692,706</u>	<u>985,541</u>	<u>18,925,503</u>
0	0	1,128,878	5,488,609
0	0	1,648,731	1,648,731
0	0	2,777,609	7,137,340
0	3,199,512	0	3,759,522
0	0	2,134,606	2,134,606
0	0	1,032,761	1,032,761
0	0	81,456	81,456
0	0	0	266,901
7,637,052	0	1,951,638	9,588,690
0	0	2,528	2,528
0	0	3,603,881	3,603,881
0	0	169,860	169,860
0	0	216,412	216,412
0	(2,848,201)	0	26,516,490
<u>7,637,052</u>	<u>351,311</u>	<u>9,193,142</u>	<u>47,373,107</u>
<u>\$ 8,588,970</u>	<u>\$ 8,044,017</u>	<u>\$ 12,956,292</u>	<u>\$ 73,435,950</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
RECONCILIATION OF THE BALANCE SHEET OF
GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS TO THE
STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
December 31, 2024

Total fund balances - total governmental funds **\$ 47,373,107**

Amounts reported for governmental activities in the statement of net position are different because:

Some assets are not financial resources and therefore are not reported in the funds. These are:

Capital assets, net of accumulated depreciation/amortization	\$ 216,659,034	
Investment in joint venture	<u>1,509,520</u>	218,168,554

Revenues in the statement of activities that do not provide current financial resources are reported as deferred inflows of resources in the funds. These are:

Property taxes	\$ 5,488,609	
Fines and forfeitures	<u>1,648,731</u>	7,137,340

Deferred outflows and inflows of resources are applicable to future periods and, therefore, are not reported in the funds. These are:

Deferred outflows of resources:		
Pension	\$ 4,745,864	
OPEB	3,866,190	
Deferred inflows of resources:		
Pension	(17,542)	
OPEB	<u>(2,581,900)</u>	6,012,612

Internal service funds are used by management to charge the costs of certain activities, such as risk management and employee benefits to individual funds. Assets and liabilities of the internal service funds are included in governmental activities in the statement of net position.

Internal service funds net position		2,269,412
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Some liabilities are not due and payable in the current period and therefore are not reported in the funds. These are:

Net pension liability	\$ (14,800,416)	
OPEB liability	(11,460,100)	
Compensated absences	(2,538,495)	
Notes payable	(305,187)	
Bonds payable	<u>(556,000)</u>	<u>(29,660,198)</u>

Net position of governmental activities		<u><u>\$ 251,300,827</u></u>
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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF REVENUES,
EXPENDITURES, AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>General</u>	<u>Special Fire District</u>	<u>American Rescue Plan Act</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 41,273,517	\$ 10,942,711	\$ 0
Licenses and permits	936,067	0	0
Fines, fees and forfeitures	979,690	0	0
Charges for services	3,222,699	0	0
Intergovernmental	6,509,477	0	4,246,292
Interest	1,015,952	0	380,811
Contributions	62,769	4,212	0
Other	1,878,328	5,408	0
Total revenues	<u>55,878,499</u>	<u>10,952,331</u>	<u>4,627,103</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
General Government	11,868,971	0	79,154
Judicial	8,223,546	0	338,478
Public Safety	24,459,845	12,756,583	632,452
Public Works	9,358,499	0	946,880
Health and Welfare	419,295	0	15,176
Culture and Recreation	3,035,606	0	140,441
Housing and Development	3,319,304	0	66,998
Capital outlay	0	20,091	0
Debt service	643,046	0	0
Intergovernmental	0	0	0
Total expenditures	<u>61,328,112</u>	<u>12,776,674</u>	<u>2,219,579</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	<u>(5,449,613)</u>	<u>(1,824,343)</u>	<u>2,407,524</u>
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in	2,219,249	0	0
Transfers out	(2,247,426)	0	(2,276,537)
Sale of capital assets	165,723	0	0
Total other financing sources (uses)	<u>137,546</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>(2,276,537)</u>
Net change in fund balance	<u>(5,312,067)</u>	<u>(1,824,343)</u>	<u>130,987</u>
Fund balances, January 1, as previously stated	35,334,553	1,726,558	135,914
Error correction	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1, as restated	<u>35,334,553</u>	<u>1,726,558</u>	<u>135,914</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 30,022,486</u></u>	<u><u>\$ (97,785)</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 266,901</u></u>

2020 SPLOST	2024 SPLOST	Nonmajor Governmental Funds	Totals
\$ 18,808,697	\$ 6,540,268	\$ 741,700	\$ 78,306,893
0	0	0	936,067
0	0	730,913	1,710,603
0	0	2,212,747	5,435,446
0	0	1,231,573	11,987,342
295,933	2,075	78,070	1,772,841
0	0	409,397	476,378
0	0	99,187	1,982,923
19,104,630	6,542,343	5,503,587	102,608,493
0	0	0	11,948,125
0	0	760,353	9,322,377
0	0	3,249,963	41,098,843
0	0	521,599	10,826,978
0	0	211,517	645,988
0	0	0	3,176,047
0	0	580,135	3,966,437
8,218,754	1,931,539	1,964,345	12,134,729
6,776,778	0	51,956	7,471,780
4,221,983	4,259,493	0	8,481,476
19,217,515	6,191,032	7,339,868	109,072,780
(112,885)	351,311	(1,836,281)	(6,464,287)
0	0	2,363,787	4,583,036
0	0	(59,073)	(4,583,036)
0	0	0	165,723
0	0	2,304,714	165,723
(112,885)	351,311	468,433	(6,298,564)
8,552,042	0	8,724,709	54,473,776
(802,105)	0	0	(802,105)
7,749,937	0	8,724,709	53,671,671
\$ 7,637,052	\$ 351,311	\$ 9,193,142	\$ 47,373,107

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
RECONCILIATION OF THE STATEMENT OF
REVENUES, EXPENDITURES, AND CHANGES IN
FUND BALANCES OF GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
TO THE STATEMENT OF ACTIVITIES
For the year ended December 31, 2024

Net change in fund balances - total governmental funds \$ (6,298,564)

Amounts reported for governmental activities in the statement of activities are different because:

Governmental funds report capital outlays as expenditures. However, in the statement of activities, the cost of those assets is allocated over their estimated useful lives and reported as depreciation/amortization expense.

Capital outlays	\$ 8,075,908	
Depreciation/amortization	<u>(10,403,666)</u>	(2,327,758)

In the statement of activities, the gain/loss on the disposal of assets is reported, whereas in the governmental funds, the proceeds from the sale of capital assets increases financial resources.

Cost of assets disposed	\$ (1,504,632)	
Related accumulated depreciation	<u>1,427,249</u>	(77,383)

Governmental funds report pension contributions as expenditures. However, in the statement of activities, the cost of pension benefits earned net of employee contributions is reported as pension expense.

Cost of benefits earned net of employee contributions	(3,179,235)
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Governmental funds report OPEB contributions as expenditures. However, in the statement of activities, the cost of OPEB benefits earned net of employee contributions is reported as OPEB expense.

OPEB contributions	\$ 245,790	
Cost of benefits earned net of employee contributions	<u>(827,684)</u>	(581,894)

The proceeds of debt issuance, net of premiums, discounts and issuance costs provide current financial resources to governmental funds, but issuing debt increases long-term liabilities in the statement of net position. Repayment of debt principal is an expenditure in the governmental funds, but the repayment reduces long-term liabilities in the statement of net position. In addition, interest on long-term debt is not recognized in the governmental funds until due, but is recognized in the statement of activities as it accrues.

Debt principal payments	7,380,823
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Revenues in the statement of activities that do not provide current financial resources are not reported as revenues in the funds.

Unavailable revenue:		
Property taxes	\$ 3,109,479	
Fines and forfeitures	<u>704,174</u>	3,813,653

The change in the value of the government's investment in a joint venture is not recognized in the governmental funds because it does not involve current financial resources. However, in the statement of activities, the change in the value of the County's share of the net position of the joint venture is included as a net increase (decrease) in net position.

Change in investment in joint venture:	159,711
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Internal service funds are used by management to charge the costs of certain activities, such as risk management and employee benefits to individual funds. Assets and liabilities of the internal service funds are included in governmental activities in the statement of net position.

Change in net position of internal service funds:	631,546
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Some expenses reported in the statement of activities do not require the use of current financial resources and are not reported as expenditures in governmental funds.

Compensated absences	<u>(107,988)</u>
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Change in net position of governmental activities	<u><u>\$ (587,089)</u></u>
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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
GENERAL FUND
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Budget		Actual	Variance with Final Budget
	Original	Final		
REVENUES				
Taxes	\$ 42,406,816	\$ 44,588,102	\$ 41,273,517	\$ (3,314,585)
Licenses and permits	926,300	935,593	936,067	474
Fines, fees and forfeitures	996,000	979,689	979,690	1
Charges for services	3,289,726	3,217,637	3,222,699	5,062
Intergovernmental	6,681,665	6,265,430	6,509,477	244,047
Interest	1,300,000	1,015,952	1,015,952	0
Contributions	10,000	62,770	62,769	(1)
Other	1,488,200	1,837,473	1,878,328	40,855
Total revenues	57,098,707	58,902,646	55,878,499	(3,024,147)
EXPENDITURES				
Current				
General Government				
Administration	878,739	1,548,750	1,548,107	643
Board of Elections	689,989	700,104	663,652	36,452
Finance	754,646	727,840	726,659	1,181
Information Technology	1,018,857	1,030,585	1,030,526	59
Human Resources	498,180	552,272	510,033	42,239
Tax Commissioner	2,029,826	2,076,356	2,031,436	44,920
Tax Assessor	2,273,596	2,364,557	1,958,581	405,976
Board of Equalization	19,581	20,017	20,018	(1)
Building and Grounds	2,095,283	2,131,698	2,083,868	47,830
Public Information	103,143	132,624	132,063	561
Attorney Fees	144,554	188,694	188,694	0
Liability Insurance	839,244	842,918	842,918	0
Audit Fees	56,872	72,472	72,472	0
Other	66,908	66,908	59,944	6,964
Judicial				
Judicial Administration	743,959	773,759	772,534	1,225
Judge Morris' Office	51,919	71,528	70,982	546
Judge Boyett's Office	51,919	64,096	63,068	1,028
Judge Willbank's Office	55,419	66,737	66,378	359
Judge Minter's Office	55,419	71,598	70,817	781
Clerk of Superior Court	1,121,660	1,152,006	1,114,350	37,656
District Attorney	1,356,419	1,448,192	1,446,497	1,695
Magistrate Court	1,263,907	1,315,235	1,312,024	3,211
Probate Court	706,461	722,645	702,721	19,924
Juvenile Court	1,299,932	1,326,232	1,274,486	51,746
Public Defender	1,152,871	1,330,985	1,329,689	1,296
Public Safety				
Sheriff's Department	10,100,581	10,513,410	10,513,057	353
Correctional Center	12,079,133	12,774,378	12,773,535	843
Coroner	129,658	129,658	120,573	9,085
Animal Control	323,249	358,979	358,041	938
Emergency Management	427,357	444,983	444,639	344
Emergency Medical Services	250,000	250,000	250,000	0
Public Works				
Public Works	8,003,119	10,007,896	9,358,499	649,397
Health and Welfare				
Physical and Mental Health	255,000	257,661	257,661	0
Family Support Council	64,800	64,800	64,800	0
Family and Children Services	80,000	80,000	80,000	0
Department of Veterans Service	984	984	984	0
Pauper Fund	10,000	15,850	15,850	0
Culture and Recreation				
Parks and Recreation	2,354,363	2,526,947	2,495,034	31,913
Senior Center	542,832	552,944	540,572	12,372

See accompanying notes to the financial statements.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
GENERAL FUND
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Budget		Actual	Variance with Final Budget
	Original	Final		
EXPENDITURES (continued)				
Current				
Housing and Development				
County Extension Service	\$ 172,409	\$ 172,995	\$ 143,760	\$ 29,235
Inspections and Enforcement	589,161	614,520	539,968	74,552
County Planner	48,000	48,000	48,000	0
Metropolitan Planning Organization	535,353	537,376	192,295	345,081
County Engineer	814,193	830,378	771,723	58,655
Timber Protection	7,875	7,875	7,766	109
Community Development	203,930	213,598	211,785	1,813
Intergovernmental payments	1,407,370	1,433,607	1,404,007	29,600
Debt service				
Principal	563,682	616,193	616,192	1
Interest	0	26,854	26,854	0
Total expenditures	58,292,352	63,278,694	61,328,112	1,950,582
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over expenditures	(1,193,645)	(4,376,048)	(5,449,613)	(1,073,565)
Other financing sources (uses)				
Transfers in	1,930,000	2,219,249	2,219,249	0
Transfers out	(1,605,293)	(2,247,425)	(2,247,426)	(1)
Sale of capital assets	0	180,991	165,723	(15,268)
Total other financing sources (uses)	324,707	152,815	137,546	(15,269)
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	(868,938)	(4,223,233)	(5,312,067)	(1,088,834)
Fund balances, January 1	868,938	4,223,233	35,334,553	31,111,320
Fund balances, December 31	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 30,022,486	\$ 30,022,486

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SPECIAL FIRE DISTRICT SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Budget			Variance with
	Original	Final	Actual	Final Budget
REVENUES				
Taxes	\$ 10,662,754	\$ 11,462,759	\$ 10,942,711	\$ (520,048)
Intergovernmental	0	0	0	0
Contributions	0	4,212	4,212	0
Other	294,000	5,408	5,408	0
Total revenues	10,956,754	11,472,379	10,952,331	(520,048)
EXPENDITURES				
Current				
Public Safety	12,672,185	12,756,585	12,756,583	2
Capital outlay	0	20,091	20,091	0
Total expenditures	12,672,185	12,776,676	12,776,674	2
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over expenditures	(1,715,431)	(1,304,297)	(1,824,343)	(520,046)
Fund balances, January 1	1,715,431	1,304,297	1,726,558	422,261
Fund balances, December 31	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ (97,785)	\$ (97,785)

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
AMERICAN RESCUE PLAN ACT SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Budget			Variance with
	Original	Final	Actual	Final Budget
REVENUES				
Intergovernmental	\$ 9,126,130	\$ 4,246,292	\$ 4,246,292	\$ 0
Interest	175,000	249,827	380,811	130,984
Total revenues	<u>9,301,130</u>	<u>4,496,119</u>	<u>4,627,103</u>	<u>130,984</u>
EXPENDITURES				
Current				
General Government	0	79,154	79,154	0
Judicial	0	338,478	338,478	0
Public Safety	0	632,454	632,452	2
Public Works	0	946,880	946,880	0
Health and Welfare	0	15,176	15,176	0
Culture and Recreation	0	140,441	140,441	0
Housing and Development	0	66,998	66,998	0
Total expenditures	<u>0</u>	<u>2,219,581</u>	<u>2,219,579</u>	<u>2</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over expenditures	9,301,130	2,276,538	2,407,524	130,986
Other financing sources (uses)				
Transfers out	<u>0</u>	<u>(2,276,538)</u>	<u>(2,276,537)</u>	<u>1</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	9,301,130	0	130,987	130,987
Fund balances, January 1	<u>(9,301,130)</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>135,914</u>	<u>135,914</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 266,901</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 266,901</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
PROPRIETARY FUNDS
December 31, 2024

	Business-Type Activities				
	Dalton Whitfield Solid Waste Management	Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	Whitfield Transit System	Totals	Internal Service Funds
ASSETS					
Current assets					
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 159,728	\$ 159,728	\$ 2,967,850
Receivables (net)					
Accounts	0	0	51,743	51,743	174,145
Intergovernmental	0	0	192,830	192,830	0
Total current assets	0	0	404,301	404,301	3,141,995
Noncurrent assets					
Depreciable capital assets (net)	0	0	62,634	62,634	0
Investment in joint venture	12,371,654	3,085,729	0	15,457,383	0
Total noncurrent assets	12,371,654	3,085,729	62,634	15,520,017	0
Total assets	12,371,654	3,085,729	466,935	15,924,318	3,141,995
LIABILITIES					
Current liabilities					
Accounts payable	0	0	1,540	1,540	352,746
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	0	0	5,487	5,487	0
Compensated absences	0	0	22,386	22,386	0
Unearned revenue	0	0	12,389	12,389	0
Claims reserve	0	0	0	0	519,837
Total current liabilities	0	0	41,802	41,802	872,583
Noncurrent liabilities					
Compensated absences	0	0	9,594	9,594	0
Total noncurrent liabilities	0	0	9,594	9,594	0
Total liabilities	0	0	51,396	51,396	872,583
NET POSITION					
Net investment in capital assets	0	0	62,634	62,634	0
Unrestricted	12,371,654	3,085,729	352,905	15,810,288	2,269,412
Total net position	\$ 12,371,654	\$ 3,085,729	\$ 415,539	\$ 15,872,922	\$ 2,269,412

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENSES,
AND CHANGES IN FUND NET POSITION
PROPRIETARY FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Business-Type Activities				
	Dalton Whitfield Solid Waste Management	Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	Whitfield Transit System	Totals	Internal Service Funds
OPERATING REVENUES					
Charges for sales and services	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 262,551	\$ 262,551	\$ 10,964,519
Other	0	0	0	0	86,813
Total operating revenues	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>262,551</u>	<u>262,551</u>	<u>11,051,332</u>
OPERATING EXPENSES					
Costs of sales and services	0	0	799,883	799,883	0
Personal services	0	0	32,199	32,199	0
Depreciation	0	0	26,470	26,470	0
Premiums and administrative fees	0	0	0	0	2,592,726
Claims paid	0	0	0	0	7,827,060
Total operating expenses	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>858,552</u>	<u>858,552</u>	<u>10,419,786</u>
Operating income (loss)	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>(596,001)</u>	<u>(596,001)</u>	<u>631,546</u>
Non-operating revenues (expenses)					
Intergovernmental	0	0	563,715	563,715	0
Gain (loss) on joint venture	(1,008,535)	(76,043)	0	(1,084,578)	0
Total non-operating revenues (expenses)	<u>(1,008,535)</u>	<u>(76,043)</u>	<u>563,715</u>	<u>(520,863)</u>	<u>0</u>
Change in net position	<u>(1,008,535)</u>	<u>(76,043)</u>	<u>(32,286)</u>	<u>(1,116,864)</u>	<u>631,546</u>
Net position, January 1, as previously stated	<u>13,380,189</u>	<u>3,161,772</u>	<u>376,038</u>	<u>16,917,999</u>	<u>1,637,866</u>
Error correction	0	0	72,869	72,869	0
Change in accounting principle	0	0	(1,082)	(1,082)	0
Net position, January 1, as restated	<u>13,380,189</u>	<u>3,161,772</u>	<u>447,825</u>	<u>16,989,786</u>	<u>1,637,866</u>
Net position, December 31	<u>\$ 12,371,654</u>	<u>\$ 3,085,729</u>	<u>\$ 415,539</u>	<u>\$ 15,872,922</u>	<u>\$ 2,269,412</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS
PROPRIETARY FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Business-Type Activities				
	Dalton Whitfield Solid Waste Management	Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	Whitfield Transit System	Totals	Internal Service Funds
Cash flows from operating activities:					
Receipts from customers and users	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 246,901	\$ 246,901	\$ 10,814,006
Payments to suppliers	0	0	(799,020)	(799,020)	(10,319,153)
Payments to employees	0	0	(25,703)	(25,703)	0
Other receipts	0	0	0	0	86,813
Net cash provided (used) by operating activities	0	0	(577,822)	(577,822)	581,666
Cash flows from non-capital financing activities:					
Intergovernmental receipts	0	0	591,545	591,545	0
Net increase (decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	0	0	13,723	13,723	581,666
Cash and cash equivalents, January 1	0	0	146,005	146,005	2,386,184
Cash and cash equivalents, December 31	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 159,728	\$ 159,728	\$ 2,967,850
Reconciliation of operating income (loss) to net cash provided (used) by operating activities:					
Operating income (loss)	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ (596,001)	\$ (596,001)	\$ 631,546
Adjustments to reconcile operating income (loss) to net cash provided (used) by operating activities:					
Depreciation expense	0	0	26,470	26,470	0
(Increase) decrease in accounts receivable	0	0	(17,079)	(17,079)	(150,513)
(Increase) decrease in prepaid expenses	0	0	14,123	14,123	0
Increase (decrease) in accounts payable	0	0	(12,256)	(12,256)	274,406
Increase (decrease) in accrued payroll liabilities	0	0	6,496	6,496	0
Increase (decrease) in unearned revenue	0	0	425	425	0
Increase (decrease) in claims reserve	0	0	0	0	(173,773)
Total adjustments	0	0	18,179	18,179	(49,880)
Net cash provided (used) by operating activities	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ (577,822)	\$ (577,822)	\$ 581,666

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FIDUCIARY FUNDS
STATEMENT OF FIDUCIARY NET POSITION
December 31, 2024

	Custodial Funds
ASSETS	
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 16,308,142
Taxes receivable	<u>65,569,109</u>
Total assets	<u>81,877,251</u>
LIABILITIES	
Due to others	<u>80,796,920</u>
NET POSITION	
Restricted for individuals, organizations, and other governments	<u><u>\$ 1,080,331</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FIDUCIARY FUNDS
STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN FIDUCIARY NET POSITION
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Custodial Funds
ADDITIONS	
Taxes collected for other agencies	\$ 120,137,593
Court fees collected for other agencies	6,285,078
Court individual cases	2,309,004
Sheriff fees collected	200,692
Sheriff inmate account deposits	1,297,504
Total additions	130,229,871
DEDUCTIONS	
Taxes distributed to other agencies	119,979,374
Court fees distributed to other agencies	6,237,643
Payments to others	2,332,454
Sheriff fees distributed to other agencies	138,258
Payments from inmates to others	1,287,693
Total deductions	129,975,422
Change in net position	254,449
Net position - beginning	825,882
Net position - ending	\$ 1,080,331

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

1. Description of Government Unit

Whitfield County, Georgia (the County) was incorporated in 1851 under the provisions of the Constitution of the State of Georgia. The County operates under a Board-Administrator form of government. The County is governed by a board of five commissioners elected by the voters of the County.

The County provides a full range of governmental services, including public safety, public works, health and welfare services, recreational programs, housing and development, solid waste management services, and transit services.

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies

A. Description of Government-wide Financial Statements

The government-wide financial statements (i.e., the statement of net position and the statement of activities) report information on all of the nonfiduciary activities of the primary government and its component units. All fiduciary activities are reported only in the fund financial statements. Governmental activities, which normally are supported by taxes, intergovernmental revenues, and other nonexchange transactions, are reported separately from business-type activities, which rely to a significant extent on fees and charges to external customers for support. Likewise, the primary government is reported separately from certain legally separate component units for which the primary government is financially accountable.

B. Reporting Entity

The reporting entity is comprised of the primary government, component units, and other organizations that are included to ensure that the financial statements are not misleading. The primary government of the County consists of all funds, departments, boards, and agencies that are not legally separate from the County.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

B. Reporting Entity, continued

Component units are legally separate organizations for which the County is financially accountable. The County is financially accountable for an organization if the County appoints a voting majority of the organization's governing board and (1) the County is able to significantly influence the programs or services performed or provided by the organizations; (2) the County is legally entitled to or can otherwise access the organization's resources; (3) the County is legally obligated or has otherwise assumed the responsibility to finance the deficits of, or provide financial support to, the organization; or (4) the County is obligated for the debt of the organization. Component units also may include organizations that are fiscally dependent on the County in that the County approves the budget, levies their taxes, or issues their debt.

The component unit columns included on the government-wide financial statements identifies the financial data of the County's discretely presented component units is reported separately to emphasize that it is legally separate from the County.

Whitfield County Health Department (Board of Health) – The Board of Health provides health care services and health education to residents of Whitfield County. The Board of Health receives financial support from Whitfield County, Georgia, the State of Georgia, and the Federal Government. The County Commission appoints a majority of the Board of Directors and approves the budget of the Board of Health. The Board of Health issued separately audited financial statements with a fiscal year ending June 30. Copies of these financial statements may be obtained from their administrative office at Whitfield County Health Department, 1710 Whitehouse Court, Dalton, GA 30720.

Certain county officials collect and disburse taxes, fees, fines, and other trust and agency receipts. Separate records of accountability are maintained for such receipts. For purposes of this report, these records are included as a part of custodial funds with remittances to the General Fund from these officials recorded as revenue. Operating costs for these officials are included as a part of the County's General Fund. These units include:

Tax Commissioner
Sheriff

Probate Court
Magistrate Court

Clerk of Superior Court
Juvenile Court

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

C. Basis of Presentation – Government-wide Financial Statements

While separate government-wide and fund financial statements are presented, they are interrelated. The governmental activities column incorporates data from governmental funds, while business-type activities incorporate data from the government's enterprise funds. Separate financial statements are provided for governmental funds, proprietary funds, and fiduciary funds, even though the latter are excluded from the government-wide financial statements.

As a general rule, the effect of interfund activity has been eliminated from the government-wide financial statements.

D. Basis of Presentation – Fund Financial Statements

The fund financial statements provide information about the government's funds, including its fiduciary funds and blended component units. Separate statements for each fund category—governmental, proprietary, and fiduciary—are presented. The emphasis of fund financial statements is on major governmental and enterprise funds, each displayed in a separate column. All remaining governmental and enterprise funds are aggregated and reported as nonmajor funds. Major individual governmental and enterprise funds are reported as separate columns in the fund financial statements.

The County reports the following major governmental funds:

General Fund – The General Fund accounts for all financial resources except those required to be accounted for in another fund. The general fund balance is available to the County for any purpose, provided it is expended or transferred according to the general laws of Georgia.

Special Fire District Fund – Accounts for the revenues of a specific property tax levy for all areas outside of the City of Dalton for funding the fire departments located in Whitfield County.

American Rescue Plan Act Special Revenue Fund – Accounts for the revenues and expenditures of the American Rescue Plan Act Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Fund.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

D. Basis of Presentation – Fund Financial Statements, continued

SPLOST 2020 Capital Projects Fund – Accounts for the proceeds of a 1 percent local option sales tax approved in 2020 for the purpose of financing long-term capital projects.

SPLOST 2024 Capital Projects Fund – Accounts for the proceeds of a 1 percent local option sales tax approved in 2024 for the purpose of financing long-term capital projects.

The County reports the following major proprietary funds:

Dalton/Whitfield Solid Waste Management Fund – Accounts for the activities of the County's 50% equity interest in the joint venture with the City of Dalton.

Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center – Accounts for the activities of the County's 50% equity interest in the joint venture with the City of Dalton.

Whitfield Transit System – This fund is used to account for the operating income, intergovernmental grants, and changes in net position for County's transit system.

Additionally, the government reports the following fund types:

Governmental Funds

Special Revenue Funds – Accounts for the proceeds of specific revenue sources that are legally or donor restricted to be expended for specified purposes.

Debt Service Funds – Accounts for the accumulation of resources and payment of general government long-term debt principal and interest from governmental resources.

Capital Projects Funds – Accounts for financial resources to be used for the acquisition or construction of specifically planned projects (other than those financed by proprietary funds).

Internal Service Funds – Accounts for the accumulation of resources to be used for health and workers' compensation insurance costs, as the County is partially self-insured.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

D. Basis of Presentation – Fund Financial Statements, continued

Fiduciary Fund Types

Custodial Funds – Custodial Funds are fiduciary in nature and are accounted for using the accrual basis of accounting. These funds are used to account for assets that are held for others.

During the course of operations the government has activity between funds for various purposes. Any residual balances outstanding at year end are reported as due from/to other funds and advances to/from other funds. While these balances are reported in fund financial statements, certain eliminations are made in the preparation of the government-wide financial statements. Balances between the funds included in governmental activities (i.e., the governmental funds) are eliminated so that only the net amount is included as internal balances in the governmental activities column. Similarly, balances between the funds included in business-type activities (i.e., the enterprise funds) are eliminated so that only the net amount is included as internal balances in the business-type activities column.

Further, certain activity occurs during the year involving transfers of resources between funds. In fund financial statements these amounts are reported at gross amounts as transfers in/out. While reported in fund financial statements, certain eliminations are made in the preparation of the government-wide financial statements. Transfers between the funds included in governmental activities are eliminated so that only the net amount is included as transfers in the governmental activities column. Similarly, balances between the funds included in business-type activities are eliminated so that only the net amount is included as transfers in the business-type activities column.

The accounting and financial reporting treatment is determined by the applicable measurement focus and basis of accounting. Measurement focus indicates the type of resources being measured such as current financial resources or economic resources. The basis of accounting indicates the timing of transactions or events for recognition in the financial statements.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

E. Measurement Focus and Basis of Accounting

The government-wide financial statements are reported using the economic resources measurement focus and the accrual basis of accounting. Revenues are recorded when earned and expenses are recorded when a liability is incurred, regardless of the timing of related cash flows. Property taxes are recognized as revenues in the year for which they are levied. Grants and similar items are recognized as revenue as soon as all eligibility requirements imposed by the provider have been met.

The governmental fund financial statements are reported using the current financial resources measurement focus and the modified accrual basis of accounting. Revenues are recognized as soon as they are both measurable and available. Revenues are considered to be available when they are collectible within the current period or soon enough thereafter to pay liabilities of the current period. For this purpose, the government considers revenues to be available if they are collected within 60 days of the end of the current fiscal period.

Expenditures generally are recorded when a liability is incurred, as under accrual basis of accounting. However, debt service expenditures, as well as expenditures related to compensated absences, and claims and judgments are recorded only when payment is due. General capital asset acquisitions are reported as expenditures in governmental funds. Issuance of long-term debt and acquisitions under leases are reported as other financing sources.

Property taxes, sales taxes, franchise taxes, licenses, and interest associated with the current fiscal period are all considered to be susceptible to accrual and so have been recognized as revenues of the current fiscal period. Entitlements are recorded as revenues when all eligibility requirements are met, including any time requirements, and the amount is received during the period or within the availability period for this revenue source (within 60 days of year-end). Expenditure-driven grants are recognized as revenue when the qualifying expenditures have been incurred and all other eligibility requirements have been met, and the amount is received during the period or within the availability period for this revenue source (within 60 days of year-end). All other revenue items are considered to be measurable and available only when cash is received by the government.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

E. Measurement Focus and Basis of Accounting, continued

The proprietary funds are reported using the economic resources measurement focus and the accrual basis of accounting.

The fiduciary funds are reported using the economic resources measurement focus and the accrual basis of accounting.

F. Revenues and Expenditures/Expenses

Program revenues include: 1) charges to customers or applicants who purchase, use, or directly benefit from goods, services, or privileges provided by a given function or segment, and 2) grants and contributions that are restricted to meeting the operational or capital requirements of a particular function or segment. All taxes, including those dedicated for specific purposes, and other internally dedicated resources are reported as general revenues rather than as program revenues.

Proprietary funds distinguish operating revenues and expenses from non-operating items. Operating revenues and expenses generally result from providing services and producing and delivering goods in connection with a proprietary fund's principal ongoing operations. The principal operating revenues of the enterprise funds are charges to customers for sales and services. Operating expenses for enterprise funds include the cost of sales and services, administrative expenses, and depreciation on capital assets. All revenues and expenses not meeting this definition are reported as non-operating revenues and expenses.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

G. Budgetary Information

The County adopts an annual operating budget for the General Fund, each Special Revenue Fund, and each Capital Projects Fund. The budget resolution reflects the total of each department's appropriation in each fund.

The General Fund, Special Revenue Funds budget, and Capital Project Funds are adopted on a basis consistent with GAAP. Budgets for the Special Revenue Funds and the Capital Projects Funds are adopted on a basis consistent with GAAP.

The legal level of control (the level at which expenditures may not legally exceed appropriations for each adopted annual operating budget is the department level within the General Fund and at the functional level for each of the remaining individual funds. Any change in total to a fund or departmental appropriation within the General Fund requires approval of the Board of Commissioners. During the year, the Board of Commissioners approved budget revisions. All unexpended annual appropriations lapse at the end of the fiscal year.

H. Cash and Investments

Cash and cash equivalents include amounts in demand deposits as well as short-term investments with a maturity date within three months of the date acquired by the County.

The statutes of the State of Georgia authorize the County to invest in the following types of investments:

- Obligations of the U. S. Government
- State of Georgia obligations and other States
- Obligations of any corporation of the government
- Repurchase agreements
- Prime banker's acceptances
- Certificates of deposit or time deposit of any national state bank or savings and loan which have deposits insured by the FDIC or FSLIC;
- The State of Georgia local government investment pool (Georgia Fund 1)

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

H. Cash and Investments, continued

Cash and cash equivalents, as reported in the statement of cash flows, includes amounts in demand deposits, amounts with fiscal agents, and investments with an original maturity at three months or less.

Any investment or deposit in excess of the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC) insured amount must be secured by either (a) security pledges of 110% of an equivalent amount of State or U.S. obligations, or (b) the financial institute participating in the Georgia Secure Deposit Program, administered by the Office of State Treasurer.

Georgia Fund 1, created by OCGA 36-83-8, is a stable asset value investment pool that follows Standard and Poor's criteria for AAAf rated money market funds and is regulated by the Georgia Office of the State Treasurer. The pool is not registered with the SEC as an investment company. The pool's primary objectives are safety of capital, investment income, liquidity and diversification while maintaining principal (\$1.00 per share value). The asset value is calculated weekly to ensure stability. The pool distributes earnings (net of management fees) on a monthly basis and determines participant's shares sold and redeemed based on \$1.00 per share. The pool also adjusts the value of its investments to fair value as of year-end and the County's investment in the Georgia Fund 1 is reported at fair value. The County considers amounts held in Georgia Fund 1 as cash equivalents for financial statement presentation.

The County's nonparticipating interest-earning investment contracts are recorded at cost. The remaining investments are recorded at fair value. Increases or decreases in fair value during the year are recognized as a component of interest income.

I. Intergovernmental Receivables

Receivables from state, federal, and local governments are recorded as revenue for the period of the allocation or as earned based on expenditures made for which reimbursement is due.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

J. Receivables

All trade and property tax receivables are reported net of an allowance for uncollectible accounts. Unbilled charges are accrued as receivables and revenue at the end of the current year.

K. Prepaid Items

Payments made to vendors that benefit future reporting periods are recorded as prepaid items. Prepaid items in the governmental funds are accounted for using the consumption method.

L. Capital Assets

Capital assets, which include property, plant, equipment, intangible, and infrastructure assets (e.g. roads, bridges, sidewalks, culverts and similar items), are reported in the applicable governmental or business type activities columns in the government-wide financial statements. Capital assets are defined by the County as assets with an initial, individual cost of \$10,000 and an estimated useful life in excess of two years or more. Such assets are recorded at historical cost or estimated historical cost if purchased or constructed. Donated capital assets are recorded at acquisition value.

Depreciation and amortization is computed using the straight-line method over the estimated useful lives of the respective assets ranging as follows:

	<u>in Years</u>
Land	N/A
Buildings	7-40
Equipment and fixtures	3-20
Vehicles	5-10
Infrastructure	40
Intangible right-to-use	
Software	2-3

The costs of normal maintenance and repairs that do not add value or materiality extend the life of the asset are charged to operations as incurred. Costs of major additions and improvements are capitalized.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

M. Deferred Outflows/Inflows of Resources

In addition to assets, the statement of financial position will sometimes report a separate section for deferred outflows of resources. This separate financial statement element, deferred outflows of resources, represents a consumption of net assets that applies to a future period(s) and so will not be recognized as an outflow of resources (expense/ expenditure) until then. The County reports deferred outflows of resources for their defined benefit pension and other postemployment benefit plans.

In addition to liabilities, the statement of financial position will sometimes report a separate section for deferred inflows of resources. This separate financial statement element, deferred inflows of resources, represents an acquisition of net assets that applies to a future period(s) and so will not be recognized as an inflow of resources (revenue) until that time. The County has only one type of item, which arises only under a modified accrual basis of accounting that qualifies for reporting in this category. Accordingly, the item, unavailable revenue, is reported only in the governmental funds balance sheet. The governmental funds report unavailable revenues from three sources: property taxes, and fines, fees, and forfeitures. These amounts are deferred and recognized as an inflow of resources in the period that the amounts become available. The County also reports deferred inflows of resources for defined benefit pension plan and other postemployment benefit plan.

N. Net Position Flow Assumption

Sometimes the County will fund outlays for a particular purpose from both restricted (e.g., restricted bond or grant proceeds) and unrestricted resources. In order to calculate the amounts to report as restricted – net position and unrestricted – net position in the government-wide and proprietary fund financial statements, a flow assumption must be made about the order in which the resources are considered to be applied. It is the County's policy to consider restricted – net position to have been depleted before unrestricted – net position is applied.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

O. Fund Balance Flow Assumption

Sometimes the County will fund outlays for a particular purpose from both restricted and unrestricted resources (the total of committed, assigned, and unassigned fund balance). In order to calculate the amounts to report as restricted, committed, assigned, and unassigned fund balance in the governmental fund financial statements a flow assumption must be made about the order in which the resources are considered to be applied. It is the County's policy to consider restricted fund balance to have been depleted before using any of the components of unrestricted fund balance. Further, when the components of unrestricted fund balance can be used for the same purpose, committed fund balance is depleted first, followed by assigned fund balance. Unassigned fund balance is applied last.

P. Restricted Assets and Restricted Net Position

Restricted Assets consist of sinking fund resources in the 2015 SPLOST Fund and 2020 SPLOST Fund are restricted to the payment of bond principal and interest requirements as they become due.

Restricted net position is equal to the excess of the restricted assets funded from operations over the liabilities to be paid with restricted assets which are due in one year or less.

Q. Fund Balances – Governmental Funds

In the fund financial statements, governmental funds report the following classifications of fund balance:

Nonspendable – includes amounts that cannot be spent because they are either not spendable in form or are legally or contractually required to be maintained intact. All amounts reported as nonspendable by the County are nonspendable in form. The County has not reported any amounts that are legally or contractually required to be maintained intact.

Restricted – includes amounts restricted by external sources (creditors, laws of other governments, etc.) or by constitutional provision or enabling legislation.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

Q. Fund Balances – Governmental Funds, continued

Committed – includes amounts that can only be used for specific purposes. Committed fund balance is reported pursuant to resolutions passed by the Board of Commissioners, the County's highest level of decision making authority, which include the language "committed for the purpose of". Commitments may be modified or rescinded only through adoption of a subsequent resolution, which shall refer to the original resolution by its number.

Assigned - consists of amounts that are intended to be used by the County for a specific purpose, but do not meet the definition of restricted or committed fund balance. Intent can only be expressed by the Commission. Assigned Fund Balance differs from Committed Fund Balance in that assignments do not require a resolution. Through resolution, the Commission has authorized the Chief Financial Officer to assign fund balances.

Unassigned – includes amounts that do not fall into one of the above four categories. This classification represents fund balance that has not been assigned to other funds and that has not been restricted, committed, or assigned to specific purposes within the General Fund. The General Fund is the only fund that should report this category of fund balance.

R. Compensated Absences

Compensated absence benefits are accrued as a liability as the benefits are earned if the employees' rights to receive compensation are attributable to services already rendered and it is probable that the employer will compensate the employees for the benefits through paid time off or some other means. Employees are permitted to accumulate paid time off up to 20 days. The total compensated absence liability is reported on the government-wide financial statements. Proprietary funds report the total compensated liability in each individual fund at the fund reporting level. Governmental funds report the compensated absence liability at the fund reporting level only "when due." In accordance with GASB Statement No. 101, *Compensated Absences*, the sick leave and employee leave bank portion of the County's liability is accrued by estimated expected sick leave and employee leave bank time to be used by employees with current economic resources.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

S. Long-Term Obligations

In the government-wide financial statements, and proprietary fund types in the fund financial statements, long-term debt and other long-term obligations are reported as liabilities in the applicable governmental activities, business-type activities, or proprietary fund type statement of net position. Bond premiums and discounts, as well as prepaid bond insurance, are deferred and amortized over the life of the bonds using the straight-line method. Bonds payable are reported net of the applicable bond premium or discount. Prepaid bond insurance is reported as deferred charges and amortized over the term of the debt. Issuance costs are recognized during the current period.

In the fund financial statements, governmental fund types, bond premiums and discounts, as well as issuance costs, are recognized during the current period. The face amount of debt issued is reported as another financing source. Premiums received on debt issuances are reported as other financial sources while discounts on debt issuances are reported as other financing uses. Issuance costs, even if withheld from the actual net proceeds received, are reported as debt service expenditures.

T. Pensions and OPEB

For purposes of measuring the net pension liability, deferred outflows of resources and deferred inflows of resources related to pensions or OPEB, and pension or OPEB expense, information about the fiduciary net position of the Barrow County Retirement Plan (the Plan) and additions to/deductions from the Plan's fiduciary net position have been determined on the same basis as they are reported by the Plan. For this purpose, benefit payments (including refunds of employee contributions) are recognized when due and payable in accordance with the benefit terms. Investments are reported at fair value.

U. Capital Contributions

Federal, state and local government assistance in the form of grants that are permanent in nature and restricted for the construction or acquisition of specific property and equipment is recorded as an asset and as non-operating revenue.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

V. Use of Estimates in the Preparation of the Financial Statements

The preparation of financial statements in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles requires management to make estimates and assumptions that affect the reported amounts of assets and liabilities, disclosure of contingent assets and liabilities at the date of the financial statements and the reported amounts of revenues and expenses during the reporting period. Actual results could differ from those estimates.

3. Deposit and Investment Risk

Custodial Credit Risk – Deposits

Custodial credit risk is the risk that in the event of a financial institution failure, the County's deposits may not be returned. The County has no formal policy, but follows the State of Georgia requirement that all deposits be federally insured or fully collateralized.

Interest Rate Risk

Interest rate risk is the risk that changes in interest rates may adversely affect an investment's fair value. The County has no formal investment policy that limits investment maturities as a means of managing its exposure to fair value losses arising from increasing interest rates.

Credit Risk

State statutes authorize the government to invest in obligations of the United States Treasury and of its agencies and instrumentalities; bonds or certificates of indebtedness of this state and of its agencies and instrumentalities; certificates of deposits of banks insured by FDIC; prime bankers' acceptances; the State of Georgia Local Government Investment Pool; repurchase agreements; bonds, debentures, notes or other evidence of indebtedness of any solvent corporation subject to certain conditions.

Fair Value

The County categorizes its fair value measurements within the fair value hierarchy established by generally accepted accounting principles. The hierarchy is based on the valuation inputs used to measure the fair value of the asset. Level 1 inputs are quoted prices in active markets for identical assets; Level 2 inputs are significant other observable inputs; and Level 3 inputs are significant unobservable inputs.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

3. Deposit and Investment Risk (continued)

At the end of the current year, the County did not have any recurring fair value measurements. The Georgia Fund 1 is an investment pool which does not meet the criteria of GASB Statement No. 79 and is thus valued at fair value in accordance with GASB Statement No. 31. As a result, the County does not disclose the investment in the Georgia Fund 1 within the fair value hierarchy.

Concentration of Credit Risk

The County places no limit on the amount it may invest in any one issuer.

Foreign currency risk

The County has no investments denominated in a foreign currency.

The County participates in the State of Georgia Local Government Investment Pool (Georgia Fund 1). Assets in this pool are invested in the Georgia Fund 1, created by OCGA 36-83-8, which is a stable net asset investment pool that follows Fitch's criteria for AAAf/S1 rated money market funds. However, Georgia Fund 1 operates in a manner consistent with Rule 2a-7 of the Investment Company Act of 1940 and is considered to be a 2a-7 like pool. The pool is not registered with the SEC as an investment company. The pool's primary objectives are safety of capital, investment income, liquidity and diversification while maintaining principal (\$1.00 per share value). Net asset value is calculated weekly to ensure stability. The pool distributes earnings (net of management fees) on a monthly basis and determines participant's shares sold and redeemed based on \$1.00 per share. Georgia Fund 1 is managed by the Georgia Office of the State Treasurer. The investment policies of Georgia Fund 1 are established by the Georgia State Depository Board.

The Georgia Fund 1 is rated AAAf/S1 by Fitch. The weighted average maturity at the end of the current year was 27 days. At the end of the current year, the County's balance in Georgia Fund 1 was \$10,982,144.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

4. Accounts Receivable

Net accounts receivable at the end of the current year consist of the following:

Primary Government:

Major Funds

General Fund	\$ 59,202
Whitfield Transit System	51,743

Nonmajor Funds

Opioid Settlement Payments Special Revenue Fund	1,648,731
Emergency 911 Special Revenue Fund	352,504
Health Insurance Internal Service Fund	174,145

Total primary government	\$ 2,286,325
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Component Units

Whitfield County Health Department Component Unit	\$ 268
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5. Intergovernmental Receivables

Intergovernmental receivables at the end of the current year consist of the following:

Major Funds

General Fund	\$ 912,816
Special Fire District Special Revenue Fund	184,019
American Rescue Plan Act Special Revenue Fund	122,102
Whitfield Transit System Enterprise Fund	192,830

Nonmajor Funds

Opioid Settlement Payments Special Revenue Fund	5,309
Local Victim Assistance Program Special Revenue Fund	2,739
Drug Abuse Treatment and Education Special Revenue Fund	3,609
Felony Domestic Violence Grant Special Revenue Fund	43,984
Accountability Courts Grant Program Special Revenue Fund	156,364
Solid Waste District Special Revenue Fund	18,837
JDA Project Capital Projects Fund	1,024,530
Capital Acquisition Capital Projects Fund	39,558

Total primary government	\$ 2,706,697
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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

6. Property Taxes

Property tax rates are set by the Board of Commissioners each year and are limited by statutory or constitutional provision. Property values are assessed as of January 1st each year. Property taxes for digest year 2024, based upon the assessments as of January 1, 2024, were temporarily levied on June 21, 2024, billed on November 20, 2024, and due on January 20, 2025. Due to discrepancies in property assessments, the final 2024 digest was approved on March 11, 2025. Refunds for overpayments or additional property taxes due will be calculated upon final billing. Tax liens may be issued 60 days after the due date. Taxes receivable at the end of the current year consist of property taxes for seven years as follows:

<u>Year of Levy</u>	
2024	\$ 17,386,152
2023	418,366
2022	111,414
2021	8,555
2020	5,171
2019	7,761
2018 and older	<u>6,103</u>
	17,943,522
Less allowance for uncollectible	<u>(234,304)</u>
Total	<u><u>\$ 17,709,218</u></u>

\$3,795,834 of sales taxes, \$117,371 of franchise taxes, and \$5,316 of hotel/motel tax are also included in taxes receivable.

7. Interfund Receivables, Payables, and Transfers

A summary of interfund receivables and payables at the end of the current year is as follows:

<u>Receivable Fund</u>	<u>Payable Fund</u>	<u>Amount</u>
General	Special Fire District	\$ 3,688,885
	American Rescue Plan Act	1,331,981
	2020 SPLOST	140,076
	2024 SPLOST	5,080,955
	Nonmajor Governmental	<u>621,096</u>
		<u><u>\$ 10,862,993</u></u>

The balances reported as Due to/Due from represent loans between the borrower funds and the lender. These balances resulted from the time lag between the dates that transactions are recorded in the accounting system and payments between the funds are made. Any residual balances outstanding between the governmental activities and business-type activities are reported in the government-wide financial statements as "internal balances".

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

7. Interfund Receivables, Payables, and Transfers (continued)

A summary of interfund transfers for the current year is as follows:

<u>Transfer Out Fund</u>	<u>Transfer In Fund</u>	<u>Amount</u>
General	Nonmajor Governmental	\$ 2,247,426
American Rescue Plan Act	General	2,160,176
	Nonmajor Governmental	116,361
Nonmajor Governmental	General	<u>59,073</u>
		<u><u>\$ 4,583,036</u></u>

Interfund transfers are used to 1) move revenues from the fund that statute or budget requires collecting them to the fund that statute or budget requires to expend them, and 2) use unrestricted revenues collected to finance various programs accounted for in other funds in accordance with budgetary authorizations. Transfers are eliminated in the government-wide financial statements if the interfund transfer is within the governmental fund group or business-type fund group.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

8. Capital Assets

Capital asset activity for the primary government for the current year is as follows:

	Beginning Balance	Increases	Decreases	Ending Balance
Governmental activities				
Nondepreciable assets				
Land	\$ 14,230,895	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 14,230,895
Construction in progress	6,677,645	4,193,927	(4,644,575)	6,226,997
Total nondepreciable assets	20,908,540	4,193,927	(4,644,575)	20,457,892
Depreciable/amortizable assets				
Buildings	94,780,829	3,002,971	0	97,783,800
Vehicles	17,591,181	1,836,923	(828,970)	18,599,134
Equipment and fixtures	27,576,998	3,296,989	(628,412)	30,245,575
Infrastructure	808,282,252	342,423	0	808,624,675
Intangible assets				
Software	153,729	0	0	153,729
Total depreciable/amortizable assets	948,384,989	8,479,306	(1,457,382)	955,406,913
Less accumulated depreciation/amortization				
Buildings	(42,879,772)	(2,694,480)	0	(45,574,252)
Vehicles	(13,317,916)	(1,683,705)	798,837	(14,202,784)
Equipment and fixtures	(18,704,205)	(1,787,918)	628,412	(19,863,711)
Infrastructure	(675,263,684)	(4,173,787)	0	(679,437,471)
Intangible assets				
Software	(63,777)	(63,776)	0	(127,553)
Total accumulated depreciation/amortization	(750,229,354)	(10,403,666)	1,427,249	(759,205,771)
Total depreciable/amortizable assets, net	198,155,635	(1,924,360)	(30,133)	196,201,142
Governmental activities capital assets, net	<u>\$ 219,064,175</u>	<u>\$ 2,269,567</u>	<u>\$ (4,674,708)</u>	<u>\$ 216,659,034</u>
Business-type Activities				
Depreciable assets				
Vehicles	\$ 598,942	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 598,942
Equipment	37,000	0	0	37,000
Total depreciable assets	635,942	0	0	635,942
Less accumulated depreciation				
Vehicles	(529,263)	(24,620)	0	(553,883)
Equipment	(17,575)	(1,850)	0	(19,425)
Total accumulated depreciation/amortization	(546,838)	(26,470)	0	(573,308)
Business-type activities capital assets, net	<u>\$ 89,104</u>	<u>\$ (26,470)</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 62,634</u>

Decreases in construction in progress for the governmental activities consist of projects placed in services in the amount of \$4,597,325 and projects abandoned in the amount \$47,250.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

9. Capital Assets (continued)

Capital asset activity for the discretely presented component unit is as follows:

	<u>Beginning Balance</u>	<u>Increases</u>	<u>Decreases</u>	<u>Ending Balance</u>
Whitfield County Health Department				
Depreciable assets				
Equipment	\$ 463,465	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 463,465
Furniture and fixtures	6,664	0	0	6,664
Leasehold improvements	175,434	100,032	0	275,466
Total depreciable assets	645,563	100,032	0	745,595
Less accumulated depreciation				
Equipment	(458,273)	(1,710)	0	(459,983)
Furniture and fixtures	(6,642)	0	0	(6,642)
Leasehold improvements	(153,603)	(7,720)	0	(161,323)
Total accumulated depreciation	(618,518)	(9,430)	0	(627,948)
Whitfield County Health Department capital assets, net	<u>\$ 27,045</u>	<u>\$ 90,602</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 117,647</u>

Depreciation/amortization expense was charged to functions/programs as follows:

Primary Government

Governmental activities

General Government	\$ 1,555,676
Judicial	27,702
Public Safety	2,810,487
Public Works	4,993,242
Culture and Recreation	951,727
Housing and Development	64,832
Total depreciation/amortization expense for governmental activities	<u>\$ 10,403,666</u>

Business-type activities

Whitfield Transit System	<u>\$ 26,470</u>
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Component Unit

Whitfield County Health Department	<u>\$ 9,430</u>
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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

10. Long-Term Debt

Governmental Activities

Direct Placement Revenue Bonds

In June 2015, the County issued Series 2015 Taxable Refunding Revenue Bonds through the Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority in the amount of \$4,885,000, due in annual installments of \$426,000 to \$556,000 through June 2025, with an interest rate of 2.990%. The proceeds from these bonds were used to repay the County's outstanding Series 2010B bonds of \$4,775,000, plus issuance costs. Pursuant to these bond issues, the County entered into an intergovernmental agreement with the Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority whereby the County has an unconditional obligation to provide funds for the bond payments. The County will exercise its power of taxation to the extent necessary, to meet the debt service obligations. At the end of the current fiscal year, the bonds had an outstanding balance of \$556,000.

The annual requirements to amortize direct placement revenue bonds payable at the end of the current year are as follows:

Year Ending June 30,	Principal	Interest	Total
2025	\$ 556,000	\$ 8,312	\$ 564,312

Notes from Direct Borrowings

In April 2018, The County entered into a direct borrowing agreement with the Georgia Environment Finance Authority (GEFA) in the amount of \$1,600,000 to fund a sewer expansion project requiring monthly installments of \$4,330 of principal and interest through December 2030; interest at 0.700% (\$305,187 outstanding). Upon an event of default, all outstanding principal and accrued interest may be declared immediately due and payable. Note payments and performance obligations are secured by taxes, fees, and charges collected by the County.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

10. Long-Term Debt (continued)

Governmental Activities, continued

Notes from Direct Borrowings, continued

The annual requirements to amortize notes from direct borrowings at the end of the current year are as follows:

Year Ending June 30,	Principal	Interest	Total
2025	\$ 49,979	\$ 1,976	\$ 51,955
2026	50,330	1,625	51,955
2027	50,684	1,272	51,956
2028	51,040	916	51,956
2029	51,398	557	51,955
2030	51,756	196	51,952
Totals	<u>\$ 305,187</u>	<u>\$ 6,542</u>	<u>\$ 311,729</u>

Contracts Payable

In August 2020, the City of Dalton Building Authority issued \$26,500,000 of revenue bonds requiring biannual installments ranging from \$30,889 to \$6,745,889; interest at 0.920%, for the purpose of acquiring, constructing, equipping, maintaining, and operating projects embracing buildings and facilities and related equipment for use by the City of Dalton, Georgia. Upon issuance, the County executed a contract with the City of Dalton Building Authority that obligates the County to pay the debt service obligations on the full bond. The obligation was paid in full during the current year.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

10. Long-Term Debt (continued)

Governmental Activities, continued

Subscriptions Payable

The County has entered into agreements to subscribe to certain software. The subscription agreements qualify under GASB Statement No. 96, *Subscription-Based Information Technology Arrangements*, and therefore, have been recorded at the present value of the future minimum subscription payments at inception. Subscriptions payables are comprised of the following individual subscriptions at the end of the current year:

- \$95,980 document management software due in annual installments of \$49,270 through October 2024, interest at 2.796%. This obligation was paid in full in the current year.
- \$57,749 licensing software due in annual installments of \$28,280 through January 2024, interest at 2.847%. This obligation was paid in full in the current year.

11. Long-Term Liabilities

Changes in Long - Term Liabilities

The following is a summary of changes in long-term liabilities of the County for the current year:

	<u>Balance</u>	<u>Additions</u>	<u>Deductions</u>	<u>Balance</u>	<u>One Year</u>
Governmental activities					
Bonds payable	\$ 1,095,000	\$ 0	\$ 539,000	\$ 556,000	\$ 556,000
Notes from direct borrowings	354,818	0	49,631	305,187	49,979
Contracts payable	6,715,000	0	6,715,000	0	0
Subscriptions payable	77,192	0	77,192	0	0
Compensated absences	2,430,508	107,987	0	2,538,495	1,776,947
Total governmental activities	<u>\$ 10,672,518</u>	<u>\$ 107,987</u>	<u>\$ 7,380,823</u>	<u>\$ 3,399,682</u>	<u>\$ 2,382,926</u>
Business-type activities					
Compensated absences	<u>\$ 15,648</u>	<u>\$ 16,332</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 31,980</u>	<u>\$ 22,386</u>

Beginning balances in the governmental activities and business-type activities was restated for the implementation of GASB 101, *Compensated Absences*, in the amount of \$378,093 and \$1,082, respectively.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

11. Long-Term Liabilities (continued)

Changes in Long - Term Liabilities, continued

The total interest incurred and charged to expense for the current year was \$90,957 for governmental activities.

Long-term liability activity for the discretely presented component unit for the respective fiscal year is as follows:

	<u>Beginning Balance</u>	<u>Additions</u>	<u>Deductions</u>	<u>Ending Balance</u>	<u>Due Within One Year</u>
Whitfield County Health Department					
Compensated absences	\$ 151,400	\$ 0	\$ 2,015	\$ 149,385	\$ 89,631

12 . Retirement Plans

Defined Benefit Pension Plan

Plan Description. The County contributes to the Association of the County Commissioners of Georgia Restated Pension Plan for Whitfield County Employees (The Plan), a defined benefit pension plan, an agent multiple-employer public employee retirement system. The Plan issues a publicly available financial report that includes financial statements and required supplementary information for the Plan. That report may be obtained by writing to Government Employees Benefits Corporation of Georgia, 400 Galleria Parkway, Suite 1250, Atlanta, Georgia 30339. The Plan provides retirement, disability and death benefits to plan participants and beneficiaries. The Plan, through execution of an adoption agreement, is affiliated with the Association County Commissioners of Georgia Third Restated Defined Benefit Plan (The ACCG Plan), an agent multiple-employer pension plan administered by the Government Employee's Benefit Corporation (GEBCorp). The ACCG, in its role as Plan Sponsor, has the sole authority to amend the provisions of the ACCG Plan, as provided in Section 17.01 of the ACCG Plan document. The County has the authority by resolution to amend the adoption agreement, which defines the specific benefit provisions of the Plan, as provided in section 17.02 of the ACCG Plan document.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

All full-time County employees meeting the provisions as set out in the adoption agreement are eligible to participate in the Plan. Benefits vested at 100% after five years of service. Participants become eligible to retire at the earlier of: a) age 65 and 5 years of service or b) age 65 and 3 years of service if terminated prior to January 1, 2007. As of February 1, 2016, participation in the Plan was frozen to all newly hired or rehired employees.

At January 1, 2023, the date of the most recent actuarial valuation, participants consisted of the following:

Retirees, beneficiaries, and disablees	
currently receiving benefits	247
Terminated plan participants entitled to but	
not yet receiving benefits	314
Active employees participating in the plan	<u>307</u>
Total number of participants	<u><u>868</u></u>

Benefits Provided. Upon eligibility to retire, participants hired before January 1, 2003 are entitled to an annual benefit in the amount of 1.0% of average annual compensation up to \$6,600 plus 1.5% of average annual compensation up to \$6,600 plus \$36 multiplied by years of service and participants hired on or after January 1, 2003 are entitled to an annual benefit in the amount of 1.0% of average annual compensation multiplied by years of service. Compensation is averaged over a five year period prior to retirement or termination. The Plan also provides benefits in the event of death before retirement and early retirement subject to certain early retirement reduction factors.

Contributions. County employees are not required to contribute to the Plan. The County contributes the entire cost of the Plan, using the actuarial basis described in the annual valuation report. The County's actual contributions for the current year totaled \$0, or 0% of covered payroll. During the budget process, the Board of Commissioners voted to not contribute to the Plan in the current year. The Board of Commissioners provides for the benefits and funding policy through County ordinance and maintains the authority to change the policy. The administrative expenses set by contract between the ACCG and GEBCorp are in addition to the state-required annual funding requirement.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

The Georgia Constitution enables the governing authority of the County, the Board of Commissioners, to establish, and amend from time-to-time contribution rates for the County and its Plan participants.

Pension Liabilities, Pension Expense, Deferred Outflows of Resources, and Deferred Inflows of Resources Related to Pensions. At the end of the current year, the County reported a net pension liability of \$14,800,416. The net pension liability was measured as of December 31, 2023, and the total pension liability used to calculate the net pension liability was determined by an actuarial valuation as of January 1, 2023. For governmental activities, the net pension liability is liquidated by the General Fund. For the current year, the County recognized pension expense of \$3,178,987.

The components of the net pension liability for the County are as follows:

	Total Pension Liability	Plan Fiduciary Net Position	Net Pension Liability
	(a)	(b)	(a) - (b)
Balances at December 31, 2022	\$ 66,274,441	\$ 50,141,864	\$ 16,132,577
Changes for the year:			
Service Cost	645,403	0	645,403
Interest	4,541,332	0	4,541,332
Liability Experience (Gain)/Loss	1,121,560	0	1,121,560
Assumption Change	1,799,010	0	1,799,010
Employer Contributions	0	2,357,168	(2,357,168)
Net Investment Income	0	7,495,188	(7,495,188)
Benefit Payments	(2,796,543)	(2,796,543)	0
Administrative Expense	0	(100,664)	100,664
Other Changes	0	(312,226)	312,226
Net changes	5,310,762	6,642,923	(1,332,161)
Balance at December 31, 2023	\$ 71,585,203	\$ 56,784,787	\$ 14,800,416

Plan fiduciary net position as a percentage of the total pension liability	79.32%
Covered payroll	\$ 18,109,147
Employer's net pension liability as a percentage of covered payroll	81.73%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

At the end of the current year, the County reported deferred outflows of resources and deferred inflows of resources related to the plan from the following sources:

	<u>Deferred Outflows of Resources</u>	<u>Deferred Inflows of Resources</u>
Net difference between projected and actual earnings on pension plan investments	\$ 2,084,038	\$ 0
Differences between expected and actual experience	1,400,944	(17,542)
Changes of assumptions	<u>1,260,882</u>	<u>0</u>
Totals	<u><u>\$ 4,745,864</u></u>	<u><u>\$ (17,542)</u></u>

The amounts reported as deferred outflows and deferred inflows of resources will be recognized in pension expense as follows:

<u>Year Ending December 31</u>	
2025	\$ 1,913,272
2026	1,908,865
2027	1,679,304
2028	<u>(773,119)</u>
Totals	<u><u>\$ 4,728,322</u></u>

Actuarial Assumptions. The total pension liability in the January 1, 2023 actuarial valuation was determined using the following actuarial assumptions, applied to all periods included in the measurement:

Future salary increases	5.00% per year with an age based scale
Cost of living adjustments	N/A
Net investment rate of return	7.00%

Healthy mortality rates were based on the Pub-2010 Amount Weighted Mortality Table with a blend of 50% of the General Employees Table and 50% of the Public Safety Employees Table with Scale AA to 2023. Disabled rates were derived from the 2024 experience study.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

The pension plan's target asset allocation as of December 31, 2023 is summarized in the following table:

	Target Allocation	Range
Fixed Income	30%	25%-35%
Large Cap	30%	25%-35%
Mid Cap	5%	2.5%-10%
Small Cap	5%	2.5%-10%
REIT	5%	2.5%-10%
International	15%	10%-20%
Multi Cap	5%	2.5%-10%
Global Allocation	5%	2.5%-10%

Discount Rate. The discount rate used to measure the total pension liability was 7.00 percent. The discount rate is determined using the estimated 50th percentile return based on UBS Capital Market Assumptions (6.71%) and five year performance in excess of benchmarks (1.00%). The projection of cash flows used to determine the discount rate assumed that contributions from employer will be made at contractually required rates, actuarially determined. Based on those assumptions, the Plan's fiduciary net position was projected to be available to make all projected future benefit payments of current active and inactive employees. Therefore, the long-term expected rate of return on Plan investments was applied to all periods of projected benefit payments to determine the total pension liability.

Sensitivity of the Net Pension Liability to Changes in the Discount Rate. The following presents what the net pension liability would be if it were calculated using a discount rate that is one percentage-point lower (6.00 percent) or one percentage-point higher (8.00 percent) than the current rate:

	Discount Rate	Net Pension Liability
1% decrease	6.00%	\$ 24,214,079
Current discount rate	7.00%	14,800,416
1% increase	8.00%	6,963,638

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

Plan Fiduciary Net Position. Detailed information about the Plan's fiduciary net position is available in the separately issued Association County Commissioners of Georgia GEBCorp financial report.

Defined Contribution Plans

The County approved the adoption of the ACCG 401(a) *Defined Contribution Plan for Whitfield County Employees*, effective February 1, 2016. All full-time employees hired after January 31, 2016 are required to participate in the plan. Employees may enter the plan on the first day of the first pay period beginning on or after the date the participant first meets the eligibility requirements. The plan can be amended by the County Commissioners. The County will match contributions on a graduated vesting schedule based on years of service as follows: 0-3 years (0%), 4-5 years (60%), and 5 years or more (100%). Employees are fully vested after five years of service. During the current year, plan members made contributions of \$456,426.

The County approved adoption of the ACCG 457(b) *Deferred Compensation Plan for Whitfield County Employees*, effective February 1, 2016. All full-time employees hired after January 31, 2016 are eligible for participation in the plan. Eligible employees may enter the plan on the first day of the first pay period beginning on or after the date the participant first meets the eligibility requirements. The plan can be amended by the County Commissioners. The County will match contributions equal to 50% of the first 4% of employee contributions, up to 2%. During the current year, plan members made contributions of \$637,712.

The County made contributions to the plans of \$728,145. Covered payroll of the employees that participate in these plans is \$41,930,031. The County has no fiduciary relationship with the plans, and plan assets are not available to the County or its general creditors. The Plan assets are held in trust by the administrator for the exclusive benefit of the participants of the Plans. The Board of Commissioners provides for the funding policy through a County ordinance and maintains the authority to change the policy. Separate financial statements are not issued for the Plans.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Other County Plans

In addition to the plan above, various County employees are covered under the following plans: Georgia Firefighters' Pension Fund, Georgia State Employees' Retirement System (ERS), Georgia Judicial Retirement System (JRS), Magistrates' Retirement Fund of Georgia, Peace Officers' Annuity and Benefit Fund of Georgia, Probate Judges' Retirement Fund of Georgia, Sheriffs' Retirement Fund of Georgia, and Superior Court Clerks' Retirement Fund of Georgia. Further information regarding these plans can be obtained from the plans' annual reports. These plans are immaterial to the financial statements.

Whitfield County Health Department Retirement Plan

Eligible employees of the Whitfield County Health Department participate in the Georgia State Employees' Retirement System (ERS), a statewide multiple-employer public employee retirement system. During the fiscal year ended June 30, 2024, the Department contributed \$456,632. As of June 30, 2024, the Department reported a liability in the amount of \$3,408,857 for its proportionate share (0.057142%) of the net pension liability. As of June 30, 2024, the Department reported deferred outflows of resources related to pension of \$778,448 and deferred inflows of resources related to pension of \$653,894. The Department recognized pension expense of \$199,114 for the fiscal year ended June 30, 2024. Further information regarding the plan can be obtained from Department's annual audit report by contacting Whitfield County Health Department, 800 Professional Boulevard, Dalton, GA 30720.

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions

County Plan

Plan Description. Whitfield County administers a single-employer defined benefit health care plan, "The Whitfield County Other Postemployment Benefits Plan." The OPEB financial statements are included in this report. No stand-alone financial report is issued.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

At January 1, 2024, the date of the most recent actuarial valuation, membership consisted of the following:

Inactive members or beneficiaries currently receiving benefits	28
Inactive members entitled to but not yet receiving benefits	0
Active employees	<u>178</u>
Total membership	<u><u>206</u></u>

Benefits Provided. Coverage under the plan includes medical and prescription drug benefits for retirees and dependents. Employees hired prior to January 1, 2009 are eligible to retire and continue medical coverage after 10 years of service and a minimum age of 60 years for reduced pension benefit or after 25 years of service and a minimum age of 60 for unreduced pension benefit. Employees hired or rehired after January 1, 2009 are not eligible for participation in the plan. Retiree and spousal coverage is provided for the lifetime of the participant. Upon the death of an eligible retiree with a covered dependent, the surviving dependent may extend coverage.

Contributions. The County has not elected to advance fund the OPEB Plan, but rather maintains the OPEB Plan on a “pay-as-you-go” basis, in that claims are paid as they arise. The Board of Commissioners authorizes participation in the OPEB and sets the contribution rates and benefits, and maintains the authority to change the policy.

The cost of coverage is paid in part by the employer and in part by the retiree. For the measurement period ended January 1, 2024, plan members receiving benefits contributed \$246,700 through their required contributions.

OPEB Liabilities, OPEB Expense, Deferred Outflows of Resources, and Deferred Inflows of Resources Related to OPEB. At the end of the current year, the County reported a total OPEB liability of \$11,460,100. The total OPEB liability was measured as of January 1, 2024. During the current year, the County recognized OPEB expense of \$808,300.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

The components of the total OPEB liability are as follows:

	Total OPEB Liability (a)	Plan Fiduciary Net Position (b)	Net OPEB Liability (a)-(b)
Balances at December 31, 2023	\$ 8,872,600	\$ 0	\$ 8,872,600
Changes for the year:			
Service cost	220,100	0	220,100
Interest	363,300	0	363,300
Differences between expected and actual experience	1,998,900	0	1,998,900
Contributions-employer	0	246,700	(246,700)
Changes of assumptions or other inputs	251,900	0	251,900
Benefit payments	(246,700)	(246,700)	0
Net changes	2,587,500	0	2,587,500
Balances at December 31, 2024	\$ 11,460,100	\$ 0	\$ 11,460,100

Plan fiduciary net position as a percentage of the total OPEB liability	0.00%
Covered-employee payroll	\$ 12,533,200
Plan net OPEB liability as a percentage of covered employee payroll	91.44%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

At the end of the current year, the County reported deferred outflows of resources and deferred inflows of resources related to the OPEB Plan from the following sources:

	Deferred Outflows of Resources	Deferred Inflows of Resources
Differences between expected and actual experience	\$ 2,690,400	\$ (1,248,900)
Changes of assumptions	930,000	(1,333,000)
Contributions subsequent to the measurement date	245,790	0
Totals	<u><u>\$ 3,866,190</u></u>	<u><u>\$ (2,581,900)</u></u>

The \$245,790 of deferred outflows of resources resulting from the County's contributions subsequent to the measurement date will be recognized as a reduction of the net OPEB liability in the subsequent year. Other amounts reported as deferred outflows and deferred inflows of resources will be recognized in OPEB expense as follows:

Year Ending June 30,	
2025	\$ 219,200
2026	219,200
2027	239,000
2028	60,300
2029 and later	<u>300,800</u>
Totals	<u><u>\$ 1,038,500</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

Actuarial Assumptions. The total OPEB liability in the January 1, 2024 actuarial valuation was determined using the following actuarial assumptions, applied to all periods included in the measurement:

Salary scale	2.50%
Actuarial cost method	Entry age normal
Discount rate	3.77%, 4.05% at prior measurement date
Healthcare cost trend rates	Pre-Medicare: 6.50% for 2024 decreasing to an ultimate rate of 5.00% by 2030
Mortality rates	Mortality rates were based on the RP-2014 Mortality Table, fully generational with base year 2006, projected using 2-dimensional mortality improvement scale MP-2021.
Amortization method	Closed level dollar for remaining unfunded liability
Remaining amortization period	Remaining amortization period varies for the bases, with a net effective amortization period of 15 years.

The demographic actuarial assumptions for retirement, disability incidence, withdrawal, and salary increases used in the January 1, 2024 actuarial valuation reflect the analysis of the County's census data along with decrement experience of similar populations throughout Georgia.

The remaining actuarial assumptions (e.g., initial per capita costs, health care cost trends, etc.) used in the January 1, 2024 actuarial valuation were based on a review of recent plan experience performed concurrently with the January 1, 2024 valuation.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

Development of Long-Term Rate. Since the County funds this plan on a pay-as-you-go basis, GASB requires the discount rate be based on a yield or index rate for 20-year, tax-exempt municipal bonds with an average rating of AA/Aa or higher (or equivalent quality on another rating scale). The Municipal Bond Index Rate selected by the County for this purpose is the Bond Buyer General Obligation 20-year Municipal Bond Index published at the last Thursday of December by The Bond Buyer (www.bondbuyer.com). The Municipal Bond Index Rate as of the measurement date was 3.77%.

Sensitivity of the Net OPEB Liability to Changes in the Discount Rate. The following presents what the net OPEB liability would be if it were calculated using a discount rate that is one percentage-point lower (2.77%) or one percentage-point higher (4.77%) than the current rate. Also, shown is the net OPEB liability as if it were calculated using healthcare cost trend rates that were one percentage point lower or one percentage point higher than the current healthcare trend rates:

<u>Discount Rate</u>		<u>Net OPEB Liability</u>
1% decrease	2.77%	\$ 12,404,900
Current discount rate	3.77%	11,460,100
1% increase	4.77%	10,586,600
<u>Healthcare Cost Trend Rates</u>		<u>Net OPEB Liability</u>
1% decrease	2.77%	\$ 10,403,400
Current trend rate	3.77%	11,460,100
1% increase	4.77%	12,673,100

OPEB Plan Fiduciary Net Position. Detailed information about the Plan's fiduciary net position is available in the separately issued GASB Statement No. 75 Report for The Whitfield County Other Postemployment Benefits Plan.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

Whitfield County Health Department OPEB Plans

Eligible employees of the Whitfield County Health Department are provided OPEB through the State of Georgia OPEB Fund, a cost-sharing multiple-employer defined benefit post-employment healthcare plan and life insurance through the SEAD-OPEB Fund, a cost-sharing multiple-employer defined benefit post-employment benefit plan. During the fiscal year ended June 30, 2024, the Health Department contributed \$224,968. As of June 30, 2024, the Health Department reported a liability (asset) in the amount of (\$262,279) for its proportionate share (0.059473%) of the SEAD-OPEB net OPEB liability (asset). As of June 30, 2024, the Health Department reported a liability (asset) in the amount of \$156,055 for its proportionate share (0.055057%) of the State OPEB net OPEB liability (asset). As of June 30, 2024 the Department reported deferred outflows of resources related to OPEB of \$385,917 and deferred inflows of resources related to OPEB of \$338,526. The Health Department recognized OPEB expense (revenue) of (\$72,705) for the fiscal year ended June 30, 2024. Further information regarding the plan can be obtained from Department's annual audit report by contacting Whitfield County Health Department, 800 Professional Boulevard, Dalton, GA 30720.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

14. Restricted, Committed, and Assigned Fund Balances

The following is a summary of restricted, committed, and assigned fund balances of the governmental funds at the end of the current year:

	American Rescue Plan Act	2020 SPLOST	Nonmajor Governmental Funds	Total Governmental Funds
Restricted for:				
Judicial				
Drug abuse treatment and education programs	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 585,040	\$ 585,040
Law library operations	0	0	111,293	111,293
Treatment programs for juvenile offenders	0	0	126,935	126,935
Judicial facilities, equipment, and operations	0	0	21,289	21,289
Divorce remediation efforts	0	0	14,623	14,623
Felony domestic violence prevention and response	0	0	36,938	36,938
Operation of accountability courts	0	0	731,273	731,273
Alternative dispute resolution programs	0	0	507,215	507,215
Public Safety				
Opioid remediation efforts	0	0	329,404	329,404
Emergency 911 system operations	0	0	528,729	528,729
Sheriff facilities and equipment	0	0	174,628	174,628
Housing and Development				
Neighborhood stabilization efforts	0	0	81,456	81,456
Grant specifications	266,901	0	0	266,901
Capital projects	0	7,637,052	1,951,638	9,588,690
Debt service	0	0	2,528	2,528
	<u>\$ 266,901</u>	<u>\$ 7,637,052</u>	<u>\$ 5,202,989</u>	<u>\$ 13,106,942</u>
Committed for:				
Capital projects	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 3,603,881</u>	<u>\$ 3,603,881</u>
Assigned for:				
Public Works				
Solid waste management activities	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 169,860	\$ 169,860
Culture and Recreation				
Recreation management activities	0	0	216,412	216,412
	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 386,272</u>	<u>\$ 386,272</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

15. Net Investment in Capital Assets

The net investment in capital assets reported on the government-wide statement of net position is calculated as follows at the end of the current year:

	Governmental Activities	Business-Type Activities	Component Unit Whitfield County Health Department
Cost of capital assets, net	\$ 216,659,034	\$ 62,634	\$ 117,647
Capital-related accounts payable	(827,854)	0	0
Retainages payable	(110,417)	0	0
Notes payable	(305,187)	0	0
Bonds payable	(556,000)	0	0
Unspent bond proceeds	31,412	0	0
Net investment in capital assets	<u>\$ 214,890,988</u>	<u>\$ 62,634</u>	<u>\$ 117,647</u>

16. Tax Abatements

The Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority (a joint venture between the County and the City of Dalton) has entered into several agreements for abatement of property taxes. The JDA provides tax incentives, based upon certain criteria, to potential and existing entities for the purpose of furthering economic growth in the Dalton-Whitfield area. The JDA is not a taxing authority. The tax abatements offered are abatements of Whitfield County, Georgia property tax and City of Dalton, Georgia property tax. The County and the City must approve the tax incentive agreements prior to their execution.

The criteria that makes an entity eligible for tax abatements through the JDA include providing new capital investment and/or new jobs in the Dalton-Whitfield area. The amount of the tax abatement transaction is determined based upon a specific rubric. Planned new jobs, community investment, diversification, wage levels, project location, and other factors are considered in determining the amount of tax abatement offered to an entity. The tax abatement period for a project can last up to 15 years.

The entity must be willing to enter into a contractual agreement with the JDA and willing to enter into a bond financed sale leaseback transaction (Industrial Revenue Bonds) which transfers title to improvements (land, buildings, or equipment) during the life of the tax deferment/abatement plan to the JDA, as provided by Georgia state law. The local taxing jurisdiction and the public receive notice of the title transfer pursuant to an Industrial Revenue Bond validation.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

16. Tax Abatements (continued)

Entities with tax abatements are required to file an annual report with the JDA which certifies the number of jobs created, the cumulative amount of capital investment, and other applicable measurements. In the event the entity fails to meet specified goals, a percentage method described in each agreement is used to determine a shortfall. The shortfall percentage is multiplied by the amount of taxes abates for the year for the project to arrive at a recovery payment. The recovery payment is due with the annual report.

As of the end of the current year, the County abated property taxes for 32 entities totaling \$5,440,549 under these programs.

17. Hotel/Motel Lodging Tax

The County has levied an 7% lodging tax in accordance with OCGA 48-13-51. A summary of the transactions for the current year follows:

Lodging tax receipts	\$ 178,231
Disbursements for trade and tourism	\$ 178,306 100% of tax receipts

18. Joint Ventures

Under Georgia law, the County, in conjunction with other cities and counties in the Northwest Georgia area, is a member of the Northwest Georgia Regional Commission (NWGRC) and is required to pay annual dues thereto. During the current year, the County paid \$210,847 in such dues. Membership in an RC is required by the Official Code of Georgia Annotated (OCGA) Section 50-8-34, which provides for the organizational structure of the RC in Georgia. The RC Board membership includes the chief elected official in each county and municipality of the area. OCGA 50-8-39.1 provides that the member governments are liable for any debts or obligations of an RC. A copy of the NEGRC financial statements can be obtained from Northwest Georgia Regional Commission, 503 West Waugh Street, Dalton, Georgia 30720.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

18. Joint Ventures (continued)

Dalton-Whitfield Regional Solid Waste Management Authority

The County participates with the City of Dalton in the Dalton-Whitfield Regional Solid Waste Management Authority (DWRSWMA). All budgetary and financial records are maintained by the City. The DWRSWMA issued separate audited financial statements dated May 19, 2025. A copy of the separately issued financial statements can be obtained at their administrative office at 4350 Gazaway Drive SE, Dalton, Georgia 30720.

The County and the City share equally in operations of the DWRSWMA, which operates solid waste disposal sites within the County. Administration is accomplished through a five-member board with each government appointing two members and those four appointing the fifth member. Current expenses are funded through user fees and, if necessary, equal transfers from both governments. The County's equity interest in this joint venture is reported as an enterprise fund in the accompanying financial statements. The County's share of the resulting income (loss) from the joint venture is shown separately as revenue (expense) in the statement of activities.

State and federal laws and regulations require the DWRSWMA to place a final cover on its landfill sites when they stop accepting waste and to perform certain maintenance and monitoring functions at each site for thirty years after closure. Although closure and post-closure care costs will be paid only near or after the date that the landfill stops accepting waste, the DWRSWMA reports a portion of the closure and post-closure care costs as a non-operating expense in each period based on landfill capacity used as of each balance sheet date. The accrual for closure and post-closure cost is summarized by location as follows:

Landfill Sites:	Westside	Old Dixie II, IV, and V	Old Dixie VI	Balefill	Total
Estimated future costs:					
Closure	Closed	Closed	\$ 15,098,000	\$ 1,546,000	\$ 16,644,000
Post-closure	1,001,000	2,608,000	8,599,000	1,551,000	13,759,000
	<u>\$ 1,001,000</u>	<u>\$ 2,608,000</u>	<u>\$ 23,697,000</u>	<u>\$ 3,097,000</u>	<u>\$ 30,403,000</u>
Percentage of capacity as of December 31, 2024	100.0%	100.0%	67.0%	99.6%	
Liability at December 31, 2024	<u>\$ 1,001,000</u>	<u>\$ 2,608,000</u>	<u>\$ 15,884,000</u>	<u>\$ 3,085,000</u>	<u>\$ 22,578,000</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

18. Joint Ventures (continued)

Dalton-Whitfield Regional Solid Waste Management Authority, continued

The DWRSWMA will record the remaining estimated cost of closure and post-closure care costs of \$7,825,000 as the remaining capacity is filled. Estimated remaining landfill life is more than 30 years. The above estimates are based on what it would cost to perform all closure and post-closure care in 2024. Actual costs when incurred may be higher due to inflation, changes in technology, or changes in laws and regulations. As of December 31, 2024, the DWRSWMA reported an ending net position of \$24,744,771, which was a decrease of \$2,017,069 from the December 31, 2023 net position.

The DWRSWMA landfill closure and post-closure requirements are being funded from user fees and interest earned from investments. If these revenues are inadequate or additional post-closure care requirements are determined, these costs may need to be covered by charges to future landfill users.

Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center Authority

The County participates with the City of Dalton in the Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center Authority (Convention Center). All budgetary and financial records are maintained by the City. The Convention Center issued separate audited financial statements dated May 23, 2025. A copy of the separately issued financial statements can be obtained at their administrative office at 2211 Dug Gap Battle Road, Dalton, Georgia 30720.

The County and the City share equally in operations of the Convention Center, which operates to promote tourism within the County by hosting conventions, special events, and trade shows. Current expenses are funded through user fees and, if necessary, equal transfers from both governments. The County's equity interest in this joint venture is reported as an enterprise fund in the accompanying financial statements. The County's share of the resulting income (loss) from the joint venture is shown separately as revenue (expense) in the statement of activities. As of December 31, 2024, the Convention Center reported an ending net position of \$9,175,301, which was a decrease of \$152,085 from the December 31, 2023 net position.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

18. Joint Ventures (continued)

Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority

The County participates in the Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority and the Dalton-Whitfield Economic Development Authority, which are reported as one entity (JDA). All budgetary and financial records are maintained by the JDA, which is housed at the Dalton-Whitfield Chamber of Commerce. The JDA issued separate audited financial statements dated June 6, 2025. A copy of the separately issued financial statements can be obtained at their administrative office at 100 South Hamilton Street, Dalton, Georgia 30720.

The County and the City share equally in operations of the JDA, which operates to promote economic development within the County. Current expenses are funded through equal transfers from both governments and a large donation from a local advised fund. The County's transfer to the entity is shown as an expenditures of the General Fund and the County's equity interest in this joint venture is shown as an investment in a joint venture in the governmental activities in the government-wide statement of net position. The County's share of resulting income (loss) from the joint venture is shown separately as revenue (expense) in the statement of activities. As of December 31, 2024, the JDA reported an ending net position of \$3,019,039, which was an increase of \$319,421 from the December 31, 2023 net position.

19. Risk Management

The County is exposed to various risks of loss related to torts; theft of, damage to, and destruction of assets; errors and omissions; injuries to employees; and natural disasters. The State Constitution provides that the County (a political subdivision) may be immune from liability for most forms of bodily injury and property damage arising out of its operations, if such losses are not insured. It is the policy of the County to utilize immunity as a legal defense against liability claims whenever the risk of loss is not insured and immunity may be asserted.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

19. Risk Management (continued)

Workers' Compensation Insurance

The County maintains a Workers' Compensation Self-Insurance Fund, which is an internal service fund, to account for resources used in payment of workers' compensation claims. The County has entered into a contract with a third party to administer the Workers' Compensation Program. The County maintains third party insurance coverage from a private insurance carrier for claims that exceed \$250,000 per occurrence or a \$1,000,000 aggregate, stop loss limit. The County is a member of the State of Georgia Subsequent Injury Trust Fund, which provides reimbursement to individual participants, should a claim be filed by an employee who has suffered previous injury before employment with the County. During the current year, the County was reimbursed from the Subsequent Injury Trust Fund for claims above the stop loss limit. The County accrued a liability for workers' compensation claims that were incurred prior to year-end but were not paid until the following year. For purposes of estimating the unpaid claims liability as of year-end, the County's third party administrator computed the reserve liability based on the estimated cost of each outstanding claim from claims experience of similar claims.

The follow describes the activity for the past three years:

Fiscal Year	Beginning of Year Claims Liability	Current Year Claims and Changes in Estimates	Claims Paid	End of Year Claims Liability
2024	\$ 299,895	\$ 307,025	\$ 364,028	\$ 242,892
2023	475,218	509,372	684,695	299,895
2022	736,128	401,084	661,994	475,218

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

19. Risk Management (continued)

Group Health Insurance

The County also maintains a Group Health Benefits Self-Insurance Fund, which is an internal service fund, to account for resources used in providing employee benefits for medical, dental, disability, and losses of life claims. The County maintains third-party insurance coverage from a private insurance carrier for claims that exceed \$100,000 per employee or a \$6,900,000 aggregate, stop loss limit, based on an annual policy term using a 12/15 run out formula on specific employee claims and a 12/12 run out on aggregate claims.

The follow describes the activity for the past three fiscal years:

Fiscal Year	Beginning of Year Claims Liability	Current Year Claims and Changes in Estimates	Claims Paid	End of Year Claims Liability
2024	\$ 393,715	\$ 9,262,447	\$ 9,379,217	\$ 276,945
2023	308,964	9,611,995	9,527,244	393,715
2022	237,343	7,233,489	7,161,868	308,964

20. Commitments and Contingencies

Commitments

As of the end of the current year, contractual commitments on uncompleted contracts totaled \$301,220.

Contingencies

The County is involved in several lawsuits filed in the normal course of its activities. The majority of these claims are considered minimal with a favorable outcome expected. The County's position is to vigorously defend its position or seek an out of court settlement.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

20. Commitments and Contingencies (continued)

Contingencies, continued

The County has received federal and state grants for specific purposes that are subject to review and audit by the grantor agencies. Such audits could lead to disallowance of certain expenditures previously reimbursed by those agencies. Based upon prior experience, County management believes such disallowances, if any, will not be significant.

21. Deficit Equity Balances

At the end of the current year, the Fire Special Revenue Fund has a deficit fund balance of \$97,785. This is due to the delay in billing the 2024 property tax digest and payments in lieu of taxes. The County plans to liquidate this deficit fund balance through future revenue recognition.

22. New Accounting Pronouncements

The County implemented GASB Statement No. 100, *Accounting Changes and Error Corrections*, effective for the County's current year. The requirements of this statement are effective for periods beginning after June 15, 2023. The implementation of this new standard had no impact on the County's net position.

The County implemented GASB Statement No. 101, *Compensated Absences*, effective for the County's current year. The requirements of this statement are effective for periods beginning after December 15, 2023. The implementation of this new standard had no impact on the County's net position.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

23. Changes in Beginning Balances

Correction of an Error

Governmental Activities

An adjustment has been made to correct the balance of capital assets at December 31, 2023. This adjustment decreased beginning net position by \$17,572.

An adjustment has been made to correct the amount of national opioid settlement revenue recognized at December 31, 2023. This adjustment increased beginning net position by \$944,557.

2020 SPLOST Fund

An adjustment has been made to correct intergovernmental payouts at December 31, 2023. This adjustment decreased beginning fund balance by \$802,105.

The net effect of these adjustments was an increase in beginning net position in the Governmental Activities by \$124,880.

Business-type Activities

Whitfield Transit System

An adjustment has been made to correct the balance of unearned revenue at December 31, 2023. This adjustment increased beginning net position by \$72,869.

Change in Accounting Principle

Governmental Activities

An adjustment has been made to adjust the balance of compensated absences at December 31, 2023. This adjustment decreased beginning net position by \$378,093.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2024

23. Changes in Beginning Balances (continued)

Change in Accounting Principle, continued

Business-type Activities

Whitfield Transit System

An adjustment has been made to adjust the balance of compensated absences at December 31, 2023. This adjustment decreased beginning net position by \$1,082.

A summary of the changes in beginning balances is presented below:

	Beginning As Previously Reported	Error Correction	Change in Accounting Principle	Beginning As Restated
Government-Wide				
Governmental Activities	\$ 252,141,129	\$ 124,880	\$ (378,093)	\$ 251,887,916
Business-Type Activities	16,917,999	72,869	(1,082)	16,989,786
Total Primary Government	<u>\$ 269,059,128</u>	<u>\$ 197,749</u>	<u>\$ (379,175)</u>	<u>\$ 268,877,702</u>
Governmental Funds				
Major Fund				
2022 SPLOST	<u>\$ 8,552,042</u>	<u>\$ (802,105)</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 7,749,937</u>

24. Subsequent Events

On June 13, 2025, the County entered into an agreement with Axon Enterprise, Inc. to subscribe to software associated with Sheriff's body and fleet cameras. Upon inception of the agreement, the County will record an intangible right-to-use capital asset and a subscription payable equal to the present value of all future subscription payments in the amount of \$2,457,895.

REQUIRED SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF CHANGES IN THE NET PENSION LIABILITY AND RELATED RATIOS
LAST TEN YEARS
December 31, 2024
(Unaudited)

	Year End		
	2024	2023	2022
Total pension liability			
Service cost	\$ 645,403	\$ 666,693	\$ 707,126
Interest	4,541,332	4,211,018	3,983,044
Differences between expected and actual experience	1,121,560	1,393,325	754,458
Assumption change	1,799,010	103,332	100,918
Plan change	0	961,768	0
Benefit payments, including refunds of employee contributions	(2,796,543)	(2,438,174)	(2,139,391)
Net change in total pension liability	5,310,762	4,897,962	3,406,155
Total pension liability - beginning	66,274,441	61,376,479	57,970,324
Total pension liability - ending (a)	\$ 71,585,203	\$ 66,274,441	\$ 61,376,479
Plan fiduciary net position			
Contributions - employer	\$ 2,357,168	\$ 3,963,335	\$ 4,629,351
Net investment income	7,494,939	(8,145,943)	7,352,037
Benefit payments, including refunds of employee contributions	(2,796,543)	(2,438,174)	(2,139,391)
Administrative expense	(100,664)	(101,253)	(99,812)
Other	(312,226)	(272,188)	(122,658)
Net change in plan fiduciary net position	6,642,674	(6,994,223)	9,619,527
Plan fiduciary net position - beginning	50,142,113	57,136,336	47,516,809
Plan fiduciary net position - ending (b)	\$ 56,784,787	\$ 50,142,113	\$ 57,136,336
Net pension liability - ending : (a) - (b)	\$ 14,800,416	\$ 16,132,328	\$ 4,240,143
Plan's fiduciary net position as a percentage of the total pension liability	79.32%	75.66%	93.09%
Covered payroll	\$ 18,109,147	\$ 18,543,209	\$ 19,221,276
Net pension liability as a percentage of covered payroll	81.73%	87.00%	22.06%

Year End						
2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
\$ 722,968	\$ 711,465	\$ 594,570	\$ 554,097	\$ 509,289	\$ 462,662	\$ 479,120
3,767,497	3,445,075	3,220,859	3,101,595	2,898,002	2,641,503	2,522,904
(719,242)	(287,806)	(233,582)	(425,004)	1,828,569	497,388	0
148,841	2,515,573	2,951,217	99,318	1,338,116	1,344,262	0
1,239,938	0	0	0	0	0	0
(1,911,990)	(1,754,716)	(1,731,952)	(1,638,034)	(1,614,361)	(1,525,835)	(1,420,706)
3,248,012	4,629,591	4,801,112	1,691,972	4,959,615	3,419,980	1,581,318
54,722,312	50,092,721	45,291,609	43,599,637	38,640,022	35,220,042	33,638,724
<u>\$ 57,970,324</u>	<u>\$ 54,722,312</u>	<u>\$ 50,092,721</u>	<u>\$ 45,291,609</u>	<u>\$ 43,599,637</u>	<u>\$ 38,640,022</u>	<u>\$ 35,220,042</u>
\$ 1,867,847	\$ 1,498,082	\$ 1,504,596	\$ 1,504,596	\$ 500,000	\$ 1,055,865	\$ 876,506
5,961,458	7,445,140	(1,718,103)	5,486,159	2,387,843	257,095	2,320,411
(1,911,990)	(1,754,716)	(1,731,952)	(1,638,034)	(1,614,361)	(1,525,835)	(1,420,706)
(101,503)	(101,576)	(88,314)	(81,692)	(82,961)	(75,736)	(71,788)
0	(252,674)	(1,746,162)	(276,533)	(260,299)	(274,034)	(260,175)
5,815,812	6,834,256	(3,779,935)	4,994,496	930,222	(562,645)	1,444,248
41,700,997	34,866,741	38,646,676	33,652,180	32,721,958	33,284,603	31,840,355
<u>\$ 47,516,809</u>	<u>\$ 41,700,997</u>	<u>\$ 34,866,741</u>	<u>\$ 38,646,676</u>	<u>\$ 33,652,180</u>	<u>\$ 32,721,958</u>	<u>\$ 33,284,603</u>
<u>\$ 10,453,515</u>	<u>\$ 13,021,315</u>	<u>\$ 15,225,980</u>	<u>\$ 6,644,933</u>	<u>\$ 9,947,457</u>	<u>\$ 5,918,064</u>	<u>\$ 1,935,439</u>
81.97%	76.20%	69.60%	85.33%	77.18%	84.68%	94.50%
\$ 19,277,934	\$ 19,718,258	\$ 19,284,710	\$ 18,256,183	\$ 17,477,196	\$ 15,716,628	\$ 15,939,437
54.23%	66.04%	78.95%	36.40%	56.92%	37.65%	12.14%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF PENSION CONTRIBUTIONS
LAST TEN YEARS
December 31, 2024
(Unaudited)

	Year End		
	2024	2023	2022
Actuarially determined contribution	\$ 2,062,154	\$ 2,357,168	\$ 2,063,335
Contributions in relation to the actuarially determined contribution	0	(2,357,168)	(3,963,335)
Contribution deficiency (excess)	<u>\$ 2,062,154</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ (1,900,000)</u>
Covered payroll	\$ 18,993,150	\$ 18,109,147	\$ 18,543,209
Contributions as a percentage of covered payroll	0.00%	13.02%	21.37%

Year End						
2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
\$ 2,108,369	\$ 2,020,982	\$ 1,867,847	\$ 1,498,082	\$ 1,504,596	\$ 1,310,742	\$ 1,039,613
(2,608,369)	(2,020,982)	(1,498,082)	(1,540,596)	(1,504,596)	(500,000)	(1,055,865)
<u>\$ (500,000)</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 369,765</u>	<u>\$ (42,514)</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 810,742</u>	<u>\$ (16,252)</u>
\$ 19,221,276	\$ 19,277,934	\$ 19,284,710	\$ 18,256,183	\$ 17,477,196	\$ 15,716,628	\$ 15,939,437
13.57%	10.48%	7.77%	8.44%	8.61%	3.18%	6.62%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF CHANGES IN THE NET OPEB LIABILITY AND RELATED RATIOS
LAST TEN YEARS
December 31, 2024
(Unaudited)

	Year End		
	2024	2023	2022
Total OPEB liability			
Service cost	\$ 220,100	\$ 350,300	\$ 359,500
Interest	363,300	209,100	198,300
Differences between expected and actual experience	1,998,900	(931,400)	788,400
Changes of assumptions or other inputs	251,900	(1,723,800)	230,600
Benefit payments and implicit subsidy credit	(246,700)	(88,300)	(155,100)
Net change in total OPEB liability	2,587,500	(2,184,100)	1,421,700
Total OPEB liability - beginning	8,872,600	11,056,700	9,635,000
Total OPEB liability - ending (a)	\$ 11,460,100	\$ 8,872,600	\$ 11,056,700
Plan fiduciary net position			
Contributions - employer	\$ 246,700	\$ 88,300	\$ 155,100
Benefit payments	(246,700)	(88,300)	(155,100)
Net change in plan fiduciary net position	0	0	0
Plan fiduciary net position - beginning	0	0	0
Plan fiduciary net position - ending (b)	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Net OPEB liability - ending : (a) - (b)	\$ 11,460,100	\$ 8,872,600	\$ 11,056,700
Plan's fiduciary net position as a percentage of the total OPEB liability	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Covered-employee payroll	\$ 12,533,200	\$ 11,933,100	\$ 11,933,100
Net OPEB liability as a percentage of covered-employee payroll	91.44%	74.35%	92.66%

Note: 2018 was the first year of implementation. Therefore, years prior to 2018 are not reported.

Year End

2021	2020	2019	2018
\$ 319,100	\$ 250,600	\$ 280,900	\$ 274,000
265,500	270,100	265,200	252,200
(799,800)	1,379,500	(656,300)	0
608,300	781,200	(284,200)	0
(185,600)	(560,500)	(61,500)	(214,800)
207,500	2,120,900	(455,900)	311,400
9,427,500	7,306,600	7,762,500	7,451,100
<u>\$ 9,635,000</u>	<u>\$ 9,427,500</u>	<u>\$ 7,306,600</u>	<u>\$ 7,762,500</u>
<u>\$ 185,600</u>	<u>\$ 560,500</u>	<u>\$ 61,500</u>	<u>\$ 214,800</u>
(185,600)	(560,500)	(61,500)	(214,800)
0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0
<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>
<u>\$ 9,635,000</u>	<u>\$ 9,427,500</u>	<u>\$ 7,306,600</u>	<u>\$ 7,762,500</u>
0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
\$ 12,908,600	\$ 12,908,600	\$ 13,367,100	\$ 13,367,100
74.64%	73.03%	54.66%	58.07%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE REQUIRED SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION
December 31, 2024

Pension Plan

1. Valuation Date

The actuarially determined contribution rate was determined as of January 1, 2023, with an interest adjustment to the fiscal year.

2. Methods and Assumptions Used to Determine Contribution Rates

Actuarial cost method = Entry Age Normal

Amortization method = Closed level dollar for remaining unfunded liability

Remaining amortization period = Remaining amortization period varies for the bases, with a net effective amortization period of 15 years

Asset valuation method = Market value as of measurement date.

Net investment rate of return = 7.00%

Future salary increases = 5.00% per year with an age based scale

Cost of living adjustments = N/A

Normal retirement age = 65

Mortality = Healthy mortality rates were based on the Pub-2010 Amount Weighted Mortality Table with a blend of 50% of the General Employees Table and 50% of the Public Safety Employees Table with Scale AA to 2023. Disabled rates were derived from a 2024 experience study.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE REQUIRED SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION
December 31, 2024

Pension Plan (continued)

3. Changes in Benefits

None to report.

4. Changes of Assumptions

The mortality improvements for the Pub-2010 Amount Weighted Mortality Table with a blend of 50% of the General Employees Table and 50% of the Public Safety Employees Table is projected to 2023 with Scale AA instead of 2022 with Scale AA.

The adjustment to the base salary increase rate was increased from 1.0% to 1.5% for participants under age 30. The base salary scale was changed from 4.00% to 5.50%. The turnover table was extended to age 60. The disability table was changed to reflect actual disabilities. The retirement rates were updated to reflect actual retirement rates over the past 5 years. 1.0% load was added the active retirement liability to account for unused sick leave and annual leave credited at retirement.

OPEB Plan

1. Valuation Date

The net OPEB liability was measured as of January 1, 2024, and the total OPEB liability used to calculate the net OPEB liability was determined and measured from actuarial valuations using data as of January 1, 2024.

2. Methods and Assumptions Used to Determine Contribution Rates

During measurement period, no assets were accumulated in a trust to pay benefits.

Actuarial cost method = Entry age normal

Amortization method = Closed level dollar for remaining unfunded liability

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE REQUIRED SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION
December 31, 2024

OPEB Plan (continued)

2. Methods and Assumptions Used to Determine Contribution Rates (continued)

Remaining amortization period = Remaining amortization period varies for the bases, with a net effective amortization period of 15 years.

Asset valuation method = Fair value

Discount rate = 3.77%, 4.05% at prior measurement date

Healthcare cost trend rates = Pre-Medicare: 6.50% for 2024 decreasing to an ultimate rate of 5.00% by 2030

Mortality = Mortality rates were based on the RP-2014 Mortality Table, fully generational with base year 2006, projected using 2-dimensional mortality improvement scale MP-2021..

3. Changes in Benefits

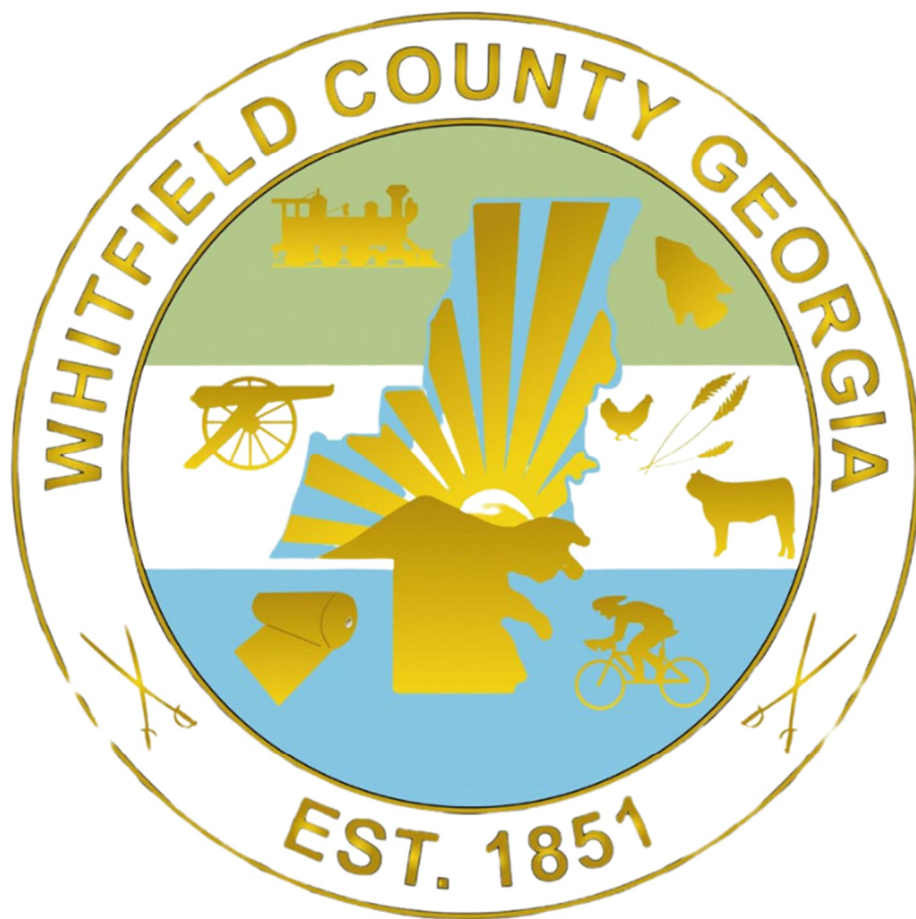
None to report.

4. Changes of Assumptions

The discount rate changed from 4.05% to 3.77%.

The prescription drug and non-Medicare medical trend assumptions were revised to reflect known premium updates in 2024 and future expectations for 2025 and later.

Supplementary Information



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COMBINING STATEMENTS

Nonmajor Governmental Funds

Internal Service Funds

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING BALANCE SHEET
NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
December 31, 2024**

	Special Revenue Funds	Capital Project Funds	Debt Service Fund	Total Nonmajor Governmental Funds
ASSETS				
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 3,122,656	\$ 6,105,529	\$ 2,528	\$ 9,230,713
Receivables				
Accounts	2,001,235	0	0	2,001,235
Intergovernmental	230,842	1,064,088	0	1,294,930
Taxes	398,002	0	0	398,002
Restricted cash and cash equivalents	0	31,412	0	31,412
Total assets	\$ 5,752,735	\$ 7,201,029	\$ 2,528	\$ 12,956,292
LIABILITIES, DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES, AND FUND BALANCES				
Liabilities				
Accounts payable	\$ 70,318	\$ 263,008	\$ 0	\$ 333,326
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	30,496	623	0	31,119
Due to other funds	263,747	357,349	0	621,096
Total liabilities	364,561	620,980	0	985,541
Deferred inflows of resources				
Unavailable revenue:				
Property taxes	104,348	1,024,530	0	1,128,878
Fines and forfeitures	1,648,731	0	0	1,648,731
Total deferred inflows of resources	1,753,079	1,024,530	0	2,777,609
Fund balances				
Restricted				
Judicial	2,134,606	0	0	2,134,606
Public safety	1,032,761	0	0	1,032,761
Housing and development	81,456	0	0	81,456
Capital outlay	0	1,951,638	0	1,951,638
Debt service	0	0	2,528	2,528
Committed				
Capital outlay	0	3,603,881	0	3,603,881
Assigned				
Public works	169,860	0	0	169,860
Culture and recreation	216,412	0	0	216,412
Total fund balances	3,635,095	5,555,519	2,528	9,193,142
Total liabilities, deferred inflows of resources and fund balances	\$ 5,752,735	\$ 7,201,029	\$ 2,528	\$ 12,956,292

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES,
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Special Revenue Funds	Capital Projects Funds	Debt Service Fund	Total Nonmajor Governmental Funds
REVENUES				
Taxes	\$ 741,700	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 741,700
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	730,913	0	0	730,913
Charges for services	2,212,747	0	0	2,212,747
Intergovernmental	824,741	406,832	0	1,231,573
Interest	11,316	66,754	0	78,070
Contributions	409,397	0	0	409,397
Other	79,573	19,614	0	99,187
Total revenues	<u>5,010,387</u>	<u>493,200</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>5,503,587</u>
EXPENDITURES				
Current				
Judicial	760,353	0	0	760,353
Public Safety	3,249,963	0	0	3,249,963
Public Works	521,599	0	0	521,599
Health and Welfare	211,517	0	0	211,517
Housing and Development	580,135	0	0	580,135
Capital outlay	39,998	1,924,347	0	1,964,345
Debt service	0	51,956	0	51,956
Total expenditures	<u>5,363,565</u>	<u>1,976,303</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>7,339,868</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	<u>(353,178)</u>	<u>(1,483,103)</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>(1,836,281)</u>
Other financing sources (uses)				
Transfers in	1,431,510	932,277	0	2,363,787
Transfers out	(59,073)	0	0	(59,073)
Total other financing sources (uses)	<u>1,372,437</u>	<u>932,277</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>2,304,714</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	1,019,259	(550,826)	0	468,433
Fund balances, January 1	<u>2,615,836</u>	<u>6,106,345</u>	<u>2,528</u>	<u>8,724,709</u>
Fund balances, June 30	<u><u>\$ 3,635,095</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 5,555,519</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,528</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 9,193,142</u></u>

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INTERNAL SERVICE FUNDS

These funds are used to account for the accumulation of resources to be used for health and workers' compensation insurance costs, as the County is partially self-insured.

Health Insurance Fund – This fund is used to account for the cost of providing life and health insurance benefits to County employees and participating dependents.

Workers' Compensation Fund – This fund is used to account for workers' compensation insurance provided to the County departments.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
INTERNAL SERVICE FUNDS
December 31, 2024

	Health Insurance Fund	Workers' Compensation Fund	Totals
ASSETS			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 497,587	\$ 2,470,263	\$ 2,967,850
Accounts receivable	174,145	0	174,145
Total current assets	671,732	2,470,263	3,141,995
LIABILITIES			
Current liabilities			
Accounts payable	306,101	46,645	352,746
Claims reserve	276,945	242,892	519,837
Total current liabilities	583,046	289,537	872,583
NET POSITION			
Unrestricted	88,686	2,180,726	2,269,412
Total net position	\$ 88,686	\$ 2,180,726	\$ 2,269,412

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENSES,
AND CHANGES IN NET POSITION
INTERNAL SERVICE FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Health Insurance Fund	Workers' Compensation Fund	Totals
OPERATING REVENUES			
Charges for services	\$ 10,115,946	\$ 848,573	\$ 10,964,519
Other	61,775	25,038	86,813
Total operating revenues	<u>10,177,721</u>	<u>873,611</u>	<u>11,051,332</u>
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Premiums and administrative fees	2,261,975	330,751	2,592,726
Claims paid	7,827,060	0	7,827,060
Total operating expenses	<u>10,089,035</u>	<u>330,751</u>	<u>10,419,786</u>
Change in net position	88,686	542,860	631,546
Net position, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>1,637,866</u>	<u>1,637,866</u>
Net position, December 31	<u><u>\$ 88,686</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,180,726</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,269,412</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Health Insurance Fund	Workers' Compensation Fund	Totals
Cash flows from operating activities:			
Receipts from interfund services provided	\$ 9,965,433	\$ 848,573	\$ 10,814,006
Payments to suppliers	(9,955,125)	(364,028)	(10,319,153)
Other receipts	61,775	25,038	86,813
Net increase (decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	72,083	509,583	581,666
Cash and cash equivalents, January 1	425,504	1,960,680	2,386,184
Cash and cash equivalents, December 31	\$ 497,587	\$ 2,470,263	\$ 2,967,850
Reconciliation of operating income (loss) to net cash provided (used) by operating activities:			
Operating income (loss)	\$ 88,686	\$ 542,860	\$ 631,546
Adjustments to reconcile operating income to net cash provided (used) by operating activities			
(Increase) decrease in accounts receivable	(150,513)	0	(150,513)
Increase (decrease) in accounts payable	250,680	23,726	274,406
Increase (decrease) in claims reserve	(116,770)	(57,003)	(173,773)
Total adjustments	(16,603)	(33,277)	(49,880)
Net cash provided (used) by operating activities	\$ 72,083	\$ 509,583	\$ 581,666

NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS

SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS

Special revenue funds are used to account for the proceeds of specific revenue sources that are legally or donor restricted to expenditure for specified purposes.

Law Library Fund – This fund is used to account for fees received from County Courts and used to finance the Law Library's operation and purchase of reference materials.

District Attorney Forfeiture Fund – This fund is used to account for monies confiscated under Federal and Georgia law by the Whitfield County District Attorney's Office related to controlled substances offenses. Such monies are restricted to defray the cost of complex investigations and to purchase equipment relating to said investigations.

Sheriff Forfeiture Fund – This fund is used to account for monies confiscated under Federal and Georgia law by the Whitfield County Sheriff's Office related to controlled substances offenses. Such monies are restricted to defray the cost of complex investigations and to purchase equipment relating to said investigations.

National Opioid Settlement Fund – This fund is used to account for the County's share of opioid settlement payment funds that are restricted for opioid remediation efforts.

Emergency 911 Fund – This fund is used to account for monies collected under Georgia law by the telephone company on behalf of Whitfield County. These monies are remitted to the County and are restricted to providing emergency 911 services to the residents of the County.

Whitfield County Neighborhood Stabilization Fund – This fund is used support efforts aimed at revitalizing and stabilizing neighborhoods that are experience economic decline, blight, or high rates of foreclosures.

Conasauga A.D.R. Fund – This fund is used to support programs and services that promote alternative methods of resolving disputes outside of traditional courtroom litigation.

Divorce Seminar Fund – This fund is used to provide financial support for educational seminars and programs designed to assist individuals going through a divorce.

Juvenile Services Fund – This fund is used to account for monies collected under Georgia law for probational services to juvenile offenders. Such monies are restricted to providing treatment to juvenile offenders.

Local Victim Assistance Program Fund – This fund is used to support services and resources for victims of crime within the County.

Drug Abuse Treatment and Education Fund – This fund is used to account for monies collected under Georgia law related to additional penalties on controlled substance offenses. Such monies are restricted for drug abuse treatment and education programs relating to controlled substances, alcohol, marijuana, and the purposes of the County's Drug Court.

Community Housing Improvement Program Fund – This fund is used to support the improvement, rehabilitation, and development of affordable housing in the community.

Felony Domestic Violence Grant Fund – This fund is used to provide financial support for programs and services aimed at addressing and preventing felony-level domestic violence offenses.

Accountability Courts Grant Program Fund – This fund is used to provide financial support for programs and services that create, expand, or sustain accountability courts aimed at reducing recidivism and promoting rehabilitation among individuals involved in the criminal justice system.

SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS, continued

Jointly Funded District Fund – This fund is used to account for property tax revenue generated through the levy of a special millage for the purposes of library and senior center improvements.

Solid Waste District Fund – This fund is used to account for property tax revenue generated through the levy of an sanitation millage for the purposes of advancing sanitation improvements within the County.

Hotel Motel Tax Fund – This fund is used to account for Hotel/Motel tax collections that are restricted for tourism in Whitfield County.

CAPITAL PROJECTS FUNDS

Capital Project Funds are used to account for financial resources to be used for the acquisition or construction of specifically planned projects (other than those financed by proprietary funds).

Capital Acquisition Fund – This fund is used to account for County capital projects.

JDA Project Fund – This fund is used to account for property tax revenue generated through the levy of an economic development millage for the purposes of advancing economic development improvements within the County.

2008 Special Purpose Local Option Sales Tax Fund – This fund is used to account for the proceeds of a 1 percent local option sales tax approved in 2008 for a period of time not to exceed six years for the purpose of financing long-term projects.

2015 Special Purpose Local Option Sales Tax Fund – This fund is used to account for the proceeds of a 1 percent local option sales tax approved in 2015 for a period of time not to exceed six years for the purpose of financing long-term projects.

DEBT SERVICE FUND

Debt service funds are used to account for the accumulation of resources and payment of general government long-term debt principal and interest from governmental resources.

Debt Service Fund – This fund is used to retire bond principal and to pay interest on general obligation bonds.

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING BALANCE SHEET
NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS
December 31, 2024

	Law Library	District Attorney Forfeiture	Sheriff Forfeiture	Opioid Settlement Payments	E911	Whitfield County Neighborhood Stabilization	Conasauga A.D.R. Program	Divorce Seminar
ASSETS								
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 111,293	\$ 23,282	\$ 174,628	\$ 328,077	\$ 216,772	\$ 90,056	\$ 507,215	\$ 14,623
Receivables								
Accounts	0	0	0	1,648,731	352,504	0	0	0
Intergovernmental	0	0	0	5,309	0	0	0	0
Taxes	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total assets	\$ 111,293	\$ 23,282	\$ 174,628	\$ 1,982,117	\$ 569,276	\$ 90,056	\$ 507,215	\$ 14,623
LIABILITIES, DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES, AND FUND BALANCES								
Liabilities								
Accounts payable	\$ 0	\$ 1,993	\$ 0	\$ 1,712	\$ 16,689	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	0	0	0	2,270	23,858	0	0	0
Due to other funds	0	0	0	0	0	8,600	0	0
Total liabilities	0	1,993	0	3,982	40,547	8,600	0	0
Deferred inflows of resources								
Unavailable revenues:								
Property taxes	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Fines and forfeitures	0	0	0	1,648,731	0	0	0	0
Total deferred inflows of resources	0	0	0	1,648,731	0	0	0	0
Fund balances								
Restricted								
Judicial	111,293	21,289	0	0	0	0	507,215	14,623
Public safety	0	0	174,628	329,404	528,729	0	0	0
Housing and development	0	0	0	0	0	81,456	0	0
Assigned								
Public works	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Culture and recreation	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total fund balances	111,293	21,289	174,628	329,404	528,729	81,456	507,215	14,623
Total liabilities, deferred inflows of resources and fund balances	\$ 111,293	\$ 23,282	\$ 174,628	\$ 1,982,117	\$ 569,276	\$ 90,056	\$ 507,215	\$ 14,623

Juvenile Service	Local Victim Assistance Program	Drug Abuse Treatment and Education	Community Housing Improvements Program	Felony Domestic Violence Grant	Accountability Courts Grant Program	Jointly Funded District	Solid Waste District	Hotel Motel Tax	Total Nonmajor Special Revenue Governmental Funds
\$ 127,412	\$ 3,114	\$ 582,449	\$ 10	\$ 0	\$ 648,349	\$ 215,633	\$ 79,743	\$ 0	\$ 3,122,656
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2,001,235
0	2,739	3,609	0	43,984	156,364	0	18,837	0	230,842
0	0	0	0	0	0	4,037	388,649	5,316	398,002
<u>\$ 127,412</u>	<u>\$ 5,853</u>	<u>\$ 586,058</u>	<u>\$ 10</u>	<u>\$ 43,984</u>	<u>\$ 804,713</u>	<u>\$ 219,670</u>	<u>\$ 487,229</u>	<u>\$ 5,316</u>	<u>\$ 5,752,735</u>
\$ 477	\$ 3,441	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 43,977	\$ 2,029	\$ 70,318
0	0	1,018	0	842	2,508	0	0	0	30,496
0	2,412	0	10	6,204	70,932	0	172,302	3,287	263,747
<u>477</u>	<u>5,853</u>	<u>1,018</u>	<u>10</u>	<u>7,046</u>	<u>73,440</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>216,279</u>	<u>5,316</u>	<u>364,561</u>
0	0	0	0	0	0	3,258	101,090	0	104,348
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1,648,731
0	0	0	0	0	0	3,258	101,090	0	1,753,079
126,935	0	585,040	0	36,938	731,273	0	0	0	2,134,606
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1,032,761
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	81,456
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	169,860	0	169,860
0	0	0	0	0	0	216,412	0	0	216,412
<u>126,935</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>585,040</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>36,938</u>	<u>731,273</u>	<u>216,412</u>	<u>169,860</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>3,635,095</u>
<u>\$ 127,412</u>	<u>\$ 5,853</u>	<u>\$ 586,058</u>	<u>\$ 10</u>	<u>\$ 43,984</u>	<u>\$ 804,713</u>	<u>\$ 219,670</u>	<u>\$ 487,229</u>	<u>\$ 5,316</u>	<u>\$ 5,752,735</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES,
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Law Library	District Attorney Forfeiture	Sheriff Forfeiture	Opioid Settlement Payments	E911	Whitfield County Neighborhood Stabilization	Conasauga A.D.R. Program	Divorce Seminar
REVENUES								
Taxes	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 1,315	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	34,428	18,004	77,004	333,719	0	0	0	0
Charges for services	0	0	0	0	2,138,978	0	63,042	0
Intergovernmental	0	0	0	0	0	104,021	0	0
Interest	6	0	251	0	0	0	1,871	0
Contributions	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Other	1,509	0	0	56,722	8,988	0	0	0
Total revenues	35,943	18,004	77,255	390,441	2,149,281	104,021	64,913	0
EXPENDITURES								
Current								
Judicial	31,956	9,709	0	0	0	0	34,393	0
Public Safety	0	0	39,434	28,746	3,181,783	0	0	0
Public Works	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Health and Welfare	0	0	0	211,517	0	0	0	0
Housing and Development	0	0	0	0	0	106,183	0	0
Capital outlay	0	0	39,998	0	0	0	0	0
Total expenditures	31,956	9,709	79,432	240,263	3,181,783	106,183	34,393	0
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	<u>3,987</u>	<u>8,295</u>	<u>(2,177)</u>	<u>150,178</u>	<u>(1,032,502)</u>	<u>(2,162)</u>	<u>30,520</u>	<u>0</u>
Other financing sources (uses)								
Transfers in	0	0	0	0	1,363,337	0	0	0
Transfers out	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Total other financing sources (uses)	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>1,363,337</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	<u>3,987</u>	<u>8,295</u>	<u>(2,177)</u>	<u>150,178</u>	<u>330,835</u>	<u>(2,162)</u>	<u>30,520</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, January 1	<u>107,306</u>	<u>12,994</u>	<u>176,805</u>	<u>179,226</u>	<u>197,894</u>	<u>83,618</u>	<u>476,695</u>	<u>14,623</u>
Fund balances, June 30	<u>\$ 111,293</u>	<u>\$ 21,289</u>	<u>\$ 174,628</u>	<u>\$ 329,404</u>	<u>\$ 528,729</u>	<u>\$ 81,456</u>	<u>\$ 507,215</u>	<u>\$ 14,623</u>

Juvenile Service	Local Victim Assistance Program	Drug Abuse Treatment and Education	Community Housing Improvements Program	Felony Domestic Violence Grant	Accountability Courts Grant Program	Jointly Funded District	Solid Waste District	Hotel Motel Tax	Total Nonmajor Special Revenue Governmental Funds
\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 12,050	\$ 550,104	\$ 178,231	\$ 741,700
0	84,390	143,147	0	0	40,221	0	0	0	730,913
10,652	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	75	2,212,747
0	0	0	287,871	73,730	359,119	0	0	0	824,741
0	0	0	0	0	9,188	0	0	0	11,316
0	0	0	0	0	409,397	0	0	0	409,397
0	0	0	0	0	12,354	0	0	0	79,573
10,652	84,390	143,147	287,871	73,730	830,279	12,050	550,104	178,306	5,010,387
7,774	25,317	153,797	0	140,567	356,840	0	0	0	760,353
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3,249,963
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	521,599	0	521,599
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	211,517
0	0	0	295,646	0	0	0	0	178,306	580,135
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	39,998
7,774	25,317	153,797	295,646	140,567	356,840	0	521,599	178,306	5,363,565
2,878	59,073	(10,650)	(7,775)	(66,837)	473,439	12,050	28,505	0	(353,178)
0	0	0	7,775	60,398	0	0	0	0	1,431,510
0	(59,073)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	(59,073)
0	(59,073)	0	7,775	60,398	0	0	0	0	1,372,437
2,878	0	(10,650)	0	(6,439)	473,439	12,050	28,505	0	1,019,259
124,057	0	595,690	0	43,377	257,834	204,362	141,355	0	2,615,836
\$ 126,935	\$ 0	\$ 585,040	\$ 0	\$ 36,938	\$ 731,273	\$ 216,412	\$ 169,860	\$ 0	\$ 3,635,095

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
GOVERNMENTAL LAW LIBRARY
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 34,428	\$ 34,428	\$ 0
Interest	6	6	0
Other	1,200	1,509	309
	<u>35,634</u>	<u>35,943</u>	<u>309</u>
Total revenues	<u>35,634</u>	<u>35,943</u>	<u>309</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	35,634	31,956	3,678
	<u>35,634</u>	<u>31,956</u>	<u>3,678</u>
Total expenditures	<u>35,634</u>	<u>31,956</u>	<u>3,678</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	3,987	3,987
Fund balance, January 1	0	107,306	107,306
Fund balances, December 31	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 111,293</u>	<u>\$ 111,293</u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S FORFEITURE
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 15,000	\$ 18,004	\$ 3,004
Total revenues	<u>15,000</u>	<u>18,004</u>	<u>3,004</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>15,000</u>	<u>9,709</u>	<u>5,291</u>
Total expenditures	<u>15,000</u>	<u>9,709</u>	<u>5,291</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	8,295	8,295
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>12,994</u>	<u>12,994</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 21,289</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 21,289</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SHERIFF'S FORFEITURE
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 77,004	\$ 77,004	\$ 0
Interest	<u>250</u>	<u>251</u>	<u>1</u>
Total revenues	<u>77,254</u>	<u>77,255</u>	<u>1</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Public Safety	29,334	39,434	(10,100)
Capital outlay	<u>50,100</u>	<u>39,998</u>	<u>10,102</u>
Total expenditures	<u>79,434</u>	<u>79,432</u>	<u>2</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(2,180)	(2,177)	3
Fund balances, January 1	<u>2,180</u>	<u>176,805</u>	<u>174,625</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 174,628</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 174,628</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
OPIOID SETTLEMENT PAYMENTS
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 252,472	\$ 333,719	\$ 81,247
Other	<u>0</u>	<u>56,722</u>	<u>56,722</u>
Total revenues	<u>252,472</u>	<u>390,441</u>	<u>137,969</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Public Safety	28,746	28,746	0
Health and Welfare	<u>223,726</u>	<u>211,517</u>	<u>12,209</u>
Total expenditures	<u>252,472</u>	<u>240,263</u>	<u>12,209</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	150,178	150,178
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>179,226</u>	<u>179,226</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 329,404</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 329,404</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
EMERGENCY 911 SYSTEM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 0	\$ 1,315	\$ 1,315
Charges for services	2,002,319	2,138,978	136,659
Other	8,990	8,988	(2)
Total revenues	<u>2,011,309</u>	<u>2,149,281</u>	<u>137,972</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Public Safety	<u>3,374,646</u>	<u>3,181,783</u>	<u>192,863</u>
Total expenditures	<u>3,374,646</u>	<u>3,181,783</u>	<u>192,863</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(1,363,337)	(1,032,502)	330,835
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in (out)	<u>1,363,337</u>	<u>1,363,337</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	0	330,835	330,835
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>197,894</u>	<u>197,894</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 528,729</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 528,729</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
WHITFIELD COUNTY NEIGHBORHOOD STABILIZATION PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Intergovernmental	\$ 104,021	\$ 104,021	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>104,021</u>	<u>104,021</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Housing and Development	<u>106,183</u>	<u>106,183</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>106,183</u>	<u>106,183</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(2,162)	(2,162)	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>2,162</u>	<u>83,618</u>	<u>81,456</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 81,456</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 81,456</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CONASAUGA ADR PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Charges for services	\$ 56,472	\$ 63,042	\$ 6,570
Interest	<u>600</u>	<u>1,871</u>	<u>1,271</u>
Total revenues	<u>57,072</u>	<u>64,913</u>	<u>7,841</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>43,940</u>	<u>34,393</u>	<u>9,547</u>
Total expenditures	<u>43,940</u>	<u>34,393</u>	<u>9,547</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	13,132	30,520	17,388
Fund balances, January 1	<u>(13,132)</u>	<u>476,695</u>	<u>489,827</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 507,215</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 507,215</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DIVORCE SEMINAR
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>14,623</u>	<u>14,623</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 14,623</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 14,623</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
JUVENILE SERVICE
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Charges for services	\$ 10,652	\$ 10,652	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>10,652</u>	<u>10,652</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>10,652</u>	<u>7,774</u>	<u>2,878</u>
Total expenditures	<u>10,652</u>	<u>7,774</u>	<u>2,878</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	2,878	2,878
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>124,057</u>	<u>124,057</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 126,935</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 126,935</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
LOCAL VICTIMS ASSISTANCE PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 84,390	\$ 84,390	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>84,390</u>	<u>84,390</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>25,317</u>	<u>25,317</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>25,317</u>	<u>25,317</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	59,073	59,073	0
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in (out)	<u>(59,073)</u>	<u>(59,073)</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DRUG ABUSE TREATMENT AND EDUCATION
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 143,147	\$ 143,147	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>143,147</u>	<u>143,147</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>153,797</u>	<u>153,797</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>153,797</u>	<u>153,797</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(10,650)	(10,650)	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>10,650</u>	<u>595,690</u>	<u>585,040</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 585,040</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 585,040</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMMUNITY HOUSING IMPROVEMENTS PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Intergovernmental	\$ 287,871	\$ 287,871	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>287,871</u>	<u>287,871</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Housing and Development	<u>295,646</u>	<u>295,646</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>295,646</u>	<u>295,646</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(7,775)	(7,775)	0
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in (out)	<u>7,775</u>	<u>7,775</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FELONY DOMESTIC VIOLENCE COURT
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Intergovernmental	\$ 73,730	\$ 73,730	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>73,730</u>	<u>73,730</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>140,578</u>	<u>140,567</u>	<u>11</u>
Total expenditures	<u>140,578</u>	<u>140,567</u>	<u>11</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(66,848)	(66,837)	11
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in (out)			
American Rescue Plan Act	<u>60,398</u>	<u>60,398</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	(6,450)	(6,439)	11
Fund balances, January 1	<u>6,450</u>	<u>43,377</u>	<u>36,927</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 36,938</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 36,938</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
ACCOUNTABILITY COURTS
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines and forfeitures	\$ 40,220	\$ 40,221	\$ 1
Intergovernmental	359,119	359,119	0
Interest	9,188	9,188	0
Contributions	0	409,397	409,397
Other	12,354	12,354	0
Total revenues	<u>420,881</u>	<u>830,279</u>	<u>409,398</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>420,881</u>	<u>356,840</u>	<u>64,041</u>
Total expenditures	<u>420,881</u>	<u>356,840</u>	<u>64,041</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	473,439	473,439
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>257,834</u>	<u>257,834</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 731,273</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 731,273</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
JOINTLY FUNDED DISTRICT
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 0	\$ 12,050	\$ 12,050
Total revenues	<u>0</u>	<u>12,050</u>	<u>12,050</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	12,050	12,050
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>204,362</u>	<u>204,362</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 216,412</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 216,412</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SOLID WASTE DISTRICT
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 521,599	\$ 550,104	\$ 28,505
Total revenues	<u>521,599</u>	<u>550,104</u>	<u>28,505</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Public Works	<u>521,599</u>	<u>521,599</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>521,599</u>	<u>521,599</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	28,505	28,505
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>141,355</u>	<u>141,355</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 169,860</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 169,860</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
HOTEL/MOTEL TAX
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 178,231	\$ 178,231	\$ 0
Charges for services	<u>75</u>	<u>75</u>	<u>0</u>
Total revenues	<u>178,306</u>	<u>178,306</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Housing and Development	<u>178,306</u>	<u>178,306</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>178,306</u>	<u>178,306</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING BALANCE SHEET
NONMAJOR CAPITAL PROJECT FUNDS
December 31, 2024

	Capital Acquisition	JDA Project	2008 SPLOST	2015 SPLOST	Total Nonmajor Capital Projects Funds
ASSETS					
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 363,764	\$ 3,463,567	\$ 1,186,185	\$ 1,092,013	\$ 6,105,529
Intergovernmental receivable	39,558	1,024,530	0	0	1,064,088
Restricted cash and cash equivalents	31,412	0	0	0	31,412
Total assets	<u>\$ 434,734</u>	<u>\$ 4,488,097</u>	<u>\$ 1,186,185</u>	<u>\$ 1,092,013</u>	<u>\$ 7,201,029</u>
LIABILITIES, DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES, AND FUND BALANCES					
Liabilities					
Accounts payable	\$ 263,008	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 263,008
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	0	0	623	0	623
Due to other funds	0	0	357,349	0	357,349
Total liabilities	<u>263,008</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>357,972</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>620,980</u>
Deferred inflows of resources					
Unavailable revenue - property taxes	<u>0</u>	<u>1,024,530</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>1,024,530</u>
Fund balances					
Restricted:					
Capital outlay	31,412	0	828,213	1,092,013	1,951,638
Committed:					
Capital outlay	<u>140,314</u>	<u>3,463,567</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>3,603,881</u>
Total fund balances	<u>171,726</u>	<u>3,463,567</u>	<u>828,213</u>	<u>1,092,013</u>	<u>5,555,519</u>
Total liabilities, deferred inflows of resources and fund balances	<u>\$ 434,734</u>	<u>\$ 4,488,097</u>	<u>\$ 1,186,185</u>	<u>\$ 1,092,013</u>	<u>\$ 7,201,029</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES,
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
NONMAJOR CAPITAL PROJECT FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Capital Acquisition	JDA Project	2008 SPLOST	2015 SPLOST	Total Nonmajor Capital Projects Funds
REVENUES					
Intergovernmental	\$ 406,832	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 406,832
Interest	0	0	36,574	30,180	66,754
Other	0	19,614	0	0	19,614
Total revenues	<u>406,832</u>	<u>19,614</u>	<u>36,574</u>	<u>30,180</u>	<u>493,200</u>
EXPENDITURES					
Capital outlay	1,360,922	0	561,920	1,505	1,924,347
Debt service	0	51,956	0	0	51,956
Total expenditures	<u>1,360,922</u>	<u>51,956</u>	<u>561,920</u>	<u>1,505</u>	<u>1,976,303</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(954,090)	(32,342)	(525,346)	28,675	(1,483,103)
Other financing sources (uses)					
Transfers in	<u>880,321</u>	<u>51,956</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>932,277</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	(73,769)	19,614	(525,346)	28,675	(550,826)
Fund balances, January 1	<u>245,495</u>	<u>3,443,953</u>	<u>1,353,559</u>	<u>1,063,338</u>	<u>6,106,345</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 171,726</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 3,463,567</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 828,213</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 1,092,013</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 5,555,519</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DEBT SERVICE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
EXPENDITURES	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>2,528</u>	<u>2,528</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,528</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,528</u></u>

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CUSTODIAL FUNDS

These funds are used to account for assets held by the County as a custodian to be expended in accordance with the conditions of its custodial capacity.

Tax Commissioner - This fund accounts for assets and related liabilities for the collection of taxes and tag and title fees.

Clerk of Superior Court, Probate Court, Juvenile Court, and Magistrate Court - These funds account for assets and related liabilities for the collection of court related fees.

Sheriff Department - This fund accounts for deposits held for incarcerated inmates.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CUSTODIAL FUNDS
STATEMENT OF FIDUCIARY NET POSITION
December 31, 2024

	<u>Tax Commissioner</u>	<u>Clerk of Superior Court</u>	<u>Sheriff</u>	<u>Probate Court</u>	<u>Magistrate Court</u>	<u>Juvenile Court</u>	<u>Total Custodial Funds</u>
ASSETS							
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 15,544,608	\$ 257,977	\$ 324,203	\$ 93,452	\$ 81,503	\$ 6,399	\$ 16,308,142
Taxes receivable	<u>65,569,109</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>65,569,109</u>
Total assets	<u>81,113,717</u>	<u>257,977</u>	<u>324,203</u>	<u>93,452</u>	<u>81,503</u>	<u>6,399</u>	<u>81,877,251</u>
LIABILITIES							
Due to others	<u>80,466,943</u>	<u>157,784</u>	<u>44,885</u>	<u>45,709</u>	<u>75,200</u>	<u>6,399</u>	<u>80,796,920</u>
NET POSITION							
Restricted for individuals, organizations, and other governments	<u>\$ 646,774</u>	<u>\$ 100,193</u>	<u>\$ 279,318</u>	<u>\$ 47,743</u>	<u>\$ 6,303</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 1,080,331</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CUSTODIAL FUNDS
STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN FIDUCIARY NET POSITION
For the year ended December 31, 2024

	Tax Commissioner	Clerk of Superior Court	Sheriff	Probate Court	Magistrate Court	Juvenile Court	Total Custodial Funds
ADDITIONS							
Taxes collected for other agencies	\$ 120,137,593	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 120,137,593
Court fees collected for other agencies	0	4,927,447	0	384,805	972,826	0	6,285,078
Court individual cases	0	2,047,190	0	222,411	17,358	22,045	2,309,004
Sheriff fees collected	0	0	200,692	0	0	0	200,692
Sheriff inmate account deposits	0	0	1,297,504	0	0	0	1,297,504
Total additions	120,137,593	6,974,637	1,498,196	607,216	990,184	22,045	130,229,871
DEDUCTIONS							
Taxes distributed to other agencies	119,979,374	0	0	0	0	0	119,979,374
Court fees distributed to other agencies	0	4,927,447	0	317,051	971,100	22,045	6,237,643
Payments to others	0	2,069,494	0	242,422	20,538	0	2,332,454
Sheriff fees distributed to other agencies	0	0	138,258	0	0	0	138,258
Payments from inmates to others	0	0	1,287,693	0	0	0	1,287,693
Total deductions	119,979,374	6,996,941	1,425,951	559,473	991,638	22,045	129,975,422
Change in net position	158,219	(22,304)	72,245	47,743	(1,454)	0	254,449
Net position, January 1	488,555	122,497	207,073	0	7,757	0	825,882
Net position, December 31	\$ 646,774	\$ 100,193	\$ 279,318	\$ 47,743	\$ 6,303	\$ 0	\$ 1,080,331

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Part III

Statistical Section



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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

Introduction to the Statistical Section (UNAUDITED)

The contents of the statistical section of the annual comprehensive financial report presents information regarding financial trends, revenue capacity, debt service and debt capacity, demographic and economic information and operating information.

Financial Trends.....	124-131
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These schedules should help the reader understand how the County's financial performance and well-being have changed over time.

Revenue Capacity.....	132-137
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These schedules contain information in order for the reader to assess the County's most significant revenue sources.

Debt Capacity.....	138-141
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These schedules contain information in order for the reader to assess the affordability of the County's current levels of outstanding debt and the ability for the County to issue additional debt in the future.

Demographic and Economic Information.....	142-143
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These schedules offer demographic and economic indicators to help the reader understand the environment within which the County's financial activities take place.

Operating Information.....	144-146
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These schedules contain service and infrastructure data to help the reader understand how the information in the County's financial report relates to the services the County provides and the activities it performs.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NET POSITION BY COMPONENT
LAST TEN YEARS

	<u>2024</u>	<u>2023</u>	<u>2022</u>	<u>2021</u>
Governmental activities				
Net investment in capital assets	\$ 214,890,988	\$ 209,697,143	\$ 205,037,958	\$ 199,289,800
Restricted	15,631,120	16,757,836	15,757,850	19,459,446
Unrestricted	<u>20,778,719</u>	<u>25,681,294</u>	<u>27,341,968</u>	<u>15,333,560</u>
Total governmental activities net position	<u>\$ 251,300,827</u>	<u>\$ 252,136,273</u>	<u>\$ 248,137,776</u>	<u>\$ 234,082,806</u>
Business-type activities				
Net investment in capital assets	\$ 62,634	\$ 89,104	\$ 124,126	\$ 177,959
Unrestricted	<u>15,810,288</u>	<u>16,828,895</u>	<u>19,569,567</u>	<u>18,513,942</u>
Total business-type activities net position	<u>\$ 15,872,922</u>	<u>\$ 16,917,999</u>	<u>\$ 19,693,693</u>	<u>\$ 18,691,901</u>
Primary government				
Net investment in capital assets	\$ 214,953,622	\$ 209,786,247	\$ 205,162,084	\$ 199,467,759
Restricted	15,631,120	16,757,836	15,757,850	19,459,446
Unrestricted	<u>36,589,007</u>	<u>42,510,189</u>	<u>46,911,535</u>	<u>33,847,502</u>
Total primary government net position	<u>\$ 267,173,749</u>	<u>\$ 269,054,272</u>	<u>\$ 267,831,469</u>	<u>\$ 252,774,707</u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NET POSITION BY COMPONENT
LAST TEN YEARS**

<u>2020</u>	<u>2019</u>	<u>2018</u>	<u>2017 - Restated</u>	<u>2016</u>	<u>2015</u>
\$ 174,460,330	\$ 194,165,355	\$ 210,051,630	\$ 225,843,608	\$ 237,951,877	\$ 225,710,706
37,914,589	17,984,043	21,170,375	16,412,612	23,879,901	34,314,997
15,452,050	15,992,924	10,765,984	9,938,504	(4,685,019)	7,839,847
<u>\$ 227,826,969</u>	<u>\$ 228,142,322</u>	<u>\$ 241,987,989</u>	<u>\$ 252,194,724</u>	<u>\$ 257,146,759</u>	<u>\$ 267,865,550</u>
\$ 129,211	\$ 215,677	\$ 261,751	\$ 211,536	\$ 161,927	\$ 252,587
16,973,807	18,442,054	16,577,913	16,310,985	15,596,297	14,750,860
<u>\$ 17,103,018</u>	<u>\$ 18,657,731</u>	<u>\$ 16,839,664</u>	<u>\$ 16,522,521</u>	<u>\$ 15,758,224</u>	<u>\$ 15,003,447</u>
\$ 174,589,541	\$ 194,381,032	\$ 210,313,381	\$ 226,055,144	\$ 238,113,804	\$ 225,963,293
37,914,589	17,984,043	21,170,375	16,412,612	23,879,901	34,314,997
32,425,857	34,434,978	27,343,897	26,249,489	10,911,278	22,590,707
<u>\$ 244,929,987</u>	<u>\$ 246,800,053</u>	<u>\$ 258,827,653</u>	<u>\$ 268,717,245</u>	<u>\$ 272,904,983</u>	<u>\$ 282,868,997</u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CHANGES IN NET POSITION
LAST TEN YEARS**

	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020
Expenses					
Governmental activities:					
General government	\$ 15,116,378	\$ 11,853,842	\$ 9,529,580	\$ 9,872,837	\$ 10,413,798
Judicial	9,774,672	9,890,084	8,923,762	8,724,385	8,177,965
Public safety	45,281,174	44,297,001	35,116,805	38,017,889	34,718,647
Public works	28,375,351	24,592,195	24,201,335	22,000,769	14,857,237
Health and welfare	1,270,711	3,841,823	1,201,978	582,415	541,984
Culture and recreation	3,960,102	3,898,447	2,838,383	1,979,171	1,827,612
Housing and development	4,096,847	4,002,331	3,135,229	2,903,608	3,746,930
Interest on long-term debt	90,957	166,236	242,298	318,286	522,205
Total governmental activities expenses	<u>\$ 107,966,192</u>	<u>\$ 102,541,959</u>	<u>\$ 85,189,370</u>	<u>\$ 84,399,360</u>	<u>\$ 74,806,378</u>
Business-type activities:					
Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	\$ 76,043	\$ 144,241	\$ 121,079	\$ 177,176	\$ 251,053
Whitfield Transit System	858,552	697,021	622,879	573,655	709,240
Dalton-Whitfield SWM Authority	1,008,535	2,633,927	(1,039,695)	(1,646,502)	1,298,396
Total business-type activities expenses	<u>1,943,130</u>	<u>3,475,189</u>	<u>(295,737)</u>	<u>(895,671)</u>	<u>2,258,689</u>
Total primary government expenses	<u>\$ 109,909,322</u>	<u>\$ 106,017,148</u>	<u>\$ 84,893,633</u>	<u>\$ 83,503,689</u>	<u>\$ 77,065,067</u>
Program Revenues					
Governmental activities:					
Charge for services:					
General government	\$ 5,474,980	\$ 2,347,549	\$ 1,242,705	\$ 1,646,471	\$ 1,555,888
Judicial	1,990,283	2,235,146	2,133,588	2,074,654	1,962,345
Public safety	3,409,632	3,817,610	3,975,839	3,455,182	3,406,440
Public works	1,194,489	374,250	247,032	233,049	228,070
Health and welfare	44,801	-	-	-	-
Culture and recreation	446,545	467,089	323,054	248,917	121,287
Housing and development	17,385	1,348,616	781,289	830,065	448,921
Operating grants and contributions	8,079,097	13,882,307	8,878,506	6,642,347	6,978,791
Capital grants and contributions	3,334,542	3,733,255	1,130,064	2,284,460	3,224,402
Total governmental activities program revenues	<u>\$ 23,991,754</u>	<u>\$ 28,205,822</u>	<u>\$ 18,712,077</u>	<u>\$ 17,415,145</u>	<u>\$ 17,926,144</u>
Business-type activities:					
Charge for services:					
Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Whitfield Transit System	262,551	318,420	171,619	86,229	64,957
Dalton-Whitfield SWM Authority	-	-	-	-	-
Operating grants and contributions	563,715	381,075	274,744	500,025	595,387
Capital grants and contributions	-	-	-	-	-
Total business-type activities program revenues	<u>\$ 826,266</u>	<u>\$ 699,495</u>	<u>\$ 446,363</u>	<u>\$ 586,254</u>	<u>\$ 660,344</u>
Total primary government program revenues	<u>\$ 24,818,020</u>	<u>\$ 28,905,317</u>	<u>\$ 19,158,440</u>	<u>\$ 18,001,399</u>	<u>\$ 18,586,488</u>
Net (Expense)/ Revenue					
Governmental activities	\$ (83,974,438)	\$ (74,336,137)	\$ (66,477,293)	\$ (66,984,215)	\$ (56,880,234)
Business-type activities	(1,116,864)	(2,775,694)	742,100	1,481,925	(1,598,345)
Total primary government net (expense)/ revenue	<u>\$ (85,091,302)</u>	<u>\$ (77,111,831)</u>	<u>\$ (65,735,193)</u>	<u>\$ (65,502,290)</u>	<u>\$ (58,478,579)</u>
General revenues and Other Changes in Net Position					
Governmental activities:					
Property taxes	\$ 32,119,003	\$ 31,725,127	\$ 35,064,617	\$ 32,243,964	\$ 31,611,939
Sales taxes	40,550,126	41,141,493	38,799,488	34,483,662	18,423,324
Insurance premium tax	5,632,927	5,295,852	4,888,585	5,022,222	4,838,448
Alcoholic beverage tax	400,551	401,523	422,523	427,652	439,003
Hotel/Motel tax	178,231	225,585	225,692	213,264	137,042
Miscellaneous taxes	790,075	586,878	778,827	587,470	576,690
Miscellaneous	2,142,634	422,319	257,827	233,712	454,190
Gain or (loss) on sale of capital assets	165,723	48,907	79,498	123,142	31,464
Investment earnings	1,408,079	1,626,195	274,898	11,923	78,421
Transfers	-	-	(259,692)	(106,959)	(43,631)
Total governmental activities	<u>\$ 83,387,349</u>	<u>\$ 81,473,879</u>	<u>\$ 80,532,263</u>	<u>\$ 73,240,052</u>	<u>\$ 56,546,890</u>
Business-type activities:					
Transfers	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 259,692	\$ 106,959	\$ 43,631
Total primary government	<u>\$ 83,387,349</u>	<u>\$ 81,473,879</u>	<u>\$ 80,791,955</u>	<u>\$ 73,347,011</u>	<u>\$ 56,590,521</u>
Change in Net Position					
Governmental activities	\$ (587,089)	\$ 7,137,742	\$ 14,054,970	\$ 6,255,837	\$ (333,344)
Business-type activities	(1,116,864)	(2,775,694)	1,001,792	1,588,884	(1,554,714)
Total primary government	<u>\$ (1,703,953)</u>	<u>\$ 4,362,048</u>	<u>\$ 15,056,762</u>	<u>\$ 7,844,721</u>	<u>\$ (1,888,058)</u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CHANGES IN NET POSITION
LAST TEN YEARS**

	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
Expenses					
Governmental activities:					
General government	\$ 10,161,993	\$ 9,877,894	\$ 9,442,567	\$ 8,936,272	\$ 9,153,564
Judicial	8,219,568	8,075,571	6,868,947	6,580,810	6,275,200
Public safety	34,788,649	30,482,562	33,437,317	32,838,284	23,785,809
Public works	32,925,790	35,286,715	31,557,349	30,209,653	30,529,832
Health and welfare	538,984	538,984	731,409	708,319	772,204
Culture and recreation	1,794,679	1,750,337	1,657,626	1,917,403	544,925
Housing and development	4,015,308	2,920,984	3,832,215	2,680,820	2,136,681
Interest on long-term debt	345,034	475,610	513,383	656,350	651,456
Total governmental activities expenses	<u>\$ 92,790,005</u>	<u>\$ 89,408,657</u>	<u>\$ 88,040,813</u>	<u>\$ 84,527,911</u>	<u>\$ 73,849,671</u>
Business-type activities:					
Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 68,417
Whitfield Transit System	750,922	783,734	742,284	744,371	793,037
Dalton-Whitfield SWM Authority	-	-	-	-	495,011
Total business-type activities expenses	<u>750,922</u>	<u>783,734</u>	<u>742,284</u>	<u>744,371</u>	<u>1,356,465</u>
Total primary government expenses	<u>\$ 93,540,927</u>	<u>\$ 90,192,391</u>	<u>\$ 88,783,097</u>	<u>\$ 85,272,282</u>	<u>\$ 75,206,136</u>
Program Revenues					
Governmental activities:					
Charge for services:					
General government	\$ 1,597,716	\$ 2,108,452	\$ 2,113,176	\$ 1,900,811	\$ 1,762,921
Judicial	1,849,675	1,963,686	2,871,599	2,728,927	2,451,203
Public safety	3,739,406	3,517,869	2,338,532	2,330,452	2,426,120
Public works	556,361	609,255	128,190	145,020	997,851
Culture and recreation	156,571	169,342	145,897	147,979	149,574
Housing and development	484,943	546,497	2,202,650	2,009,994	1,725,178
Operating grants and contributions	4,938,148	3,312,192	2,458,535	2,573,112	1,224,867
Capital grants and contributions	1,452,571	1,395,063	3,044,312	2,070,393	684,788
Total governmental activities program revenues	<u>\$ 14,775,391</u>	<u>\$ 13,622,356</u>	<u>\$ 15,302,891</u>	<u>\$ 13,906,688</u>	<u>\$ 11,422,502</u>
Business-type activities:					
Charge for services:					
Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	\$ 104,618	\$ 168,986	\$ 112,466	\$ 154,392	\$ -
Whitfield Transit System	200,702	228,652	212,076	242,490	259,904
Dalton-Whitfield SWM Authority	1,724,867	828,712	651,831	600,385	-
Operating grants and contributions	304,419	360,577	289,534	290,525	314,890
Capital grants and contributions	-	-	135,445	132,227	119,929
Total business-type activities program revenues	<u>\$ 2,334,606</u>	<u>\$ 1,586,927</u>	<u>\$ 1,401,352</u>	<u>\$ 1,420,019</u>	<u>\$ 694,723</u>
Total primary government program revenues	<u>\$ 17,109,997</u>	<u>\$ 15,209,283</u>	<u>\$ 16,704,243</u>	<u>\$ 15,326,707</u>	<u>\$ 12,117,225</u>
Net (Expense)/ Revenue					
Governmental activities	\$ (78,014,614)	\$ (75,786,301)	\$ (72,737,922)	\$ (70,621,223)	\$ (62,427,169)
Business-type activities	1,583,684	803,193	659,068	675,648	(661,742)
Total primary government net (expense)/ revenue	<u>\$ (76,430,930)</u>	<u>\$ (74,983,108)</u>	<u>\$ (72,078,854)</u>	<u>\$ (69,945,575)</u>	<u>\$ (63,088,911)</u>
	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
General revenues and Other Changes in Net Position					
Governmental activities:					
Property taxes	\$ 34,220,533	\$ 32,453,402	\$ 31,513,742	\$ 28,271,752	\$ 22,608,630
Sales taxes	20,197,515	27,380,737	25,680,398	25,524,158	17,936,259
Insurance premium tax	4,560,447	4,272,930	3,962,650	3,700,351	3,477,199
Alcoholic beverage tax	411,188	407,996	404,559	397,186	387,485
Hotel/Motel tax	228,692	260,224	246,476	257,608	259,461
Miscellaneous taxes	717,816	700,966	842,068	792,105	728,783
Miscellaneous	262,590	191,478	1,097,834	980,016	1,068,644
Gain or (loss) on sale of capital assets	-	-	783,670	47,711	89,543
Investment earnings	149,271	109,718	11,719	10,674	17,166
Transfers	(234,383)	(197,885)	(105,229)	(79,129)	(98,314)
Total governmental activities	<u>\$ 60,513,669</u>	<u>\$ 65,579,566</u>	<u>\$ 64,437,887</u>	<u>\$ 59,902,432</u>	<u>\$ 46,474,856</u>
Business-type activities:					
Transfers	\$ 234,383	\$ 197,885	\$ 105,229	\$ 79,129	\$ 98,314
Total primary government	<u>\$ 60,748,052</u>	<u>\$ 65,777,451</u>	<u>\$ 64,543,116</u>	<u>\$ 59,981,561</u>	<u>\$ 46,573,170</u>
Change in Net Position					
Governmental activities	\$ (17,500,945)	\$ (10,206,735)	\$ (8,300,035)	\$ (10,718,791)	\$ (15,952,313)
Business-type activities	1,818,067	1,001,078	764,297	754,777	(563,428)
Total primary government	<u>\$ (15,682,878)</u>	<u>\$ (9,205,657)</u>	<u>\$ (7,535,738)</u>	<u>\$ (9,964,014)</u>	<u>\$ (16,515,741)</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FUND BALANCES OF GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
LAST TEN YEARS

	<u>2024</u>	<u>2023</u>	<u>2022</u>
General fund:			
Nonspendable	\$ 560,010	\$ 569,234	\$ 444,771
Unassigned	<u>29,462,476</u>	<u>34,765,919</u>	<u>35,464,532</u>
Total general fund	<u><u>\$ 30,022,486</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 35,335,153</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 35,909,303</u></u>
All other governmental funds:			
Nonspendable	\$ 3,199,512	\$ -	\$ -
Restricted	13,106,942	15,167,050	14,679,032
Committed	3,603,881	3,689,448	2,799,149
Assigned	386,272	277,269	161,850
Unassigned	<u>(2,945,986)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>(12,645)</u>
Total all other governmental funds	<u><u>\$ 17,350,621</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 19,133,767</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 17,627,386</u></u>

Note: This schedule reports using the modified accrual basis of accounting.

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FUND BALANCES OF GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
LAST TEN YEARS**

2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
\$ 415,908	\$ 421,669	\$ 407,940	\$ 419,191	\$ 380,294	\$ 368,221	\$ 369,163
28,914,750	28,386,644	26,744,207	22,648,547	19,107,881	15,485,677	13,475,415
<u>\$ 29,330,658</u>	<u>\$ 28,808,313</u>	<u>\$ 27,152,147</u>	<u>\$ 23,067,738</u>	<u>\$ 19,488,175</u>	<u>\$ 15,853,898</u>	<u>\$ 13,844,578</u>
\$ 5,750	\$ -	\$ 346,031	\$ 329,530	\$ 2,191,099	\$ 1,808,567	\$ 6,421,863
24,304,893	37,596,763	17,334,405	21,170,375	16,412,612	23,879,901	34,314,997
3,174,106	756,559	1,133,233	1,036,282	710,508	492,114	309,353
5,034	-	-	-	-	-	-
(25)	(636)	(54,268)	-	-	-	-
<u>\$ 27,489,758</u>	<u>\$ 38,352,686</u>	<u>\$ 18,759,401</u>	<u>\$ 22,536,187</u>	<u>\$ 19,314,219</u>	<u>\$ 26,180,582</u>	<u>\$ 41,046,213</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES, GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
LAST TEN YEARS

	<u>2024</u>	<u>2023</u>	<u>2022</u>	<u>2021</u>
REVENUES				
Taxes	\$ 78,306,893	\$ 79,470,149	\$ 79,302,917	\$ 72,868,278
Licenses and permits	936,067	1,440,291	862,365	910,965
Intergovernmental revenues	11,987,342	17,183,099	9,863,245	8,365,957
Charges for services	5,435,446	6,481,913	5,031,675	5,372,739
Fines, forfeitures and penalties	1,710,603	1,466,647	1,659,930	1,204,303
Investment earnings	1,772,841	1,909,327	284,124	17,341
Contributions and donations	476,378	27,862	33,570	34,475
Miscellaneous	1,982,923	1,754,787	1,815,631	1,452,378
Total revenues	<u>102,608,493</u>	<u>109,734,075</u>	<u>98,853,457</u>	<u>90,226,436</u>
EXPENDITURES				
Current -				
General government	11,948,125	11,481,643	10,476,588	9,427,655
Judicial	9,322,377	8,764,985	8,610,550	7,581,261
Public safety	41,098,843	39,565,527	35,610,118	33,219,604
Public works	10,826,978	8,334,502	7,988,436	7,801,794
Health and welfare	645,988	1,064,844	660,776	582,415
Culture and recreation	3,176,047	2,746,594	1,715,927	1,377,143
Housing and development	3,966,437	3,848,655	3,253,426	2,631,588
Capital outlay	12,134,729	13,829,829	20,019,520	30,787,095
Intergovernmental	8,481,476	8,354,907	8,887,007	-
Debt service				
Principal retirement	7,420,823	7,303,822	7,150,941	7,445,602
Interest and fiscal charges	90,957	166,236	242,298	318,286
Total expenditures	<u>109,112,780</u>	<u>105,461,544</u>	<u>104,615,587</u>	<u>101,172,443</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over expenditures	<u>(6,504,287)</u>	<u>4,272,531</u>	<u>(5,762,130)</u>	<u>(10,946,007)</u>
OTHER FINANCING SOURCES (USES)				
Sale of capital assets	165,723	48,907	2,738,095	123,142
Refunding bond issued	-	-	-	-
Proceeds from contract payable	-	-	-	-
Debt service-principal	-	-	-	-
Loans issued	-	-	-	-
Transfers in	4,583,036	4,439,509	4,452,042	4,936,747
Transfers out	(4,583,036)	(4,439,509)	(4,711,734)	(4,454,465)
Issuance of subscriptions payable	-	153,729	-	-
Total other financing sources (uses)	<u>165,723</u>	<u>202,636</u>	<u>2,478,403</u>	<u>605,424</u>
Net change in fund balances	<u>\$ (6,338,564)</u>	<u>\$ 4,475,167</u>	<u>\$ (3,283,727)</u>	<u>\$ (10,340,583)</u>
Debt service as a percentage of noncapital expenditures	7.75%	8.15%	8.74%	11.03%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES, GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
LAST TEN YEARS

2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
\$ 57,309,435	\$ 59,164,252	\$ 65,404,921	\$ 63,333,501	\$ 58,564,076	\$ 45,310,716
526,571	560,668	616,922	557,925	436,518	493,552
9,807,590	5,515,071	4,932,147	6,287,273	4,717,912	2,928,682
5,141,580	5,493,125	5,297,091	4,792,305	4,735,662	5,730,081
1,173,584	1,356,867	1,510,315	1,988,743	1,859,148	1,559,477
141,754	386,272	304,338	154,055	142,584	95,528
115,984	78,800	10,758	125,665	192,400	56,733
1,377,695	1,307,950	1,193,376	1,097,834	980,016	1,068,644
75,594,193	73,863,005	79,269,868	78,337,301	71,628,316	57,243,413
8,978,357	8,648,900	8,213,542	7,923,960	7,614,471	7,540,769
7,282,472	7,081,220	6,893,666	6,739,930	6,360,274	6,134,696
30,467,387	28,165,902	26,034,268	25,197,530	23,650,687	21,735,455
6,753,012	7,379,739	6,940,552	7,114,105	5,466,017	6,493,425
541,984	538,984	538,984	572,134	549,044	612,929
1,449,851	1,351,865	1,332,659	1,327,158	1,283,623	1,138,648
3,709,746	3,823,622	2,755,086	3,093,880	2,570,046	3,762,866
16,239,471	5,589,860	8,004,753	11,654,041	18,110,292	8,783,617
668,130	3,863,467	7,807,862	10,140,514	10,204,929	4,027,612
1,816,488	6,808,983	6,967,691	8,030,794	7,985,100	3,486,981
522,205	345,034	475,610	513,333	658,727	621,587
78,429,103	73,597,576	75,964,673	82,307,379	84,453,210	64,338,585
(2,834,910)	265,429	3,305,195	(3,970,078)	(12,824,894)	(7,095,172)
31,464	104,083	38,490	843,221	47,711	
-	-	-	-	-	4,885,000
26,500,000	-	-	-	-	18,434,044
(2,700,000)	-	-	-	-	(4,775,000)
296,528	172,494	3,655,731	-	-	-
8,880,727	1,692,648	2,750,617	3,569,036	3,492,573	3,383,897
(8,924,358)	(1,927,031)	(2,948,502)	(3,674,265)	(3,571,701)	(3,482,210)
-	-	-	-	-	-
24,084,361	42,194	3,496,336	737,992	(31,417)	18,535,274
\$ 21,249,451	\$ 307,623	\$ 6,801,531	\$ (3,232,086)	\$ (12,856,311)	\$ 11,440,102
3.76%	10.52%	10.95%	12.01%	12.80%	7.68%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
ASSESSED AND ESTIMATED ACTUAL VALUE OF TAXABLE PROPERTY
LAST TEN YEARS

CALENDAR YEAR	REAL PROPERTY	PERSONAL PROPERTY	PUBLIC UTILITIES
2015	\$ 2,102,030,066	\$ 1,030,285,340	\$ 71,487,661
2016	2,128,163,776	1,011,402,852	74,391,237
2017	2,255,189,012	1,056,032,717	72,768,592
2018	2,256,931,862	1,112,036,982	72,404,907
2019	2,306,803,979	1,165,073,140	74,358,989
2020	2,332,359,233	1,179,972,215	75,874,332
2021	2,474,534,343	1,160,639,757	79,784,151
2022	2,419,794,915	1,248,839,165	83,244,379
2023	3,063,435,404	1,434,692,401	74,807,238
2024	3,341,397,001	1,443,110,379	86,643,918

NOTES:

1. Real property includes commercial and residential property.
2. All property is assessed at 40% of the estimated actual value.
3. Tax rate is per \$1,000 of assessed value

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
ASSESSED AND ESTIMATED ACTUAL VALUE OF TAXABLE PROPERTY
LAST TEN YEARS

LESS TAX-EXEMPT PROPERTY	TOTAL		ASSESSED TO TOTAL ESTIMATED ACTUAL VALUE	TOTAL DIRECT TAX RATE
	ASSESSED VALUE	ESTIMATED ACTUAL VALUE		
\$ (907,271,796)	\$ 2,296,531,271	\$ 5,741,328,178	40%	7.061
(896,054,401)	2,317,903,464	5,794,758,660	40%	9.561
(887,587,000)	2,496,403,321	6,241,008,303	40%	9.329
(912,374,586)	2,528,999,165	6,322,497,913	40%	9.312
(967,023,121)	2,579,212,987	6,448,032,468	40%	8.812
(1,654,832,810)	1,933,372,970	4,833,432,425	40%	8.312
(1,550,717,725)	2,164,240,526	5,410,601,315	40%	7.312
(1,084,063,231)	2,667,815,228	6,669,538,070	40%	7.300
(1,214,207,428)	3,358,727,615	8,396,819,038	40%	6.000
(1,424,208,812)	3,446,942,486	8,617,356,215	40%	5.556

Source: Whitfield County Tax Assessor's Office.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
PROPERTY TAX RATES - ALL OVERLAPPING GOVERNMENTS
LAST TEN YEARS

CALENDAR YEAR	COUNTY RATES					COUNTY SCHOOLS	CITY OF DALTON	DALTON SCHOOLS	CITY OF VARNELL	DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY OF DALTON	STATE OF GEORGIA	TOTAL OVERLAPPING
	MAINTENANCE AND OPERATING	SPECIAL FIRE DISTRICT	SOLID WASTE	JOINT DEVELOPMENT	TOTAL COUNTY							
2015	7.061	1.283	0.341	0.376	9.061	18.756	2.511	8.200	2.404	0.950	0.050	41.932
2016	9.561	1.283	0.341	0.376	11.561	18.756	2.506	8.200	2.404	0.950	0.000	44.377
2017	9.329	2.755	0.286	0.397	12.767	18.756	2.506	8.200	2.404	0.950	0.000	45.583
2018	9.312	2.755	0.286	0.397	12.750	18.756	2.505	8.770	2.404	2.500	0.000	47.685
2019	8.812	2.755	0.286	0.397	12.250	18.756	2.482	8.770	2.352	2.500	0.000	47.110
2020	8.312	2.755	0.286	0.397	11.750	18.756	2.237	8.770	2.346	2.500	0.000	46.359
2021	7.312	2.755	0.286	0.397	10.750	18.756	2.208	8.665	2.335	2.500	0.000	45.214
2022	7.300	2.755	0.286	0.397	10.738	18.756	2.207	8.650	2.326	1.500	0.000	44.177
2023	6.000	2.755	0.286	0.000	9.041	18.500	1.936	8.460	1.895	0.990	0.000	40.822
2024	5.556	2.755	0.286	0.000	8.597	18.756	1.841	9.420	1.736	0.990	0.000	41.340

Source: Tax Commissioner's Office.

Notes:

1. Tax rates are shown in dollars per \$1,000 of assessed value.
2. 2024 Rates are based on the collection order not the final 2024 Digest. These will be updated in 2025 to the Final 2024 Digest.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

PRINCIPAL TAXPAYERS

Current Year and Nine Years Ago

2024			2015		
TAXPAYER	TAXABLE ASSESSED VALUATION	PERCENT OF TOTAL ASSESSED VALUATION	TAXPAYER	TAXES LEVIED	PERCENT OF TOTAL ASSESSED VALUATION
SHAW INDUSTRIES	\$ 968,189,979	28.09%	SHAW INDUSTRIES	\$ 7,759,348	36.34%
MOHAWK INDUSTRIES / WORLD CARPETS	613,376,475	17.79%	MOHAWK INDUSTRIES	2,336,584	12.41%
ENGINEERED FLOORS / PENTZ STREET HOLDI	465,801,477	13.51%	ENGINEERED FLOORS	1,530,233	9.15%
TARKETT USA	126,531,569	3.67%	BEAULIEU GROUP	1,316,158	6.81%
ORIENTAL WEAVERS	86,318,188	2.50%	J & J INDUSTRIES	905,896	3.24%
NORTH GEORGIA EMC	71,308,680	2.07%	TANDUS FLOORING	892,553	3.61%
GEORGIA POWER COMPANY	56,935,036	1.65%	NORTH GEORGIA EMC	609,268	2.29%
SYNTHETIC TURF RESOURCES	56,075,811	1.63%	SHIROKI GEORGIA LLC	475,749	1.51%
QTS PROCUREMENT LLC	33,458,760	0.97%	WINDSTREAM GEORGIA	447,022	1.52%
SPECTRUM SOUTHEAST	32,388,106	0.94%	NORFOLK SOUTHERN	427,256	1.89%

Source: Whitfield County Tax Commissioner's Office

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
PROPERTY TAX LEVIES AND COLLECTIONS
LAST TEN YEARS**

DIGEST YEAR	TAXES LEVIED	REFUNDS ADJUSTMENTS	TOTAL ADJUSTED LEVY	COLLECTED WITHIN THE YEAR OF THE LEVY		COLLECTIONS IN SUBSEQUENT YEARS	TOTAL COLLECTIONS TO DATE	
				AMOUNT	PERCENTAGE OF ORIGINAL LEVY		AMOUNT	PERCENTAGE OF ADJUSTED LEVY
2015	\$ 19,414,088	\$ (268,181)	\$ 19,145,907	\$ 17,343,021	89.33%	\$ 1,802,142	\$ 19,145,163	100.00%
2016	25,089,495	218,166	25,307,661	23,059,586	91.91%	2,238,025	25,297,611	99.96%
2017	28,953,450	(448,366)	28,505,084	27,056,626	93.45%	1,446,403	28,503,029	99.99%
2018	29,263,039	(456,714)	28,806,325	27,388,243	93.59%	1,396,058	28,784,301	99.92%
2019	28,571,237	(316,508)	28,254,729	26,646,024	93.26%	1,525,411	28,171,435	99.71%
2020	27,250,769	(369,260)	26,881,509	25,432,446	93.33%	1,280,954	26,713,400	99.37%
2021	25,028,113	199,438	25,227,551	23,636,659	94.44%	1,587,359	25,224,018	99.99%
2022	25,550,231	114,695	25,664,926	23,233,524	90.93%	2,046,428	25,279,952	98.50%
2023	24,830,695	(166,355)	24,664,340	1,227,181	4.94%	23,067,194	24,294,375	98.50%
2024	25,701,932	(431,808)	25,270,124	8,558,825	33.30%	14,061,658	22,620,483	89.51%

Source: Whitfield County Tax Commissioner's Office

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
TAX REVENUES BY SOURCE - GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
LAST TEN YEARS

CALENDAR YEAR	PROPERTY	LOCAL OPTION SALES	SPECIAL PURPOSE LOCAL OPTION SALES	INSURANCE PREMIUM	ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGE	REAL ESTATE TRANSFER	OTHER	TOTAL
2015	\$ 22,678,327	\$ 10,448,099	\$ 7,488,160	\$ 3,477,199	\$ 387,485	\$ 75,851	\$ 755,595	\$ 45,310,716
2016	28,074,028	9,848,729	15,675,429	3,700,351	397,186	88,347	780,006	58,564,076
2017	32,409,272	9,896,272	15,784,126	3,962,650	404,559	105,913	770,709	63,333,501
2018	32,382,872	10,561,298	16,819,439	4,272,930	407,996	140,684	819,702	65,404,921
2019	33,011,018	11,159,405	9,038,110	4,560,447	408,301	121,637	865,334	59,164,252
2020	33,466,092	12,153,696	6,132,305	4,838,448	439,003	137,324	712,866	57,879,734
2021	31,713,738	12,933,171	21,358,294	5,022,222	427,652	192,197	799,289	72,446,563
2022	34,415,709	14,504,025	24,067,556	4,888,585	422,523	227,907	776,612	79,302,917
2023	31,848,423	15,468,337	25,547,638	5,295,852	401,523	125,518	782,858	79,470,149
2024	<u>32,119,003</u>	<u>15,201,161</u>	<u>25,348,965</u>	<u>5,632,927</u>	<u>400,551</u>	<u>74,489</u>	<u>893,817</u>	<u>79,670,913</u>
Percentage Change In Dollars Over 10 Years	<u>41.6%</u>	<u>45.5%</u>	<u>238.5%</u>	<u>62.0%</u>	<u>3.4%</u>	<u>-1.8%</u>	<u>18.3%</u>	<u>75.8%</u>

Note:

Other: Includes financial institution business taxes, franchise taxes, hotel/motel taxes and fireworks excise taxes.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
RATIO OF OUTSTANDING DEBT BY TYPE
LAST TEN YEARS

CALENDAR YEAR	GOVERNMENTAL ACTIVITIES				BUSINESS- TYPE ACTIVITIES		TOTAL PRIMARY GOVERNMENT	PERCENT OF PERSONAL INCOME	PER CAPITA
	REVENUE BONDS	INTER- GOVERNMENTAL LIABILITY	CAPITAL LEASES	NOTES PAYABLE	CAPITAL LEASES				
2015	\$14,504,000	\$ 18,584,321	\$ 207,115	\$ 379,840	-		\$ 33,675,276	1.00%	\$ 324
2016	11,344,000	13,948,206	110,713	284,880	-		25,687,799	0.74%	246
2017	8,111,000	9,341,558	14,577	189,920	-		17,657,055	0.47%	169
2018	5,903,000	7,655,887	413,624	127,584	-		14,100,095	0.36%	135
2019	4,252,000	2,700,000	295,661	205,118	-		7,452,779	0.18%	69
2020	2,987,000	26,500,000	-	501,646	-		29,988,646	0.72%	287
2021	2,128,000	19,962,000	-	453,046	-		22,543,046	0.50%	219
2022	1,619,000	13,369,000	-	404,105	-		15,392,105	0.32%	149
2023	1,095,000	6,715,000	-	354,820	-		8,164,820	0.16%	79
2024	556,000	-	-	305,187	-		861,187	0.02%	8

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
RATIO OF NET GENERAL BONDED DEBT TO
ASSESSED VALUE AND NET BONDED DEBT PER CAPITA
LAST TEN YEARS

CALENDAR YEAR	POPULATION	ASSESSED VALUE	GROSS BONDED DEBT	DEBT SERVICE AVAILABLE	NET BONDED DEBT	RATIO OF NET BONDED DEBT TO ASSESSED VALUE	NET BONDED DEBT PER CAPITA
2015	104,216	\$ 2,296,531,271	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2016	104,589	2,317,903,464	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2017	104,658	2,496,403,321	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2018	104,062	2,528,999,165	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2019	104,628	2,579,212,987	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2020	102,864	1,933,372,970	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2021	102,848	2,164,240,526	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2022	103,132	2,667,815,228	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2023	103,687	3,358,727,615	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2024	105,070	3,446,942,486	-	-	-	0.00%	-

Source: Whitfield County Tax Assessor's Office

Note:

Gross bonded debt includes all long-term general obligation bonds.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DIRECT AND OVERLAPPING GOVERNMENTAL ACTIVITIES DEBT
AS OF DECEMBER 31, 2024

<u>Governmental Unit</u>	<u>Debt Outstanding</u>	<u>Estimated Percentage Applicable</u>	<u>Estimated Share of Overlapping Debt</u>
Overlapping Debt			
City of Dalton Board of Education (1)	13,050,000	100%	13,050,000
City of Dalton (1)	16,470,000	100%	16,470,000
City of Varnell (2)	85,000	100%	<u>82,500</u>
Total Overlapping Debt			<u>\$ 29,602,500</u>
County Direct Debt			
Whitfield County	\$ -	100%	<u>-</u>
Total County Direct Debt			<u>-</u>
Total Direct and Overlapping Debt			<u><u>\$ 29,602,500</u></u>

Sources:

- (1) Data provided by City of Dalton Finance Office
- (2) Data provided by City of Varnell City Manager

Note: Overlapping governments are those that coincide, at least in part, with the geographic boundaries of the County. This schedule estimates the portion of the outstanding debt of those overlapping governments that is borne by the residents and businesses of Whitfield County. Applicable percentages were estimated by determining the portion of another government unit's assessed value that is within the County's boundaries and dividing it by each unit's total assessed value. Entities are situated entirely within the geographic boundaries of the County.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA **LEGAL DEBT MARGIN INFORMATION** **LAST TEN YEARS**

	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
Debt limit	\$ 487,115,130	\$ 487,115,130	\$ 375,187,846	\$ 369,799,832	\$ 374,214,346	\$ 362,059,510	\$ 360,998,985	\$ 357,122,803	\$ 342,787,384	\$ 344,445,910
Total net debt applicable to limit	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Legal debt margin	<u>\$ 487,115,130</u>	<u>\$ 487,115,130</u>	<u>\$ 375,187,846</u>	<u>\$ 369,799,832</u>	<u>\$ 374,214,346</u>	<u>\$ 362,059,510</u>	<u>\$ 360,998,985</u>	<u>\$ 357,122,803</u>	<u>\$ 342,787,384</u>	<u>\$ 344,445,910</u>
Total net debt applicable to the limit as a percentage of debt limit	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%

Legal debt margin calculation for 2024

	4,871,151,298
Assessed value of taxable property	\$ 3,446,942,486
Add: exempt real property	<u>1,424,208,812</u>
Total assessed value of taxable property	4,871,151,298
Debt limit (10%) of total assessed value	487,115,130
Debt applicable to limit	<u>-</u>
Legal debt margin	<u><u>\$ 487,115,130</u></u>



WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA DEMOGRAPHIC STATISTICS LAST TEN YEARS

CALENDAR YEAR	POPULATION	PERSONAL INCOME	PER CAPITA INCOME	UNEMPLOYMENT RATE
2015	104,216	3,380,245,960	32,435	5.8%
2016	104,589	3,484,591,713	33,317	5.7%
2017	104,658	3,774,804,744	36,068	5.5%
2018	104,062	3,886,819,762	37,351	4.4%
2017	104,658	3,774,804,744	36,068	5.5%
2018	104,062	3,886,819,762	37,351	4.8%
2019	104,628	4,054,544,256	38,752	4.4%
2020	102,864	4,177,431,000	39,927	7.3%
2021	102,848	4,889,878,000	47,545	3.9%
2022	103,132	4,770,680,056	46,258	3.8%
2023	103,687	4,972,310,085	47,955	3.3%
2024	105,070	4,759,565,930	45,299	4.2%

Population source: United States Census Bureau (<https://www.census.gov/quickfacts/fact/table/whitfieldcountygeorgia/PST045224>)

Per Capita Income source: Bureau of Economic Analysis (www.bea.gov/sites/default/files/2024-11/lapi1124.pdf) and GA Labor Market Explorer

Unemployment rate source: GDOL (www.dol.georgia.gov/area-unemployment-rate-and-labor-force-estimates)

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA PRINCIPAL EMPLOYERS CURRENT YEAR AND NINE YEARS AGO

2024			2015		
EMPLOYER	EMPLOYEES	PERCENT OF TOTAL EMPLOYMENT	EMPLOYER	EMPLOYEES	PERCENT OF TOTAL EMPLOYMENT
Shaw Industries, Inc.	6,133	12.44%	Shaw Industries, Inc.	7,517	17.36%
Mohawk Industries	4,172	8.46%	Mohawk Industries	6,015	12.86%
Engineered Floors	3,600	7.30%	Beaulieu Group, LLC	2,056	4.40%
Whitfield County Schools	1,899	3.85%	Whitfield County Schools	1,500	3.21%
Q cells	1,800	3.65%	Hamilton Medical Center	1,059	2.26%
Hamilton Medical Center	1,763	3.58%	Tandus	879	1.88%
Tarkett	1,182	2.40%	Dalton City Schools	800	1.71%
Dalton Public Schools	970	1.97%	Engineered Floors	750	1.60%
Whitfield County	707	1.43%	Shiroki North America, Inc.	705	1.51%
City of Dalton	675	1.37%	J&J Flooring Group	665	1.42%

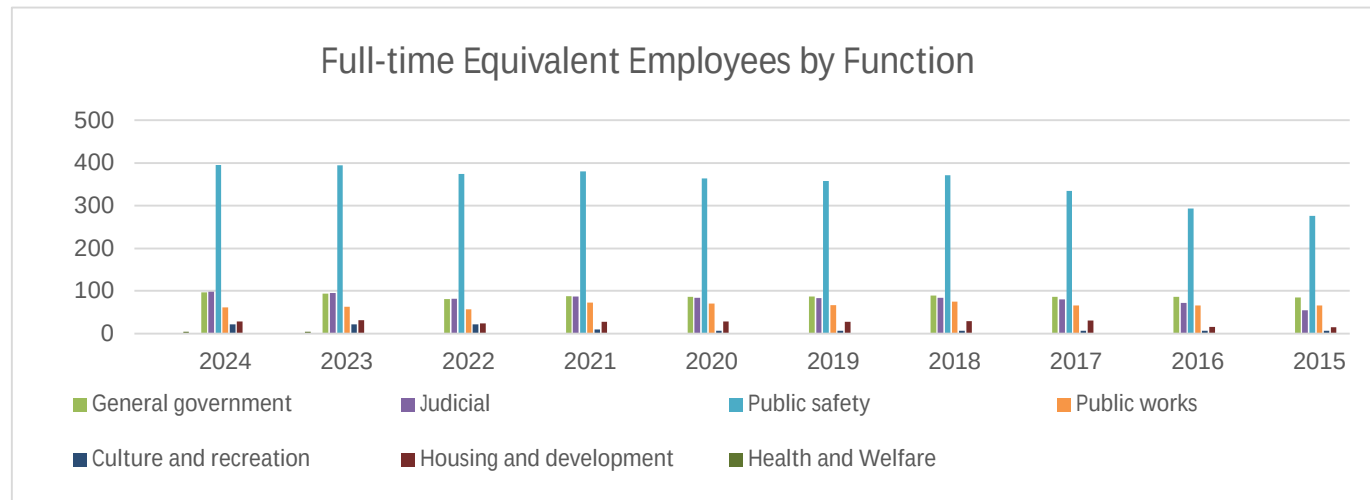
Source:

<https://locationdalton.com/regional-data/major-employers>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

FULL-TIME EQUIVALENT WHITFIELD COUNTY EMPLOYEES BY FUNCTION LAST TEN YEARS

Function/Program	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
General government	97	94	81	88	86	87	89	86	86	85
Judicial	98	95	82	87	84	83	84	80	72	55
Public safety	395	394	374	380	364	358	371	335	293	276
Public works	62	63	57	73	71	67	75	66	66	66
Health and Welfare	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Culture and recreation	22	22	22	10	7	7	7	7	7	7
Housing and development	29	32	24	28	29	28	30	31	16	15
Total	708	705	640	666	641	630	656	504	501	501



Source: Whitfield County Human Resources Department

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
OPERATING INDICATORS BY FUNCTION
LAST TEN YEARS**

Function/Program	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
General government										
Vehicle tags issued (in dollars)	175,107	174,885	168,726	157,457	155,540	162,605	N/A	107,475	106,856	100,966
Public safety										
E-911 calls	217,617	239,205	227,539	238,079	230,750	227,498	185,955	178,449	N/A	292,937
Fire service calls	6,659	6,743	9,878	8,856	7,600	6,613	5,357	5,677	6,031	5,518
Fire average response time (minutes)	5.6	5.5	5.5	5.5	6.4	6.2	6.1	5.9	6.2	6.2
EMS service calls	16,406	16,354	16,935	17,490	16,347	16,600	16,655	15,069	13,421	13,848
EMS average response time (minutes)	9.5	9.3	9.6	10.1	9.5	9.4	10.0	9.8	8.6	8
Public works										
Miles of road resurfacing	31.0	25.0	28.0	22.0	4.8	18.5	23.4	27.4	27.0	8.7
Culture and recreation										
Number of program participants	3,718	4,236	3,804	3,601	2,300	3,692	4,033	4,054	3,944	3,820
Housing and development										
Building permits issued	2,266	3,263	3,050	3,287	2,621	622	665	508	517	442

Source: Department managers within each function

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CAPITAL ASSET STATISTICS BY FUNCTION
LAST TEN YEARS**

Function/Program	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
General government County facilities	24	23	21	21	21	21	21	21	21	21
Public safety Fire stations	12	12	12	12	12	12	11	10	10	10
Public works Miles of roads	724	724	724	711	711	664	664	711	718	718
Culture and recreation County owned ball fields	25	24	23	18	18	19	20	20	20	17

Source: Department managers within each function

Part IV

Other Reporting Section



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SINGLE AUDIT SECTION

This section contains reports required by the Uniform Guidance and grantor agencies.

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**Independent Auditor's Report on Internal Control over Financial Reporting and on
Compliance and Other Matters Based on an Audit of Financial Statements
Performed In Accordance with Government Auditing Standards**

Honorable Chairman and Members
of the Board of Commissioners
Whitfield County, Georgia

We have audited, in accordance with the auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America and the standards applicable to financial audits contained in *Government Auditing Standards*, issued by the Comptroller General of the United States, the financial statements of the governmental activities, the business-type activities, the discretely presented component unit, each major fund, and the aggregate remaining fund information of Whitfield County, Georgia, as of and for the year ended December 31, 2024, and the related notes to the financial statements, which collectively comprise Whitfield County, Georgia's basic financial statements and have issued our report thereon dated June 30, 2025. Our report includes a reference to other auditors who audited the financial statements of Whitfield County Health Department, as described in our report on Whitfield County, Georgia's financial statements. This report does not include the results of the other auditors' testing of internal control over financial reporting or compliance and other matters that were reported on separately by those auditors.

Report on Internal Control over Financial Reporting

In planning and performing our audit of the financial statements, we considered Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over financial reporting (internal control) as a basis for designing audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances for the purpose of expressing our opinions on the financial statements, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control. Accordingly, we do not express an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control.

Our consideration of internal control was for the limited purpose described in the preceding paragraph and was not designed to identify all deficiencies in internal control that might be material weaknesses or significant deficiencies and therefore, material weaknesses or significant deficiencies may exist that have not been identified. However, as described in the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs, we identified certain deficiencies in internal control that we consider to be material weaknesses and significant deficiencies.

A *deficiency in internal control* exists when the design or operation of a control does not allow management or employees, in the normal course of performing their assigned functions, to prevent, or detect and correct, misstatements on a timely basis. A *material weakness* is a deficiency, or a combination of deficiencies, in internal control, such that there is a reasonable possibility that a material misstatement of the entity's financial statements will not be prevented, or detected and corrected on a timely basis. We consider the deficiency described in the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs as item 2024-001 to be a material weakness.

A *significant deficiency* is a deficiency, or a combination of deficiencies, in internal control that is less severe than a material weakness, yet important enough to merit attention by those charged with governance. We consider the deficiencies described in the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs as items 2024-002 through 2024-004 to be significant deficiencies.

Report on Compliance and Other Matters

As part of obtaining reasonable assurance about whether Whitfield County, Georgia's financial statements are free of material misstatement, we performed tests of its compliance with certain provisions of laws, regulations, contracts, and grants agreements, noncompliance with which could have a direct and material effect on the determination of financial statement amounts. However, providing an opinion on compliance with those provisions was not an objective of our audit, and accordingly, we do not express such an opinion. The results of our tests disclosed no instances of noncompliance or other matters that are required to be reported under *Government Auditing Standards*.

Whitfield County, Georgia's Response to Findings

Government Auditing Standards requires the auditor to perform limited procedures on Whitfield County, Georgia's response to the findings identified in our audit and described in the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs. Whitfield County, Georgia's response was not subjected to the other auditing procedures applied in the audit of the financial statements and, accordingly, we express no opinion the response.

Purpose of This Report

The purpose of this report is solely to describe the scope of our testing of internal control and compliance and the results of that testing, and not to provide an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control or on compliance. This report is an integral part of an audit performed in accordance with *Government Auditing Standards* in considering the entity's internal control and compliance. Accordingly, this communication is not suitable for any other purpose.

Rushton, LLC

Gainesville, Georgia
June 30, 2025

**Independent Auditor's Report on Compliance for Each Major Program and on
Internal Control over Compliance Required by the Uniform Guidance**

Honorable Chairman and Members
of the Board of Commissioners
Whitfield County, Georgia

Report on Compliance for Each Major Federal Program

Opinion on Each Major Federal Program

We have audited Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance with the types of compliance requirements identified as subject to audit in the *OMB Compliance Supplement* that could have a direct and material effect on each of Whitfield County, Georgia's major federal programs for the year ended December 31, 2024. Whitfield County, Georgia's major federal programs are identified in the summary of auditor's results section of the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs.

In our opinion, Whitfield County, Georgia complied, in all material respects, with the types of compliance requirements referred to above that could have a direct and material effect on each of its major federal programs for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2024.

Basis for Opinion on Each Major Federal Program

We conducted our audit of compliance in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America; the standards applicable to financial audits contained in *Government Auditing Standards*, issued by the Comptroller General of the United States; and the audit requirements of Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards* (Uniform Guidance). Our responsibilities under those standards and the Uniform Guidance are further described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of Compliance section of our report.

We are required to be independent of Whitfield County, Georgia and to meet our other ethical responsibilities, in accordance with relevant ethical requirements relating to our audit. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion on compliance for each major federal program. Our audit does not provide a legal determination of Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance with the compliance requirements referred to above.

Responsibilities of Management for Compliance

Management is responsible for compliance with the requirements referred to above and for the design, implementation, and maintenance of effective internal control over compliance with the requirements of laws, statutes, regulations, rules, and provisions of contracts or grant agreements applicable to Whitfield County, Georgia's federal programs.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of Compliance

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether material noncompliance with the compliance requirements referred to above occurred, whether due to fraud or error, and express an opinion on Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance based on our audit. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not absolute assurance and therefore is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards, *Government Auditing Standards*, and the Uniform Guidance will always detect material noncompliance when it exists. The risk of not detecting material noncompliance resulting from fraud is higher than for that resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control. Noncompliance with the compliance requirements referred to above is considered material if there is a substantial likelihood that, individually or in the aggregate, it would influence the judgment made by a reasonable user of the report on compliance about Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance with the requirements of each major federal program as a whole.

In performing an audit in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards, *Government Auditing Standards*, and the Uniform Guidance, we:

- Exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism throughout the audit.
- Identify and assess the risks of material noncompliance, whether due to fraud or error, and design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks. Such procedures include examining, on a test basis, evidence regarding Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance with the compliance requirements referred to above and performing such other procedures as we considered necessary in the circumstances.
- Obtain an understanding of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over compliance relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances and to test and report on internal control over compliance in accordance with the Uniform Guidance, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over compliance. Accordingly, no such opinion is expressed.

We are required to communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and any significant deficiencies and material weaknesses in internal control over compliance that we identified during the audit.

Report on Internal Control over Compliance

A deficiency in internal control over compliance exists when the design or operation of a control over compliance does not allow management or employees, in the normal course of performing their assigned functions, to prevent, or detect and correct, noncompliance with a type of compliance requirement of a federal program on a timely basis. A *material weakness in internal control over compliance* is a deficiency, or a combination of deficiencies, in internal control over compliance, such that there is a reasonable possibility that material noncompliance with a type of compliance requirement of a federal program will not be prevented, or detected and corrected, on a timely basis. A *significant deficiency in internal control over compliance* is a deficiency, or a combination of deficiencies, in internal control over compliance with a type of compliance requirement of a federal program that is less severe than a material weakness in internal control over compliance, yet important enough to merit attention by those charged with governance.

Our consideration of internal control over compliance was for the limited purpose described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of Compliance section above and was not designed to identify all deficiencies in internal control over compliance that might be material weaknesses or significant deficiencies in internal control over compliance. Given these limitations, during our audit we did not identify any deficiencies in internal control over compliance that we consider to be material weaknesses, as defined above. However, material weaknesses or significant deficiencies in internal control over compliance may exist that were not identified.

Our audit was not designed for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of internal control over compliance. Accordingly, no such opinion is expressed. The purpose of this report on internal control over compliance is solely to describe the scope of our testing of internal control over compliance and the results of that testing based on the requirements of the Uniform Guidance. Accordingly, this report is not suitable for any other purpose.

Rushton, LLC

Gainesville, Georgia
June 30, 2025

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF EXPENDITURES OF FEDERAL AWARDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

Federal Grant/Pass-Through Grantor/Program Title	Federal Assistance Listing Number	Pass- Through Number	Expenditures	Amounts Provided to Subrecipients
Department of Agriculture				
Forest Services Schools and Roads Cluster Passed through the Georgia Office of State Treasurer: Schools and Roads - Grants to States	10.665	486Forest	\$ 7,626	\$ 0
Department of Housing and Urban Development				
Passed through the Georgia Department of Community Affairs: Home Investment Partnerships Program	14.239	2022-115	287,871	0
Department of the Interior				
Payments in Lieu of Taxes	15.226	N/A	32,438	0
Passed through the Georgia Department of Natural Resources: Outdoor Recreation Acquisition, Development, and Planning	15.916	P20AP00125/13-01014 P22AP01133/13-01067	7,700 39,558 47,258	0 0 0
Total Department of the Interior			79,696	0
Department of Justice				
Passed through the Criminal Justice Coordinating Council Delinquency Prevention Program	16.548	L21-8-025 L21-8-031	30,843 12,563 43,406	0 0 0
Crime Victim Assistance	16.548	C23-8-249 C23-8-101	32,770 93,289 126,059	0 0 0
Violence Against Women Formula Grants	16.588	W23-8-058	73,730	0
Total Department of Justice			243,195	0
Department of Transportation				
Passed through the Georgia Department of Transportation: Highway Planning and Construction	20.205	PI0020231-PLN PI0019734-PLN	54,621 130,074 184,695	0 0 0
Federal Transit Cluster Federal Transit Formula Grants	20.507	T008761 T008887	133,179 192,830 326,009	0 0 0
Total Federal Transit Cluster				
Formula Grants for Rural Areas and Tribal Transit Program	20.509	T007364	99,529	0
Total Department of Transportation			610,233	0

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF EXPENDITURES OF FEDERAL AWARDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

Federal Grant/Pass-Through Grantor/Program Title	Federal Assistance Listing Number	Pass- Through Number	Expenditures	Amounts Provided to Subrecipients
Department of the Treasury				
COVID-19 Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds	21.027	N/A	\$ 3,706,216	\$ 0
Passed through the Georgia Office of Planning and Budget: COVID-19 Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds	21.027	GA-0013725 GA-0013697 GA-0013857	6,800 41,322 315,398 <u>363,520</u>	0 0 0 <u>0</u>
Passed through the Judicial Council of Georgia: COVID-19 Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds	21.027	2023 ARPA 3Y046,3Y002	176,557	88,843
Total Department of the Treasury			<u>4,246,293</u>	<u>88,843</u>
Appalachian Regional Commission				
Appalachian Area Development	23.002	CH2023-G037	5,178	0
Department of Health and Human Services				
Passed through the Georgia Department of Health/GA Southern: Epidemiology and Laboratory Capacity for Infection Diseases (ELC)	93.323	40500-036-23234503 40500-036-23234503	22,617 99,457 <u>122,074</u>	0 0 <u>0</u>
Aging Cluster Passed through the Northwest Georgia Regional Commission - Area Agency on Aging: Special Programs for the Aging, Title III, Part C, Nutrition Services	93.045	FY2025	41,496	0
Total Department of Health and Human Services			<u>163,570</u>	<u>0</u>
Executive Office of the President				
High Intensity Drug Trafficking Areas Program	95.001	N/A	8,581	0
Department of Homeland Security				
Passed through the Georgia Emergency Management Agency: Hazard Mitigation Grant	97.039	HMGP-4579-0001	17,064	0
Emergency Management Performance Grants	97.042	OEM-22-157	30,780	0
Homeland Security Grant Program	97.067	EMW-2021-SS-00080	7,294	0
Total Department of Homeland Security			<u>55,138</u>	<u>0</u>
Total Federal Awards			<u>\$ 5,707,381</u>	<u>\$ 88,843</u>

See accompanying notes to the schedule of expenditures of federal awards and the schedule of findings and questioned costs.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE SCHEDULE OF EXPENDITURES OF FEDERAL AWARDS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

1. Basis of Presentation

The accompanying schedule of expenditures of federal awards (the Schedule) includes the federal award activity of Whitfield County, Georgia, under programs for the federal government for the current year. The information in this schedule is presented in accordance with the requirements of Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards* (Uniform Guidance). Because this schedule presents only a selected portion of the operations of the County, it is not intended to and does not present the financial position, changes in net position or cash flows of the County.

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies

Expenditures reported on the Schedule are reported on the accrual basis of accounting. Such expenditures are recognized following the cost principles contained in Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards*, wherein certain types of expenditures are not allowable or are limited as to reimbursement.

3. De Minimis Indirect Cost Rate

Whitfield County, Georgia has elected not to use the 10-percent *de minimis* indirect cost rate allowed under the Uniform Guidance.

4. Payments to Subrecipients

For the current year, Whitfield County, Georgia passed federal funds through to subrecipients in the amount of \$88,843.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF FINDINGS AND QUESTIONED COSTS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

1. Summary of the Auditor's Results

A. Financial Statements

Type of auditor's report issued:	Unmodified
Internal control over financial reporting:	
Material weakness(es) identified?	Yes
Significant deficiencies identified not considered material weaknesses?	Yes
Noncompliance material to financial statements noted?	None reported

B. Federal Awards

Internal control over major programs:	
Material weakness(es) identified?	None reported
Significant deficiencies identified not considered material weaknesses?	None reported
Type of auditor's report issued on compliance for major programs:	Unmodified
Any audit findings disclosed that are required to be reported in accordance with the Uniform Guidance?	None reported
Identification of major programs:	
21.027 COVID-19 Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds	
Dollar threshold used to distinguish Between Type A and Type B programs:	\$750,000
Auditee qualified as low-risk auditee?	No

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF FINDINGS AND QUESTIONED COSTS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

2. Financial Statement Findings and Responses

2024-001

Condition: The prior year financial statements were restated for errors and incorrectly reported amounts in the Governmental Activities, 2020 SPLOST Fund, the Whitfield Transit System Fund. The County lacks sufficient controls and procedures regarding year-end close to ensure timely and accurate financial reporting. Material adjustments were required during the audit process.

Criteria: Generally accepted accounting principles require balances reported in the financial statements to be properly calculated and recorded. Internal controls should be in place to ensure the County can perform timely and accurate year-end close procedures.

Effect: Failure to properly design and implement internal controls over year-end close procedures and to accurately calculate financial statement balances caused financial statements to be materially misstated.

Cause: Financial statement balances were not accurately calculated due to various miscalculations and posting and classification errors.

Recommendation: The Finance Department should review their year-end procedures for recording assets and liabilities and make necessary adjustments to those procedures to verify amounts are accurately calculated. For example, we recommend performing a second independent review before recording adjustments. The second review and approval should be evidenced by dating and initialing workpapers to confirm financial statement balances are accurately calculated.

Management Response: Management concurs with this finding. Finance Department personnel will implement a second review policy to ensure that financial statement amounts are properly calculated and recorded. This action was taken immediately upon receipt of the comment from our auditors.

2024-002

Condition: Appropriate segregation of duties does not exist among recording, distributing, and reconciliation of cash accounts and other operational functions in the various departments throughout the County. This is especially prominent in the Tax Commissioner's Office, the Sheriff's Office, the Magistrate Court, and the Clerk of Superior Court.

Criteria: Segregation of employees' duties is a common practice in an effective internal control structure. Segregation of duties is when specific employee functions related to important accounting areas (such as cash receipting and cash disbursements) are separated among different individuals to significantly reduce the risk that any one individual could intentionally or unintentionally misappropriate assets.

Effect: Failure to maintain adequate segregation of duties exposes the assets of the County to greater risk of misappropriation.

Cause: There are constitutional offices of the County that lack adequate segregation of duties.

Recommendation: We recommend that each County office review its policies and procedures to determine where it can adequately segregate duties to alleviate the segregation of duties issues.

Management Response: Management has provided a copy of this finding to the appropriate Elected Officials and they concur with this finding. Action was taken immediately upon receipt of this comment from our auditors.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF FINDINGS AND QUESTIONED COSTS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

2. Financial Statement Findings and Responses, continued

2024-003

Condition: During audit procedures at the offices of the Tax Commissioner's Office and the Magistrate Court, we noted no formal approval process for voided transactions.

Criteria: Proper internal controls require that all voided transactions are properly approved.

Effect: Failure to maintain proper supporting documentation with evidence of approval for voided transactions subjects the assets of the County to greater risk of misappropriation.

Cause: Management is not approving voided transactions.

Recommendation: Supporting documentation with evidence of approval of voided transactions should be retained at the offices of the Tax Commissioner's Office and the Magistrate Court.

Management Response: Management has provided a copy of this finding to the appropriate Elected Official and they concur with this finding. This action was taken immediately upon receipt of the comment from our auditors.

2024-004

Condition: During audit procedures at the Building Inspections and Enforcements Department, we noted instances where deposits were not made timely. Receipts were held for more than seven days before depositing in 16 of 40 (40%) tested building permit receipts.

Criteria: Proper internal controls require that cash receipts be deposited and transactions recorded in a timely manner.

Effect: Failure to deposit cash receipts in a timely manner exposes the County to a greater risk of loss due to fraud.

Cause: Building Inspections and Enforcements Department staff is not delivering deposits to the Finance Department weekly.

Recommendation: At a minimum, deposits should be made at least weekly.

Management Response: Management concurs with this finding. Management will advise the appropriate Department Head to implement the recommendation. This action was taken immediately upon receipt of the comment from our auditors.

3. Prior Year Audit Findings Follow-Ups

2023-001

Condition: State law requires local governments to adopt and operate under annual appropriated balanced budgets for all governmental funds. Management did not adopt and operate under a balanced budget for the American Rescue Plan Act Special Revenue Fund, the SPLOST 2020 Fund, and the SPLOST Fund. Each of the funds' budget was amended to utilize additional fund balance, however, the budgeted utilization exceeded available balances.

Corrected

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF FINDINGS AND QUESTIONED COSTS
For the year ended December 31, 2024

4. *Federal Award Findings and Questioned Costs*

The audit of our basic financial statements and schedule of expenditures of federal awards disclosed no audit findings or questioned costs which are required to be reported under Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards*.

STATE REPORTING SECTION

This section contains additional reports required by the State of Georgia.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF PROJECTS FINANCED WITH SPECIAL
PURPOSE LOCAL OPTION SALES TAX
For the year ended December 31, 2024

Project	Estimated Cost *		Expenditures		
	Original	Current	Prior Years**	Current Year	Total
<u>2008 SPLOST</u>					
Road Improvements	\$ 36,289,785	\$ 36,289,785	\$ 36,447,468	\$ 561,920	\$ 37,009,388
City of Dalton road projects	11,710,215	13,862,676	13,862,676	0	13,862,676
Total	<u>\$ 48,000,000</u>	<u>\$ 50,152,461</u>	<u>\$ 50,310,144</u>	<u>\$ 561,920</u>	<u>\$ 50,872,064</u>
<u>2015 SPLOST</u>					
County-wide communication project	\$ 8,040,000	\$ 8,040,000	\$ 7,797,393	\$ 0	\$ 7,797,393
Library improvements	335,000	337,455	98,150	0	98,150
Public safety vehicles and improvements	6,400,000	6,678,226	6,678,227	0	6,678,227
Fire station and land	1,400,000	1,400,000	1,400,000	0	1,400,000
Edwards Park gymnasium	2,000,000	3,006,178	3,006,178	0	3,006,178
Recreational park projects	2,400,000	2,400,000	1,553,208	0	1,553,208
Roads, streets, and bridge projects	15,000,000	16,328,338	16,304,164	1,505	16,305,669
City of Dalton	24,525,000	26,567,961	26,567,961	0	26,567,961
City of Cohutta	485,000	485,000	485,000	0	485,000
City of Tunnel Hill	700,000	700,000	700,000	0	700,000
City of Varnell	315,000	315,000	315,000	0	315,000
Total	<u>\$ 61,600,000</u>	<u>\$ 66,258,158</u>	<u>\$ 64,905,281</u>	<u>\$ 1,505</u>	<u>\$ 64,906,786</u>
<u>2020 SPLOST</u>					
Courthouse improvements	\$ 6,000,000	\$ 6,829,931	\$ 6,830,021	\$ 73,748	\$ 6,903,769
Correctional Center improvements	850,000	2,865,000	2,020,542	497,665	2,518,207
Fire Dept. debt payoff, improvements, and vehicles	4,667,743	4,667,743	1,461,029	789,658	2,250,687
Animal Control projects	200,000	270,802	270,800	10,639	281,439
Library improvements and technology	1,200,000	1,200,000	22,691	209,417	232,108
Roads, streets, and bridge projects, and public works equipment	9,396,450	9,396,450	9,354,286	3,593,923	12,948,209
Public safety vehicles	1,469,252	2,711,468	2,711,468	947,256	3,658,724
Sewer improvements, Carbondale, Connector 3, Cleveland Highway	4,942,500	4,942,500	3,312,123	5,116	3,317,239
Westside Park/Miracle Field improvements and field construction	2,300,000	2,300,000	1,139,656	2,022,952	3,162,608
R'bend Park construction, infrastructure, community center, and fields	13,000,000	16,119,065	16,192,461	68,380	16,260,841
Rocky Face Ridge Park improvements	300,000	300,000	284,728	0	284,728
Bond interest	700,000	700,000	545,703	61,778	607,481
City of Dalton	19,099,000	25,154,842	25,990,278	4,221,983	30,212,261
City of Cohutta	378,560	378,560	378,560	0	378,560
City of Tunnel Hill	490,945	490,945	490,945	0	490,945
City of Varnell	1,005,550	1,005,550	1,005,550	0	1,005,550
Total	<u>\$ 66,000,000</u>	<u>\$ 79,332,856</u>	<u>\$ 72,010,841</u>	<u>\$ 12,502,515</u>	<u>\$ 84,513,356</u>
Principal payments on long-term liabilities used to fund previous SPLOST projects				<u>6,715,000</u>	
Total Expenditures and Transfers Out of the 2020 SPLOST Capital Projects Fund				<u>\$ 19,217,515</u>	

**The prior years column has been restated for 2020 SPLOST in the amount \$802,105 to correct the beginning balance of City of Dalton intergovernmental payments.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF PROJECTS FINANCED WITH SPECIAL
PURPOSE LOCAL OPTION SALES TAX
For the year ended December 31, 2024

Project	Estimated Cost *		Expenditures		
	Original	Current	Prior Years**	Current Year	Total
2024 SPLOST					
Fire station renovations, equipment, and vehicles	\$ 6,950,000	\$ 6,950,000	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Correctional Center improvements	1,100,000	1,100,000	0	0	0
Courthouse improvements	1,200,000	1,200,000	0	0	0
Sheriff's Firing Range and Training Center improvements	51,000	51,000	0	0	0
Prater's Mill renovations	478,000	478,000	0	0	0
First Responder/Transit building	85,000	85,000	0	0	0
Public Safety radios and phone systems	3,000,000	3,000,000	0	0	0
Roads, streets, and bridge projects, and public works equipment	28,100,000	28,100,000	0	1,783,386	1,783,386
Sheriff's Office vehicles and equipment	1,830,950	1,830,950	0	0	0
Edward's Park improvements, equipment, and vehicles	2,250,000	2,250,000	0	0	0
Westside Park improvements, Community Center and Gymnasium	4,050,000	4,050,000	0	0	0
Rocky Face Ridge Park improvements	150,000	150,000	0	0	0
Sewer and infrastructure improvements	900,000	900,000	0	148,153	148,153
City of Dalton	26,815,050	26,815,050	0	1,219,493	1,219,493
City of Cohutta	592,000	592,000	0	592,000	592,000
City of Tunnel Hill	752,000	752,000	0	752,000	752,000
City of Varnell	1,696,000	1,696,000	0	1,696,000	1,696,000
Total	\$ 80,000,000	\$ 80,000,000	\$ 0	\$ 6,191,032	\$ 6,191,032

* Estimated cost represents the portion of these projects to be financed with Special Purpose Local Option Sales Tax.
Actual costs that are in excess of these amounts have been financed through alternative funds.

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